Colle, London and Blackmar Diemer Systems

T. D. Harding







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Best regards!!
Saludos!

Caissa Lovers

SPECIALIST CHESS OPENINGS

GENERAL EDITOR: R.G. WADE

Colle, London and Blackmar-Diemer systems

T.D. HARDING

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Contents

Symbols and References vi
Preface vii
1 Introduction 1
2 Colle System (2 ♘f3, 3 e3), Ideas and Irregular Lines 10
3 Main Line Colle (with ... d5) 22
4 Colle v. Queen's Indian (... b6) 34
5 London System (♗f4), Introduction 40
6 London v. King's Indian (... g6) 52
7 Miscellaneous after 2 ♘f3 69
8 Stonewall (2 e3 with f4 and c3) 83
9 Blackmar-Diemer Gambit (2 e4) 87
Index of Complete Games 102
Index of Variations 103

Symbols and References

+	check
=	balanced position
±	some advantage to White
∓	some advantage to Black
±	clear advantage to White
∓	clear advantage to Black
∞	unclear
!	good move
!!	excellent move
!?	enterprising move (or idea worth further investigation)
?!	dubious move
?	weak move
??	outright blunder
Δ	with the idea of ...
1-0	Black resigned
½-½	Draw
0-1	White resigned
Ch	Championship
corres	Correspondence game

W or B at the side of a diagram indicates which player is to move. In the text, a number in brackets after a move refers to the diagram of that number.

The following were my chief sources:

ECO	*Encyclopaedia of Chess Openings* (volume D)
Euwe	*Theorie der Schach-Eroffnungen* (Tiel III, Berlin 1966)
Koltanowski	*Colle System* (Chess Digest)
N and T	Neikirkh and Tsvetkov, *Shakmatny Debyuti* (volume 3; Sofia 1968)
Pachman	(i) *Queen's Gambit and other Closed Games*; (ii) *Indian Systems*

and the following journals and periodicals:
British Chess Magazine, Chess, Chess Player 1-14, Fernschach, Informator 1-26 (R50-59), *Shakhmatny Bulletin, 64.*

Special cources for chapter 9 were:

E.J.Diemer	- *Vom Ersten Zug an Auf Matt!* (Amsterdam 1956, reprinted 1976 Schachverlag Rudi Schmauss, under the title *'Das moderne Blackmar-Diemer Gambit*)
Kampars and Tejler	- Chess Digest booklets (*Discover the Blackmar-Diemer Gambit*, 5 vols 1971-77)

PREFACE

This book deals chiefly with the Colle System and with the opening 1 d4, 2 ♘f3, 3 ♗f4 (sometimes called the London System). I also discuss some variations (such as 1 d4 d5 2 ♘f3 c5 and 1 d4 d5 2 ♘f3 ♗f5) which players adopting these openings need to know. One advantage of these debuts is their universality - White can play them against either 1 ... ♘f6 or 1 ... d5 and adapt them to more or less any subsequent development used by Black.

The Colle and London Systems are more dangerous than their reputations. They may be somewhat old-fashioned, but that too can be a practical advantage. Players tend to study the variations used by contemporary grandmasters to the neglect of the old. This does not, however, invalidate the knowledge gained by the players of the past and readers will therefore find many pre-war games (and even some pre 1914 games) in this book.

The reader who adopts these openings in his own games will, consequently, be able to use ideas developed by some of the great masters of the past - while, at the same time, catching his less-prepared opponents on unfamiliar ground. There have, of course, been some developments in recent years - as the dates of the examples quoted show. In selecting games quoted, I have tried to blend the significant modern examples of the Queen Pawn Openings with the accepted theory and classical examples of these systems.

I should like to take this opportunity of thanking all those people whose help, encouragement and bullying finally brought this book into being. Apart from all at Batsfords, credit is due to Robert Bellin, Les Blackstock, George Botterill, Michael Franklin, and Arthur Hall.

T.D.Harding
Dublin
February 1979

1 Introduction

The Queen Pawn Openings discussed in this book have rarely attracted the attention of theoreticians. Nevertheless they have considerable practical value.

Many players do not have the time to study the fashionable openings which the masters play and which the experts and keen students imitate. They want a reliable way of beginning the game which will not be overthrown by some sensational grandmaster refutation, an opening which they can rely on from season to season. The Colle System and the London (♗f4) systems in this book are such openings.

There is, moreover, a lot to be said for learning an uncommon but sound opening and playing it regularly. Soon you know much more about it than your opponents do. Understanding from experience the middle-game positions which arise from it, especially when the opening is of a strategic rather than tactical character, is an advantage which far outweighs any risk that the occasional opponent, knowing your repertoire, may prepare a special answer to it.

The British master, Michael Franklin, has scored countless points with the London system against the King's Indian Defence, 1 d4 ♘f6 2 ♘f3 g6 3 ♗f4 which is discussed in chapter 6. In his hands, a supposedly innocuous opening has become a fearsome weapon with which, at one time or another, he has defeated most of the leading English players.

It is noteworthy that Spassky has taken up this variation, although he did not handle it in quite the same way as Franklin. Here is the game Spassky-Bukic, Bugojno 1978:

1	**d4**	**♘f6**
2	**♘f3**	**g6**
3	**♗f4**	

3 ♗g5 has become more popular recently, but it does not have quite the same meaning as the move played by Spassky. On g5, the bishop may help to control d5 (by threatening ♗xf6) but it does not give White pressure against the

square c7, which is one of the features of the London System. Also the bishop on g5 may be more readily challenged, by ... h6 or ... ♘e4.

In this book I shall not be considering Queen Pawn Openings in which White develops this bishop on g5.

3	...	♗g7
4	e3	0-0
5	♗e2	

This is a modest square for the bishop, which Franklin usually plays to c4. White is in effect playing, in reverse, the London System against Reti's Opening. This consists in erecting a barrier of pawns (by d4, e3 and often c3 also) to minimise the effect of the fianchettoed black bishop, having first developed White's own bishop outside the pawn chain in order to avoid its becoming bad. Against the Reti, there is the same choice of squares for the king's bishop.

5	...	d6
6	0-0	♘bd7
7	h3	

Black plays to achieve the advance ... e5, which cannot be prevented. In doing so, however, he is backward in the development of his ♕-side. The plan of ... b6 and ... ♗b7, perhaps in conjunction with ... c5, is sometimes preferred. White plays h3 in order to preserve his bishop; the move is usually desirable sooner or later.

7	...	♕e8
8	c4	

The reason for not playing ♗c4 is now seen. Spassky intends to take the initiative on the ♕-side.

8	...	e5
9	♗h2	♕e7

Bukic criticised this move in *Informator*, preferring 9 ... ♘e4 (to meet 10 ♘c3 with 10 ... ♘xc3). At least two courses would have been open to Spassky then. He could have played 10 ♘a3!? and, after 10 ... a6 or 10 ... c6, 11 ♖c1 preparing for c4-c5. Alternatively, he could challenge the knight by 10 ♘fd2 ♘df6 (10 ... ♘xd2 11 ♕xd2) 11 de de 12 ♕c2 ♗f5 13 ♗d3. White's positional edge should survive the simplifications because Black's e-pawn is under pressure on e5. If it advances to e4 then the h2-b8 diagonal becomes open for the white bishop.

9 ... ♘e4 was tried in Yusupov-Tukmakov, USSR 1st League 1978, but the reply was 10 ♘bd2. There followed 10 ... ♘xd2 11 ♕xd2 e4 12 ♘e1 ♕e7 13 ♘c2 f5 with a reasonable position for Black. After 14 b4 g5 15 c5 ♘f6 16 ♘a3 f4 17 ef g4 18 hg ♘xg4 19 ♗xg4 ♗xg4 the position became double-edged but a draw was agreed after 20 ♖ae1 dc 21 dc ♖ad8 22 ♕c1 ♖d3 23 ♖e3 ♖fd8 24 ♕c4+ ♕f7 25 ♕xe4 ♗f5 26 ♕c4 ♖xe3 27 fe ♖d2 28 ♕xf7+ ♔xf7 29 ♘c4 ♖xa2 30 ♘e5 ♗xe5 in view of the active black rook and opposite coloured bishops which cancel out White's extra pawn.

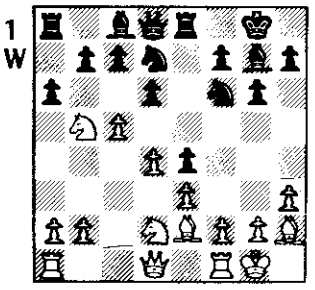
10	♘c3	e4

The sequel shows this advance to be mistaken. A game F.Portisch-Butnorius, USSR 1969, went instead 10 ... c6 11 ♕c2 ♘e8 12 b4 f5 13 c5 d5 14 de ♘xe5 15 ♘d4 ♘f6 =. Almost certainly, Spassky had a stronger continuation in mind. 11 c5!? is a possibility, for if 11 ... dc 12 de, 11 ... d5 12 ♘xe5 while if 11 ... ed 12 ed or 11 ... e4 12 ♘fd2 the threat of 13 ♗d6, winning the exchange, becomes embarrassing for Black.

11	♘d2	♖e8
12	♘b5	♕d8

The queen returns to her home square, having made three moves! However 12 ... ♘f8 13 c5 would also be unsatisfactory (13 ... dc 14 ♘xc7).

13	c5!	a6*(1)*



Spassky now demonstrates the correctness of his strategy by 'winning' three pawns for a knight. The rest of the game requires less comment.

14	cd!	ab
15	dc	♕e7
16	♗xb5	

One of Spassky's extra pawns is a protected pawn on the 7th - thanks to the London System bishop. He also controls most of the squares that matter so Bukic finds it hard to organise his pieces.

16	...	♗f8
17	♘c4	♕e6
18	♕c2	♕d5

If 18 ... ♘d5 19 a3 followed by ♖ae1 and the break f2-f3.

19	a4	♖e6
20	♖fc1	♘e8
21	♕c3	♘ef6

Not 21 ... ♘d6? 22 ♗xd7 ♗xd7 22 ♘b6.

22	♘e5	♘b6
23	♘c4	♘fd7
24	♕b3	

Defending b5 and so threatening a4-a5.

24	...	♖f6
25	♗xd7	♘xd7
26	♕b5!	♕f5

Not 26 ... ♕xb5 27 ab ♖xa1 28 ♖xa1 followed by ♖a8.

27	♗g3	♖fa6

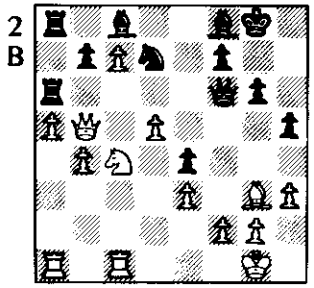
27 ... h5 was a better try, according to Bukic, who was now in time trouble.

28	d5!	♕f6
29	a5	h5
30	b4*(2)*	

A new phase: White threatens to cash in his pawn majority by advancing it.

30	...	h4
31	♗h2	♕f5
32	♖f1!	g5
33	f3	♖g6
34	♖ad1	ef
35	♖xf3	♕c2

Bukic's desperate counter-attack



has resulted only in the exchange of the e-pawn which was his last bulwark in the centre.

36	♖d2	♕c3
37	d6	♖a6
38	e4	♕c1+
39	♖f1	♕c3
40	♕d5	♘f6

The weak f-pawn (40 ... ♖g7 41 ♖df2) causes the collapse of the blockade.

41	♖xf6!	1-0

If 41 ... ♕xf6 42 d7 ♗xd7 43 ♕xd7 and the c-pawn will be next to claim a victim, while if 41 ... ♖xf6 42 ♗e5 ♕c1+ 43 ♖d1 White not only wins the rook but he still has his pawns.

The full discussion of the London System against ... g6 is in chapter 6. The move ♗f4 can also be played at move 2 or 3 against other set-ups by Black, e.g. 1 d4 ♘f6 2 ♘f3 e6 (or 2 ... b6) 3 ♗f4 or 1 d4 d5 2 ♗f4 or 1 d4 d5 2 ♘f3 ♘f6 3 ♗f4. Such lines are to be found in chapter 5.

Although this type of attack is by no means new - it dates back to the beginning of the century at least - it has still not received a thorough investigation. The main idea is, once more, to use the ♗f4 to exploit any weaknesses that may appear on the b8-h2 diagonal, especially if Black has played not only ... d5 but also ... e6 or ... c6 as well. Secondary ideas are to post a knight on e5 and then to adopt a Colle-like formation aimed at an eventual ♔-side attack.

One drawback of the ♗f4 systems is that Black may be able to counter-attack rapidly against b2, which is left unprotected by the bishop sortie. A lively recent example of this plan is the following game, which probably raises more questions than it answers.

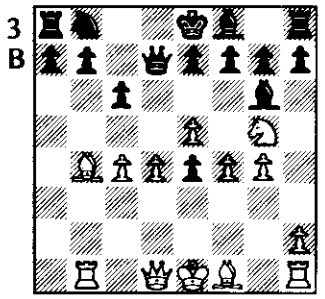
Rakic-Bagirov, 'Partizan Belgrade' v. Burevestnik, European Club Championship 1979:

1	d4	d5
2	♘f3	c6
3	♗f4	♕b6
4	♘bd2	

4 ♕c1 is safer.

4	...	♕xb2
5	e4	♘f6
6	e5	♘e4
7	♘xe4	de
8	♖b1	♕xa2
9	♘g5	♕a5+
10	♗d2	♕d5
11	♗b4	♗f5
12	g4	♗g6
13	c4	♕d7
14	f4*(3)*	

Can White's gambit be sound? In this game it was enterprisingly refuted.



14	...	ef
15	e6	f2+!

16 ♔xf2 fe 17 ♖b2 ♘a6 18 ♗c3 e5 19 ♗g2 e6 20 ♖e1 ♗e7 21 ♖xe5 0-0+ 22 ♔g1 ♗f6 23 ♘f3 ♖ad8 24 ♖e1 c5 25 ♘e5 ♗xe5 26 ♖xe5 cd 27 ♖xb7 ♕xb7! 28 ♗xb7 dc 29 ♕c1 c2 30 ♖e1 ♘c5 31 ♗e4 ♗xe4 32 ♖xe4 ♖d1+ 0-1.

An earlier example in which ♗f4 was more successful is von Scheve-Marshall, Monte Carlo 1901:

1	d4	d5
2	♗f4	c5
3	e3	♘c6
4	c3	♕b6
5	♕d2	c4?

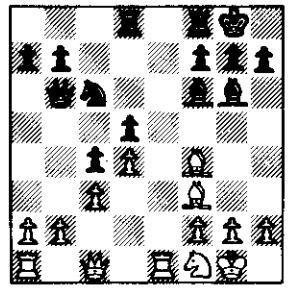
This is almost invariably a mistake because it takes all the pressure off White's centre. 5 ... ♘f6 is correct.

6	♘f3	♘f6
7	♗e2	♗f5
8	0-0	♘e4
9	♕c1	e6
10	♘bd2	♗e7
11	♘xe4	♗xe4
12	♘d2	♗g6
13	e4	

Retribution for Black's 5th move begins. The c4-pawn is now seen to be weak.

13	...	0-0
14	ed	ed
15	♗f3	♖ad8
16	♖e1	♗f6
17	♘f1*(4)*	

Black's long-term prospects are not good. White will complete his development by ♕d2 and then double his rooks on the e-file. The knight can go to e3 to increase the pressure against d5. Marshall, never one to endure torture passively, decided on a counter-stroke which at least offered practical chances.



17	...	♘xd4!?
18	cd	♕xd4
19	♗g5!	b5
20	♗xf6	♕xf6
21	♘e3	d4
22	♘d5	♕d6
23	♕d2	d3

White, with knight for two pawns, faces some technical difficulties.

24	b3	♔h8
25	bc	bc
26	♖ac1	♕c5
27	♘e3	♖d4
28	♖c3	f5

29 ♖ec1 ♕a5
30 ♖d1

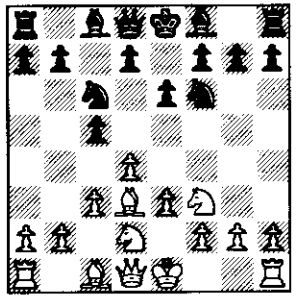
White now has a thorough blockade but 30 ... ♕c5 followed by 31 ... ♖c8 would still set him an examination in technique. Instead Marshall, untypically, blundered:

30 ... ♗f7?
31 ♖xd3 ♕xd2
32 ♖3xd2 ♖xd2 33 ♖xd2 f4 34 ♘d1 g5 35 h4 h6 36 ♘c3 ♖e8 37 ♖d7 ♖e1+ 38 ♔h2 ♗g6 39 ♖xa7 ♗f5 40 hg hg 41 ♖a5 ♗d3 42 ♖xg5 ♖c1 43 ♘d5 ♖c2 44 ♘f6 ♗h7 45 ♗e4 1-0. See chapter 5 for a full discussion of this opening.

The first chapters in this book deal with the Colle System, in which White adopts similar formations except that he delays the development of his queen's bishop. That piece may go to b2 (as in the Zuckertort form of the opening) or remain on c1 until it is clear what will be its best square. A typical formation for White can be seen in diagram 5. An allied opening is the Stonewall (chapter 8) but that is generally less recommended than the Colle because of the rigidity of the pawn formation c3+d4+e3+f4. Both openings can, however, lead to dangerous and almost automatic ♔-side attacks for White if Black is unable to find counterplay.

Diagram 5 arises by 1 d4 ♘f6 2 ♘f3 e6 3 e3 c5 4 ♗d3 ♘c6 5 c3. The move c2-c3, protecting d4 and preventing ... ♘b4, characterises the Colle system. Black may or may

5 B



not play an early ... d5. White will normally play ♘bd2, 0-0 and then advance e3-e4. There are plenty of examples of this plan against various black formations in chapters 2-4.

The game Enevoldsen-Nimzowitsch, Copenhagen 1935, followed a different course: (from diagram 5)

5 ... b6
6 0-0 ♗e7
7 a3!? 0-0
8 e4 d5

Black is late in playing this - he normally is able to meet e4 with ... de. Now White produces a middle-game similar to the Advance Variation of the French Defence.

9 e5 ♘d7
10 ♕e2 ♖e8
11 ♗f4

Nimzowitsch has to face his own strategy of over-protection! If 11 ... f6 12 ef ♗xf6 13 ♘e5! ♘xe5 14 de White has attacking chances on the ♔-side.

11 ... a5
12 ♘bd2 c4
13 ♗c2 b5

As Black's counter-attack gathers momentum, White finds a way to keep the initiative.

14 ♘e4! ♘f8

Not 14 ... de? 15 ♕xe4 threatening both ♕xh7+ and ♕xc6.

15 ♘g3 ♗d7
16 h3 ♖a7
17 ♘h2 b4
18 ab ab
19 ♖xa7 ♘xa7
20 ♖a1 ♘b5
21 ♗d2 ♕b6?

According to Pachman, Black would have had much better chances of holding the game with 21 ... bc 22 bc ♘a3 to drive the Colle bishop off its killer diagonal b1-h7.

22 ♘g4 bc
23 bc ♘a3
24 ♖xa3! ♗xa3
25 ♘h5 ♘g6

If 25 ... ♗e7 26 ♗h6! gives a winning attack.

26 ♘gf6+ ♔h8
27 ♘xg7 ♖g8
28 ♘xh7! ♔xg7

Black also loses after 28 ... ♖xg7 (or 28 ... ♔xh7 29 ♕h5+) 29 ♘f6 ♖h7! 30 ♘xh7 ♔xh7 31 ♕h5+ ♔g7 32 ♕h6+ ♔g8 33 ♗xg6 fg 34 ♕xg6+ ♔f8 35 ♗h6+ mating in 5 with checks.

29 ♕h5 f5
30 ef+ ♔f7 31 ♘g5+ ♔xf6 32 ♕f3+ ♔e7 33 ♕f7+ ♔d8 34 ♕xg8+ ♘f8 35 ♘h7 ♕b2 36 ♘xf8 ♕xc2 37 ♘xe6++ ♔e7 38 ♗g5+ ♔d6 39 ♕f8+ ♔c6 40 ♕xa3 1-0 (40 ... ♗xe6 41 ♕a6+).

The Colle System is so named because of the Belgian master Edgar Colle (1897-1932) who scored many brilliant victories with it. Colle was a dangerous attacking player who, but for ill-health, would probably have become a grandmaster. His compatriot George Koltanowski (now a Californian) was influenced by Colle and also played this opening with great success and wrote about it.

Although the system is rightly named after Colle, there were some early anticipations of his plan. Perhaps the first of these was the game Charousek-Suchting, Berlin 1897, which follows. Charousek was another player of enormous potential which was not realised because of illness (he died in 1900 at the age of 26).

Here is the game Charousek-Suchting:

1 d4 d5
2 e3 ♘f6
3 ♘f3 c5
4 c3 e6
5 ♗d3 ♘c6
6 0-0 ♗d6
7 ♘bd2 c5?!

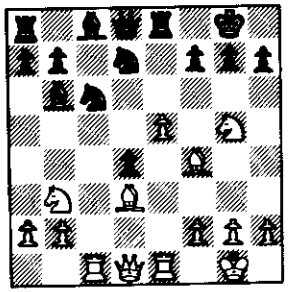
This is better delayed until Black has castled.

8 dc ♗xc5
9 e4 d4?!

As P.W.Sergeant commented, in his book *Charousek's Games of Chess*, Black is quickly subjected to an attack after this and ought to have preferred 9 ... de. Then 10

♘xe4 ♘xe4 11 ♗xe4 would offer White a slight advantage, based on the ♔-side pawn majority and threats against e5.

10	♘b3	♗b6
11	cd	ed
12	e5!	♘d7
13	♗g5	♕c7
14	♖c1	0-0
15	♖e1	♖e8
16	♗f4	♕d8
17	♘g5!*(6)*	



17	...	♘dxe5

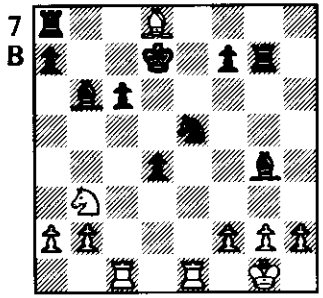
Black is obliged to accept the offered e-pawn now. If instead 17 ... ♘f8 18 ♕h5 g6 19 ♕h6 Δ 20 ♘e4, 21 ♘f6+. Or if 17 ... h6 18 ♘xf7 ♔xf7 19 ♗c4+ ♔f8 20 ♕f3 Δ 21 ♗g5+.

18	♕h5	h6
19	♗h7+	♔f8

If 19 ... ♔h8 20 ♘xf7+ ♘xf7 21 ♖xe8+ ♕xe8 22 ♗g6.

20	♗e4!	♗g4
21	♕h4	hg
22	♕h8+	♔e7
23	♗xg5+	♔d7
24	♕xg7	♖g8
25	♗xc6+	bc
26	♗xd8	♖xg7
27	♗f6!*(7)*	

Charousek avoids the nasty trap 27 ♗xb6? ♘f3+! when Black wins.



27	...	♘d3
28	♗xg7	♘xe1
29	♖xe1	c5
30	♗f6	♖e8
31	♖xe8	♔xe8
32	f3	♗f5

The smoke has cleared, leaving Charousek a pawn ahead but facing some technical difficulties. 32 ... ♗e6 (Sergeant) would have been better, the correct reply being 33 ♔f1 and not 33 ♘c1? d3 34 ♗c3 c4+ 35 ♔f1 ♗e3.

33	♘d2	♔d7
34	♘c4	♔e6

34 ... ♗c7 was also possible but Black trusted to the bishops of opposite colours.

35	♘xb6	ab
36	♗d8	b5
37	a3	c4?

Better was 37 ... ♔d5.

38	♗a5	♗c2
39	♗d2	f5?

This makes it easier for White to obtain connected passed pawns.

40	♔f2	♗d3
41	g4	♔f6
42	♔g3	♔g6
43	h4	fg
44	fg	♗e2
45	h5+	♔h7
46	♔h4	♗d1
47	g5	♔g7?

The last chance was 47 ... ♗c2 48 g6+ (not immediately forced, it is true) 48 ... ♗xg6 49 hg+ ♔xg6 50 ♔g4 c3 hoping to reach the drawn endgame of ♔ versus ♔, ♗ and a-pawn (since the bishop cannot control a8).

48	g6	♔f6
49	♗g5+	♔g7
50	♗e7!	1-0

If 50 ... d3 51 ♗b4 and 52 ♔g5 cannot be prevented since 51 ... ♔h6 52 ♗f8 is checkmate.

In the popular form of the Queen Pawn Opening, 1 d4 is followed by 2 c4. This gives White more space than the systems in this book, in which White holds back his c-pawn. The drawback of 2 c4 is that it allows Black to strike back against d4 with defences like the Benoni, King's Indian or Grünfeld or (after 1 d4 d5 2 c4) the various defences to the Queen's Gambit. All these well-analysed lines are avoided by playing 1 d4 and (after 1 ... d5 or 1 ... ♘f6) 2 ♘f3. In certain cases, such as when Black plays 2 ... ♗f5!?, White can after all play 3 c4 and obtain some advantage.

The chapters that follow discuss these openings in detail. Although there are few critical main lines, such as one finds in the Sicilian Defence, I have arranged examples so far as possible according to the normal Batsford system of variations and numbered sub-variations. The reader should remain constantly aware of the possibility of transposing from one variation to another, as (in the general absence of sharp early threats) the move-order is often flexible. Several transpositions are pointed out in the text but it would be impossible to mention all those which might arise in a game.

The Stonewall Attack (chapter 8) is an illustration of this. Although the 2 e3 move order is standard, White has the interesting alternative 2 ♘d2!? This move rules out the London System but otherwise keeps Black guessing. White may subsequently adopt a Stonewall but he also has the option of a delayed ♘gf3. In that case he leads the game into a Colle (with either c3 or b3).

My final bonus chapter deals with the controversial Blackmar-Diemer Gambit, 1 d4 d5 2 e4!? de 3 ♘c3 ♘f6 4 f3. I have concentrated my attention there on the two most popular defences, Bogoljubow's 5 ... g6 and the Tartakower-Gunderam Defence 4 ... ef 5 ♘xf3 ♗f5. These, I believe, are the main reason the gambit is rarely played in serious master chess. Nevertheless, the cause of the Blackmar-Diemer is far from hopeless below master level and any chess player can derive instruction and entertainment from its analysis.

2 Colle System (2 ♘f3, 3 e3), Ideas and Irregular Lines

The Queen Pawn Openings to be discussed in chapters 2-4 involves White adopting the piece-pawn set up shown in diagram 5. This opening was a speciality of the Belgian master Edgar Colle (1897-1932) and of his compatriot George Koltanowski (who later emigrated to America). They turned what in the 19th century had been an occasional method of development into a major attacking system with clearly defined objectives. However counters were finally found so that the Colle System has been only occasionally seen in post-war master chess. Below master level, it retains its sting in the hands of a good attacking player, especially as its finesses are largely forgotten now.

It is often said that White in the Colle System takes upon himself the role of the second player with a tempo in hand. He renounces attempts to fight for control of Black's strong-point d5 by the traditional methods (c4, ♘c3, ♗g5). Instead, he aims for e3-e4 in the middle-game, when it will be backed up by pieces massed in the centre, and for control of e5 (especially in lines with b3).

If Black plays in routine fashion, castling too early and failing to react vigorously in the centre, White has an automatic ♔-side attack which often culminates in a sacrificial breakthrough by ♗xh7+ (or ♘xf7). White's main problem is his dark-squared bishop, which is restricted by the pawn chain on its own colour.

Black's counterplay generally consists in central pawn advances aimed at saddling White with an isolated d-pawn which later may become weak, and by preparing tactical blows either against h2 or (in the lines with ... b6) on the diagonal a8-h1. He has a considerable choice of development of his bishops and queen's knight, especially if he has not played ... d5. Both players must be careful about their move-order, so to avoid confusion we shall treat the Colle and allied lines in four separate chapters, viz.:

a) All lines with ♗f4 are in chapter 5.
b) Lines with ... b6 (no early ... d5) in chapter 4.
c) Lines with ... d5 by Black and c3 by White in chapter 3.
d) Others in this chapter.

1 d4 ♘f6

Or 1 ... d5 2 ♘f3 ♘f6 3 e3, but with ... d6 no longer possible the alternative 3 ♗f4 seems more appropriate to us.

2 ♘f3 e6

Lines in which Black plays ... ♘f6 and ... d5, but refrains from ... e6, are discussed in B below.

3 e3 d5

3 ... b6 or 3 ... c5 (with ... b6 and not ... d5) are in chapter 4.

4 ♗d3

Or:

a) **4 ♘e5** ♘bd7 5 f4 ♘xe5 6 fe ♘e4 7 ♕f3 f5 8 ♘d2 ♕h4+ 9 g3 ♕h6 10 ♘xe4 fe 11 ♕f4 (Sultan Khan-Voellmy, Berne 1932) 11 ... ♕xf4 12 ef ♗e7 = ECO.

b) **4 ♗e2** c5 5 0-0 ♘c6 6 a3 ♗d6 7 dc ♗xc5 8 b4 ♗d6 9 ♗b2 0-0 10 c4 dc 11 ♗xc4 e5 = Blackburne-Pillsbury, London 1899.

c) **4 b3** c5 5 ♗b2 ♘c6 6 ♘bd2 cd (6 ... ♗d6 7 ♗d3 see A below) 7 ed ♕a5 8 a3 ♘e4 9 ♗d3 ♗xd2 10 ♘xd2 ♗e7 11 0-0 ♗d7 12 ♘f3 0-0 13 ♖e1 ± Rossetto-Karaklajic, Belgrade 1962.

d) **4 ♘bd2** c5 and now:

d1) 5 ♘e5!? ♘c6 6 ♗b5 ♕b6 7 c4 ♗d6 8 ♕a4 ♗d7 9 ♘xd7 ♘xd7 (Sultan Khan-Maroczy, London 1932) is unclear.

d2) 5 a3 ♘bd7 6 dc ♗xc5 7 b4 ♗e7 8 ♗b2 0-0 9 c4 b6 (9 ... dc 10 ♘xc4 ± Rubinstein-Capablanca, Berlin 1928) 10 ♗d3 dc 11 ♘xc4 ♗b7 12 0-0 ♖c8 13 ♕e2 (Rubinstein-Monticelli, Budapest 1929) 13 ... ♘d5 = - Evans.

d3) 5 c3 when:

d31) 5 ... ♘bd7 6 ♘e5!? (6 ♗d3 below) 6 ... ♘xe5 (6 ... ♗d6!? - ECO) 7 de ♘d7 8 f4 f6 9 ♗d3 g6 10 ef ♕xf6 11 e4 (Bisguier-Lombardy, New York 1957-58) with complications.

d32) 5 ... b6?! 6 ♗b5+! ♘bd7 (6 ... ♗d7 7 ♗d3! gaining control of e5 thanks to Black's misplaced *bishop.*) 7 ♘e5 ♗d6 8 f4 ♗b7 9 0-0 a6 10 ♗a4 ♕e7 11 ♕f3 ♗xe5 12 fe ♘e4 13 ♘xe4 de 14 ♕g4 0-0 15 ♗c2 ± Riumin-Rabinovich, Moscow 1935.

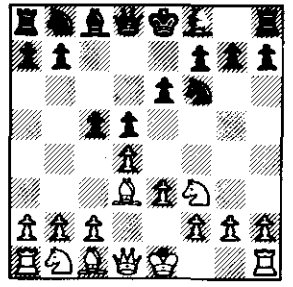
d33) 5 ... ♘c6 is usual:

d331) **6 ♗d3** below.

d332) **6 ♘e5!?** ♘xe5 7 de ♘d7 8 f4 f6 9 ♗d3 g6 10 ef ♘xf6 11 ♘f3 ♗g7 12 0-0 0-0 13 ♕e2 ♕b6 = (½:½, 47) Wahltuch-Alekhine, London 1922.

d333) **6 ♗b5** ♕b6 (or 6 ... ♕c7 7 ♘e5 ♗d6 8 f4 ♘e4!? Sultan Khan-Tartakower, match 1931) 7 ♕e2 ♗d6 8 ♘e5 ♗xe5 (8 ... 0-0!? = - ECO) 9 de ♘d7 10 f4 0-0 11 ♗d3 ♘e7 12 ♘f3 f6 13 ef ♘xf6 14 0-0 ♗d7 15 c4 ♗e8 16 ♘e5 ♘c6 = Tartakower-Euwe, Vienna 1921.

4 . . . c5 *(8)*



This move is desirable, to put pressure on the white centre, but not obligatory. Alternatives are discussed in C, below.

White now usually plays 5 c3, which is the subject of chapter 3. He can also play:

5 b3 – A, below.

5 0-0, defying Black to play ... c4 (Maroczy-Nimzowitsch, Göthenburg 1920) – a move that is invariably bad in the Colle if White can play ♗c2 (with e4 soon following) but is not so clear here. In Potter-Zukertort, 3rd match game 1875, Black played instead 5 ... ♘c6 and the game went on 6 a3!? (6 c3 or 6 b3 would be normal.) 6 ... ♗d6 7 ♘c3!? b6 8 b3 0-0 9 ♗b2 transposing to A below.

A

Colle-Zukertort System (5 b3)

Johannes Zukertort (1842-1888), the Polish-born loser of the first World Championship match (v. Steinitz in 1886), in his early career was a disciple of Adolf Anderssen and delighted in the romantic gambits like the Evans, but in his mature years was one of the pioneers of closed openings like the English, Queen's Gambit and various QPOs. In the London 1883 tournament which was his greatest triumph he played several games with a system closely allied to the one in this chapter, but in which he developed his bishop less aggressively on e2.

However, against Blackburne on 11.6.1883, he launched the system which now bears his name. This victory ensured Zukertort the first prize with four rounds still to go!

Zukertort-Blackburne: 1 d4 e6 2 ♘f3 ♘f6 3 e3 d5 4 ♗d3 ♗e7 5 0-0 0-0 6 b3 c5 7 ♗b2 ♘c6 8 ♘bd2 ('I ... determined to fight the whole battle on the Queen's side.') 8 ... cd(?) 9 ed b6 10 c4 ♗a6 ('The commencement of a futile attack ...') 11 ♖e1 ♖c8 12 ♖c1 ♘a5 13 ♘e5 ♗b4(?) 14 c5(!) ♗xd3 15 ♘xd3 ♗xd2 16 ♕xd2 ♘e4 17 ♕e3 ♖e8 18 f3 ♘f6 19 ♖c2 ♘d7 20 ♖ec1 bc ('This exchange gives White a crushing superiority in numbers on the Queen's side, which must decide the contest before Black can make any use of his strong centre.') 21 dc ♘b8 22 ♘e5 f6 ('After 22 ... ♘bc6 23 ♘xc6 ♘xc6 – 23 ... ♖xc6 24 ♗c3 – I intended to proceed with 24 b4, for Black dare not take the pawn on account of 25 ♕c3!') 23 c6(!) ♖c7 (23 ... fe 24 c7 ♕d7 25 cb=♕ ♖xb8 26 ♖c7) 24 ♕d2 (24 ♗c3?? d4!) 24 ... fe 25 ♕xa5 ♕c8 (25 ... ♘xc6? 26 ♕a4) 26 ♗xe5 ♖f7 (26 ... ♖xc6? 27 ♕xa7) 27 ♗xb8 ♕xb8 28 c7 ♕c8 29 ♕xa7 e5 30 ♖c5 e4 31 ♖b5 ♖ef8 32 ♖b8 ♕d7 33 ♖xf8+ ♖xf8 34 ♕a4 ♕xa4 35 ba ♖c8 36 fe de 37 ♔f2 (37 a5 also wins.) 37 ... ♔f7 38 ♔e3 ♔e6 39 ♔xe4 g6 40 ♖c6+ ♔d7 41 ♔d5 1-0. (Notes based on Zukertort's in the tournament book.)

Zukertort's system was revived by Morrison and Watson in the London 1922 international tournament and was subsequently played from time to time by a few grandmasters. However, it never attained the high reputation which the Colle system proper attained at its height. Black does not experience serious difficulties in equalizing so long as he avoids the exchange c5xd4 which led to Blackburne's downfall.

White occasionally plays a plan based on b3 and ♗b2 against the lines where Black avoids ... d5, but these are discussed in chapter 4 because they are not, strictly speaking, a Zukertort variation.

So, continuing from diagram 8:

5 b3 ♘c6

Others:

a) 5 ... cd?! 6 ed ♗b4+ (See below for 6 ... ♗d6 and 6 ... ♘c6.) 7 c3 (7 ♔f1!? – Alekhine) 7 ... ♗d6 8 0-0 ♘c6 9 ♕e2 ♕c7 10 ♖e1 0-0 11 ♘e5 b6 12 ♗g5 ♘e7 13 ♕f3 ± Euwe-Beffie, Hastings 1922.

b) 5 ... ♘bd7 6 ♗b2 (6 ♘bd2!?, preventing ... ♘e4 and envisaging e3-e4 – Sozin):

b1) 6 ... ♕a5+? 7 ♘bd2 ♘e4 8 0-0 (8 ♗xe4 de 9 ♘g5 cd! 10 ♘gxe4 de – Sozin) 8 ... f5 (Nenarokov-Sorokin, 6th match game 1929) 9 c4! ± – Sozin, *Shakhmatny Listok*.

b2) 6 ... ♗d6 7 0-0 ♕c7 8 ♘bd2 (8 c4!? 0-0 9 ♘c3 a6 10 cd ed 11 ♖c1 ± ECO) 8 ... e5! 9 de ♘xe5 10 ♗b5+ ♗d7 11 ♗xd7+ ♘fxd7 12 ♘xe5 ♗xe5 13 ♗xe5 ♘xe5 14 ♘f3 ♖d8 15 ♕e2 0-0 16 ♖ad1 = Tartakower-Orbakh, Giessen 1928.

b3) 6 ... b6 7 0-0 ♗b7 8 ♘bd2 ♗e7 9 dc (9 ♖e1!?) 9 ... ♗xc5 (9 ... bc 10 c4 or 9 ... ♘xc5 10 ♗b5+) 10 ♕e2 0-0 11 e4 ♖e8? (11 ... de 12 ♘xe4 ♘xe4 13 ♗xe4 ♗xe4 14 ♕xe4 ♘f6 ± ECO) 12 e5 ♘h5 13 g3 g6 14 ♘d4 ♖c8 15 f4 with a double-edged game (1-0, 41), Spielmann-Stoltz, match 1943.

b4) 6 ... cd 7 ed ♗d6 8 ♘bd2 ♕c7 9 0-0 0-0 10 ♕e2 ♖e8 11 ♘e5 ♘f8 12 f4 ♗d7 13 g4 ♗c6 14 g5 ♘6d7 15 ♕h5 ♖e7 16 ♖f3 ± Eljaschoff-Hilse, Dusseldorf 1908.

b5) 6 ... ♗e7 7 0-0 0-0 8 ♘bd2 and now:

b51) 8 ... ♕c7 9 ♘e5 b6 10 f4 ♗b7 11 c4 ♘e4 12 cd ed 13 ♘xe4 de 14 ♗c4 ♘f6 15 ♕e2 ♖ad8 16 ♖ad1 ± Rabinovich-Makagonov, 10th USSR Ch 1937.

b52) 8 ... b6 9 ♘e5 ♗b7 10 f4 ♘e4 11 ♕e2 ♖c8 12 ♘xe4 de 13 ♗b5 ♘xe5 14 de ♕c7 15 f5 ef 16 ♗c4! ♖cd8 17 ♖xf5 ♗d5 18 ♗xd5 ♖xd5 19 ♕g4 ± Guimard-Lundin, Groningen 1946.

b53) 8 ... a6 9 ♘e5 ♘xe5 10 de ♘d7 11 f4 b5 12 c4 bc 13 bc ♘b6 14 ♕c2 g6 15 ♖ad1 ± Yudovich-Blumenfeld, USSR 1934.

6 ♗b2

Alternatively:

a) 6 0-0 and now:

a1) 6 ... ♗d6 7 ♘bd2 (7 ♗b2 below) 7 ... ♕a5 and if 8 ♗b2 cd 9 ed ♗a3 - Euwe.

a2) 6 ... ♖b8 7 ♗b2 b5 8 dc ♗xc5 9 ♘d4 ♘xd4 10 ed ♗d6 11 ♕e2 b4 12 ♘d2 0-0 13 ♘f3 ♗b7 14 ♘e5 ♖c8 with complications,

Vorotnikov-Korchnoi, USSR 1964. ECO suggests 9 ♘bd2 with the idea e3-e4 ±.

a3) **6** ... cd 7 ed ♗d7 (Beltran-Djurasevic, Oberhausen 1961) 8 ♖e1!? or 8 ♗b2!? – ECO.

a4) Also noteworthy is **6** ... ♕c7!? when Havin-Ravinsky, ½-final Burevestnik Club Ch 1956, continued 7 ♗b2 (7 a3 e5 =) 7 ... cd 8 ed ♘b4 9 ♘e5 ♗d7 10 ♖e1 ♖c8 11 c4 ♘xd3 12 ♕xd3 dc 13 bc ♗d6 14 ♘d2 0-0 15 ♖e3 ♖fd8 16 ♖h3 with attacking chances (1-0, 32).

b) **6 a3** can be met by 6 ... ♕b6 7 ♗b2 c4 8 ♗e2 ♗d7 – Neikirkh and Tsvetkov.

The text move is best. White would like to tempt moves like ... ♕a5+, ... cd or ... ♘c6-b4 all of which should recoil on Black's head.

6 ... ♗d6

Questionable plans are:

a) **6** ... cd 7 ed ♗b4+ (7 ... ♗d6 below) 8 c3 ♗d6 9 0-0 0-0 10 c4 b6 11 ♘bd2 ♗b7 12 ♘e5 (1-0, 35) Rotlevi-Rozenkrantz, St Petersburg 1909.

b) **6** ... ♗e7 7 ♘bd2 ♘b4?! 8 0-0 ♘xd3 9 cd b6 10 ♘e5 ♗b7 11 f4 cd 12 ♗xd4 ± Tempelhoff-Rikman, corres 1974-5. Better 7 ... 0-0 8 0-0 b6, but not 8 ... cd which transposes to Zukertort-Blackburne above.

c) **6** ... ♗d7 7 0-0 ♖c8 8 c3 (8 a3 ± ECO) 8 ... ♗d6 9 ♘bd2 e5 10 de ♘xe5 11 ♘xe5 ♗xe5 12 ♘f3 ♗b8 13 h3 c4 14 ♗c2 0-0 15 ♕d4 ♖e8 (Gunsberg-Steinitz, match 1890) was unclear.

7 0-0

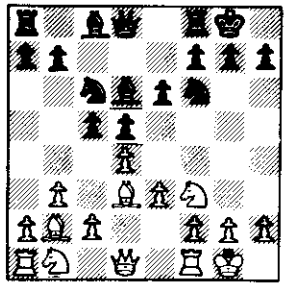
If 7 ♘bd2:

a) 7 ... ♘b4 8 ♗e2 ♕e7 9 a3 ♘c6 10 ♘e5 ♗xe5 11 de ♘d7 12 f4 f5 13 c4 ± Rubinstein-Treybal, Baden-Baden 1925.

b) 7 ... 0-0 8 a3 ♕e7 9 ♘e5 (Dus-Hotimirski v. Romanovsky, USSR 1948) 9 ... ♖d8 10 0-0 ♘d7 11 f4 ♘f8 = – Bogoljubow.

7 ... 0-0!*(9)*

7 ... ♕c7 is also playable (to prevent ♘e5) as the following game by the young Smyslov illustrates: 8 a3 b6 9 c4 ♗b7 10 ♘c3 a6 11 ♖e1 (correct is 11 dc bc 12 cd ed 13 ♖c1 starting the fight against Black's hanging pawns – Smyslov) 11 ... cd 12 ed 0-0 13 ♘a4 ♗f4 14 ♘e5 (14 c5!?) 14 ... dc 15 bc ♘xe5 16 de ♕c6! 17 ♗f1? (17 ♕f3 ∓) 17 ... ♖fd8 18 ♕b3 ♘g4 19 h3 ♖d3! 20 ♕xb6 (20 ♕xd3 ♗h2+ 21 ♔h1 ♘xf2+) 20 ... ♖xh3! 21 ♗d4 ♗h2+ 22 ♔h1 ♗xe5+ 0-1 Gerasimov-Smyslov, Moscow House of Pioneers Ch 1935.



After the text move, Alekhine wrote, 'White is faced with a dilemma as to how he is to carry

through his intended plan (occupying e5) in its full entirety'.

8 a3

Usually played, as ... ♘b4 might soon be troublesome. Others:

a) **8 ♘bd2** ♕e7 (now ... e5 is in the air) 9 ♘e5 cd 10 ed ♗a3 11 ♗xa3 ♕xa3 ∓ Bogoljubow-Capablanca, New York 1924. However, 9 c4 is some improvement for White (Spielmann-Stoltz, 5th match game 1933).

b) **8 ♘e5** (Maroczy-Bogoljubow, New York 1924) can be met by 8 ... ♕e7 9 f4 cd '... after which the exchange of the adverse bishop is forced' – Alekhine. This is not strictly true as White can play 10 ed ♘b4 11 ♗e2 ♘e4 12 a3 ♘c6 13 ♘d2. In view of this, there seems no reason to criticise the plan adopted by Bogoljubow in the game: 8 ... ♘e7!? 9 ♘d2 b6 10 f4 ♗b7 11 ♕f3 ♖c8 12 ♘g4 (12 g4 c4! 13 bc dc 14 ♕xb7 cd 15 cd ♘ed5 ∓) 12 ... ♘xg4 13 ♕xg4 when 13 ... f5 (Alekhine) would have been simplest, and would give a roughly even position.

Black could also consider meeting 8 ♘e5 by 8 ... ♗d7!? (ECO) or 8 ... ♕c7 9 f4 cd 10 ed ♘b4 11 ♘c3 ♘xd3 12 ♕xd3 ♗d7 = Rabinovich-Bogoljubow, Moscow 1924.

8 ... b6

a) **8** ... cd is still wrong. Alekhine-Rosselli, Zurich 1934, continued 9 ed b6 10 ♘bd2 ♗b7 11 ♕e2 ♕c7 12 ♘e5 ♘e7 13 f4 ♖ac8 14 ♖ac1 g6 15 g4 h5 16 h3 ♔g7 17 c4 ♕d8 18 c5! and not now 18 ... bc 19 bc ♗xc5+ because of 20 ♖xc5! and 21 g5 ±.

b) **8** ... ♕c7 9 c4 and if 9 ... e5?! 10 cd ♘xd5 11 dc ♗xc5 12 ♘bd2 ±.

c) **8** ... ♕e7 9 ♘e5 (otherwise ... e5) 9 ... ♖d8 (9 ... ♗xe5?! 9 de ♘d7 10 f4) 10 ♘d2 ♘d7 11 f4 (11 ♘xd7!? followed by c4) 11 ... ♘f8 = – Bogoljubow. Black's vital h-pawn is protected, and he can continue with ... f6 and possibly ... ♗c8-d7-e8.

9 ♘e5

a) **9** ♘bd2 ♗b7 10 ♘e5 probably transposes.

b) A curiosity is the 3rd Potter-Zukertort match game 1875: **9** ♘c3 (by transposition) 9 ... ♗b7 10 ♕e2 ♖c8 11 ♖fd1 cd (a move which met with the approval of Steinitz) 12 ed ♖e8 13 ♘b1 (admission of error) 13 ... ♕c7 14 ♖e1 ♘e4 15 ♘bd2 (15 ♗xe4? de 16 ♕xe4 ♘e5) 15 ... f5!?, but Steinitz preferred 15 ... ♘xd2 followed by ... f6. This shows that some of the QPO ideas were current in London at least, prior to the 1883 tournament.

9 ... ♗b7
10 ♘d2 ♕e7

Or 10 ... a6 11 f4 b5 12 dc ♗xc5 13 ♕f3 ♖c8 14 ♕g3 ♘xe5 15 ♗xe5 ♗d6 16 ♗d4 ♕e7 17 f4 g6 18 ♕g5 (Dus-Hotimirski v. Nimzowitsch Carlsbad 1907) 18 ... ♘d7 19 ♕xe7 ♗xe7 20 e4 ♘f6 = – Nimzowitsch.

11 f4 ♖fd8

11 ... ♘d7? 12 ♘xd7 ♕xd7 13 dc ♗xc5 14 ♗xh7+! ♔xh7 15 ♕h5+ ♔h8 16 ♗xg7!

12 ♖f3 ♘e4!
13 ♖h3

13 ♘xe4 de 14 ♗xe4 ♗xe5!

13 ... f5

The game we follow is Euwe-Rubinstein, Mährisch-Ostrau 1923:

14 ♗xe4 de

15 ♕h5 ♗xe5

Koltanowski prefers 15 ... h6, but Euwe then intended 16 ♘xc6 ♗xc6 17 ♘c4 and 18 ♖g3 with a strong attack.

16 ♕xh7+ ♔f7

17 fe ♖h8

17 ... ♘xe5 can be met by 18 ♕h5+ or 18 ♖g3.

18 ♕xh8 ♖xh8

19 ♖xh8 ♗a6!

20 ♘f1 ♕d7?

20 ... ♗xf1 21 ♖xf1 ♕g5 might save Black, as White cannot link his rooks – Euwe.

21 ♖d1 ♘xe5

21 ... ♗xf1 22 ♔xf1 cd would have given plenty of counterplay – Koltanowski.

22 d5! ♘g4

23 de+ ♕xe6 24 ♖hd8 ♗b5 25 c4 ♗e8 26 ♖1d5 f4 27 h3 fe 28 ♘g3 e2 (better 28 ... ♘f6 – Euwe) 29 ♘xe2 ♘e3 30 ♖g5 g6 31 ♘f4 ♕e7 32 ♖xg6 ♘f5 33 ♖f6+ ♔g8 34 ♖xe8+ ♕xe8 35 ♖xf5 e3 36 ♖g5+ ♔h7 37 ♖h5+ 1-0.

B

Lines without ... e6

1 d4 ♘f6

2 ♘f3 d5

3 e3

B1 3 ... g6

B2 3 ... c5

Other lines without ... e6 are:

a) 3 ... ♘bd7 4 ♘bd2 (4 c3; 4 ♗d3) 4 ... c5 transposing to B2, unless White tries Koltanowski's suggestion 5 ♗b5!?

b) 3 ... c6 4 ♗d3 g6 5 ♘bd2 ♗g7 6 0-0 (6 c3 ♘bd7 7 e4 de gives White nothing; Schneider-Benites, Moscow 1956) 6 ... 0-0 7 e4 de 8 ♘xe4 ♘xe4 9 ♗xe4 ♗g4 10 c3 ♘d7 11 h3 ♗e6 12 ♖e1 ♖e8 13 ♗f4 ♕a5 14 ♕e2 ♕h5 15 ♗c2 ♗d5 16 ♗e4 ♗xe4 17 ♕xe4 ♕d5 18 ♕xd5 cd ½:½ Aronson-Stolyar, 24th USSR Ch 1957. Hardly the last word!

B1

3 ... g6

The Colle formation is not very good for White against this King's Indian set-up. This is a good reason why White should not go 3 e3 unless Black has played ... e6.

4 ♗d3 ♗g7

5 ♘bd2

5 0-0 should transpose.

5 ... ♘bd7

The most flexible reply, though 5 ... 0-0 (6 b3 ♗f5! = MCO) or 5 ... c5 6 c3 will generally transpose to lines below. Exceptionally, the game Solmanis-Holmov, ½-final 17th USSR Ch 1949, went 5 ... 0-0 6 c3 c5 7 0-0 b6 8 e4 cd 9 e5 ♘h5 10 cd ♘f4 11 ♗b1 ♕d7 12 g3 ♘h3+ 13 ♔g2 ♕g4 14 ♘b3 f6 and White was under pressure.

6 0-0

6 b3 has also been played. Then:

a) **6 ... e5!?** 7 ♘xe5 ♘xe5 8 de ♘g4 9 f4! ♕h4+ (9 ... ♘xe3 10 ♕f3) 10 g3 ♕h3 11 ♗f1! ♕h5 12 ♕f3!? (12 ♘f3 is more solid) 12 ... ♗xe5 13 fe ♕xe5 14 ♖b1 ♘xe3 15 ♗b2! (15 ♗e2 ♘xc2+ leads to a draw.) 15 ... d4 (The White king can now escape to c1 against 15 ... ♘xc2+.) 16 ♕e4 ♘xc2+ 17 ♔f2 ♕xe4 18 ♘xe4 ♗f5 (18 ... f5!? followed by ... c5 was the last chance.) 19 ♗d3 ♘b4 20 ♘f6+ and wins; Sultan Khan-Alexander, British Ch 1931.

b) **6 ... c5** 7 ♗b2 0-0 8 h3? (correct is 8 0-0 e5 9 de ♘g4 10 e4 = Neikirkh and Tsvetkov) 8 ... cd 9 ed ♘h5 10 g3 ♕c7 11 ♕e2 ♘c5! 12 ♘e5 ♘xd3+ 13 ♕xd3 ♗f5 14 ♖c1 ♖ac8 15 ♕e3 ♕d6 16 c3 ♖fe8 17 f4 g5! 18 0-0 gf 19 ♘xf4 ♗h6 20 ♕f3 ♘xf4 21 gf ♔h8 22 ♖f2 ♖g8+ 23 ♔h2 ♖g6 ∓ Rellstab-Petrov, Kemeri 1937.

6 ... c5

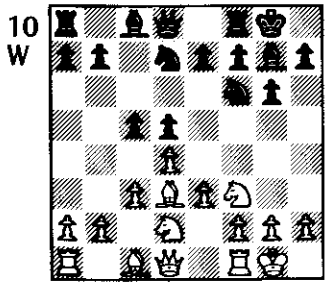
Or 6 ... 0-0! when:

a) **7 b3** e5!? 8 de (8 ♘xe5!?) 8 ... ♘g4 9 ♖b1 ♘dxe5 = Dus-Hotmirsky v. Aratovsky, ½-final 17th USSR Ch 1949.

b) **7 c3** e5 8 de ♘g4 9 ♕c2 ♘xe5 ∓ Stahlberg-Böök, Stockholm 1952.

c) **7 c4!?** could be considered.

7 c3 0-0 *(10)*



This position is a reversed Catalan in which White has an extra move and has his bishop posted on d3 instead of e2. Therefore he has little to fear, and may proceed:

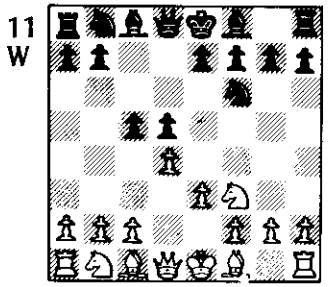
a) **8 ♕e2** ♖e8? (Koltanowski's 8 ... ♕c7 is critical.) 9 ♘e5 (or 9 e4 Colle-Fairhurst, Scarborough 1927) 9 ... ♘xe5 10 de ♘d7 11 f4 ♕b6 12 ♕f3 e6 13 c4! ± Seitz-O'Hanlon, Nice 1930.

b) **8 b4!?** (or 8 b3) is more in the anti-Catalan spirit, e.g. 8 ... cb (8 ... b6!) 9 cb (Black's ♗g7 stands poorly now.) 9 ... ♘e8 10 ♗b2 ♘d6 11 ♕b3 ♘b6 12 a4 ♗f5 13 ♗xf5 gf 14 b5 ♘bc4 = Prins-Landau, Zandvoort 1936.

c) **8 e4** de (8 ... cd 9 e5 ±) 9 ♘xe4 ♘xe4 10 ♗xe4 cd 11 ♘xd4 ♘c5 12 ♗c2 ♕c7 = Nestler-Pachman, Venice 1950.

B2

3 ... c5 *(11)*



4 c3

White can also play:

a) **4 dc**, which is a Queen's Gambit Accepted with reversed colours and an extra tempo; because of this 3 ... c5 is slightly suspect. Guimard-Shainswit, New York 1951, continued 4 ... ♕a5+ 5 ♘bd2 (5 ♗d2!? ♕xc5 6 ♘a3 – Dr.Dunhaupt,

MCO) 5 ... ♕xc5 6 a3 g6 7 c4 ♗g7 8 b4 ♕c7 9 ♗b2 0-0 10 ♖c1 ± (but ½:½, 35)

b) **4 b3** when:

b1) **4 ... ♘c6** 5 ♗b2 ♗g4 6 ♗e2 e6 7 0-0 cd 8 ed ♗d6 (8 ... ♖c8!? Halprin-Pillsbury, Vienna 1898) **9** ♘e5 ♗f5 10 ♗d3 ♗g6 11 ♔h1 ♕c7 12 f4 ♘e4 13 ♘d2 ± Dus-Hotimirski v. Spielmann, Carlsbad 1907.

b2) 4 ... cd 5 ed ♘c6 6 ♗b2 ♗g4 7 ♘bd2 e6 8 ♗d3 (8 ♗e2! - Keres) 8 ... ♗d6 9 h3 ♗h5 10 0-0 0-0 11 ♖e1? (11 a3) 11 ... ♘b4! ∓ Gasic-Keres, Sarajevo 1972.

	4 ...	**♘bd7**
	5 ♘bd2	

5 ♗d3 is playable too, but after 5 ... e6 White must return to normal lines (chapter 3) because there is nothing in 6 ♕a4?! ♗e7 7 ♘bd2 0-0 8 0-0 ♕c7 9 e4 cd 10 cd de 11 ♘xe4 ♘xe4 12 ♗xe4 ♘f6 13 ♗d3 ♗d7 ∓ Nestler-Szabados, Venice 1950.

	5 ...	**♕c7**

Only this gives the variation an independent character. 5 ... g6 see B1; 5 ... e6 see chapter 3.

	6 ♗d3	

If **6 ♕a4** e6 7 ♗d3 Black can play 7 ... ♗e7 (note to White's 5th) or:

a) **7 ... ♗d6** 8 dc ♗xc5 9 0-0 0-0 10 ♕h4 ♗e7 Colle-Spielmann, Bled 1931.

b) **7 ... c4** 8 ♗b1 a6 9 e4 de 10 ♘xe4 b5 11 ♕d1 ♗b7 – Neikirkh and Tsvetkov.

Also **6 ... g6**!? is playable, though after 7 c4! Colle-Rubinstein, Rotterdam 1931, continued 7 ... ♗g7? (7 ... cd first) 8 cd ♘xd5 9 e4! ♘5b6 10 ♕c2! ♕d6 11 a4! ±.

	6 ...	**e5**
	7 e4	

7 *de is innocuous.* Makagonov-Fridstein, ½-final 15th USSR Ch 1947, went 7 ... ♘xe5 8 ♘xe5 ♕xe5 9 ♘f3 ♕c7 10 b3 ♗e7 11 c4 dc 12 bc 0-0 13 0-0 ♗g4 14 ♗b2 ♖ad8 15 ♕c2 =.

	7 ...	**♘xe4**
	8 ♘xe4	**de**
	9 ♗xe4	**♘f6**

Koltanowski-Sebestany, Barcelona 1934, went instead 9 ... cd 10 cd ♗b4+ 11 ♗d2 ♗xd2+ 12 ♕xd2 0-0 13 ♖c1 and now only 13 ... ♕b8 would avoid the loss of material.

	10 ♗c2	

And now:

a) **10 ... ♗d6** 11 de ♗xe5 12 ♕e2 0-0 13 ♘xe5 ♖e8 14 f4 ± – Tartakower.

b) **10 ... ed** 11 0-0 ♗e7 would be more prudent – Tartakower.

c) Colle-Stoltz, Bled 1931, went **10 ... cd**!? 11 0-0 (11 cd? ♗b4+ 12 ♗d2 ♗xd2+ 13 ♕xd2 ed =) 11 ... dc? (11 ... ♗d6 avoids the worst.) 12 ♘xe5! ♗d6 13 ♗a4+ ♔f8 14 ♗f4 ♗g4 (14 ... ♔g8 is slightly better) 15 ♘g6+! ♔g8 16 ♗xd6 ♗xd1 17 ♗xc7 ♗xa4 18 ♘xh8 ♘d5 (18 ... ♔xh8 19 b3) 19 ♗a5 c2 20 ♗d2 ♔xh8 21 ♖he1 ♔g8 22 ♖ac1 ♖c8 23 ♖e4 ♗d7 24 ♖d4 ♗e6 25 b3 b5 26 ♗a5 g5 27 ♖d2 ♖c6 28 ♖cxc2 ♖a6 29 b4 ♖d6 30 a3 h6 31 ♖c5 a6 32 ♗c7 ♖d7 33 ♗e5 ♔h7 34 h3 h5 35 ♗b2 ♔g6 36 ♖c6 1-0.

C

	Black avoids ... c5	
1	**d4**	**♘f6**
2	**♘f3**	**e6**
3	**e3**	**d5**
4	**♗d3**	

There is no clear pattern to the lines where Black avoids ... c5.

C1 4 ... b6

C2 4 ... ♗e7

C3 4 ... ♗d6

C1

	4 ...	**b6**

Not as good as the lines in chapter 4, because the pawn at d5 is in the way of the bishop.

	5 ♘bd2	

Or 5 0-0 ♗b7 6 b3 ♘bd7 7 ♗b2 (compare A):

a) **7 ... ♗d6** 8 c4 0-0 transposes to the Keres line against the Queen's Indian Defence, which is one of the best ways of handling that defence, e.g. Keres-Taimanov, Tallinn 1975.

b) **7 ... ♗e7** 8 ♘bd2 0-0 9 ♕e2 (here or last move c2-c4 is still good.) 9 ... ♘e4 10 ♖ad1 f5 11 ♘e5 (11 c4!?) 11 ... ♘xe5 12 de ♘xd2 13 ♖xd2 ♕e8 with complex play ahead on both wings; Gibson-Sultan Khan, British Ch 1931.

	5 ...	**♗b7**

If 5 ... ♗a6?! 6 c4! ♗d6 (6 ... dc 7 ♘xc4) 7 0-0 0-0 8 b3 c6 9 ♕e2 ♖e8 10 ♗b2 ♘bd7 11 ♘e5 ♖c8 12 f4 Koltanowski-Sunver, Sitges 1934; Black's ♗a6 is not well placed.

	6 ♕e2	

Alternatively:

a) **6 0-0** and if 6 ... ♗e7 7 b3 0-0 8 ♗b2 followed by c4 is the Queen's Indian again.

b) **6 ♘e5!?** ♗d6 (6 ... a6 7 f4 c5 8 c3 ♘c6 9 ♕f3 ± Colle-Sultan Khan, Hastings 1930-31) 7 f4 ♘e4 (7 ... 0-0 8 ♕f3!? – ECO; compare chapter 8 again.) 8 ♕f3 ♘xd2 (8 ... f5? 9 ♕h5+) 9 ♗xd2 ♕h4+ 10 g3 ♕h3 11 ♗f1 ♕f5 12 ♗d3 ½:½ Koltanowski-Spielmann, Sitges 1934. Koltanowski said that 10 ♕f2 might be playable, heading for the endgame.

	6 ...	**♗e7**
	7 e4	**de**
	8 ♘xe4	**♘bd7**
	9 0-0	**0-0 ±**

And here White has:

a) **10 ♖d1** ♘xe4 11 ♗xe4 ♗xe4 12 ♕xe4 ♘f6 13 ♕c6 ± Pirc-Stahlberg, Moscow 1935.

b) **10 ♖e1** and now:

b1) **10 ... ♖e8** (Franklin-Najdorf, Hastings 1971-72) 11 ♘eg5 ♗xf3 (or 11 ... ♗d6 12 ♘e5 ±) 12 ♕xf3 ± – Franklin, ECO.

b2) **10 ... ♘xe4** 11 ♗xe4 ♗xe4 12 ♕xe4 ♘f6 13 ♕b7 ♕c8 14 ♕c6 ± Franklin-Markland, Hastings 1971-72.

C2

	4 ...	**♗e7**
	5 ♘bd2	**0-0**

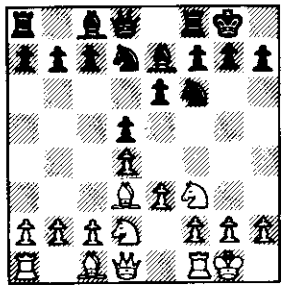
Or 5 ... ♘bd7 6 0-0 b6?! (7 c3 or 7 b3 would be normal.) 7 ... ♘xe5 8 de ♘d7 9 f4 ♘c5! 10 ♗b5+ ♗d7 11 ♗e2 a6 12 c4 dc 13 ♗xc4 g6 14 ♕c2! ± Flohr-Noteboom, Hamburg 1930.

	6 0-0	

Riumin-Budo, 7th USSR Ch 1931, went 6 ♕e2 ♘bd7 7 e4 de 8 ♘xe4

♘xe4?! (8 ... b6!? intending ... ♗b7 ±) 9 ♕xe4 ♘f6 10 ♕h4 c5 11 dc ♗xc5 12 0-0 ± with the initiative.

6 ... ♘bd7 *(12)*



7 e4

Or 7 ♕e2 b6 8 e4 de 9 ♘xe4 ♗b7 10 ♘xf6 ♘xf6 11 ♖d1 (to protect d4 indirectly) 11 ... ♕d5!? 12 ♗g5! h6 13 c4 ♕a5 14 ♗f4 Koltanowski-Cherta, Spain 1935.

7 ... de
8 ♘xe4 ♘xe4

9 ♗xe4 ♘f6 10 ♗d3 c5 (Now we see why Black should have played this earlier! If 10 ... b6 ECO gives 11 ♕e2 ♗b7 12 ♖d1 ±.) 11 dc! (obtaining a ♕-side majority) 11 ... ♗xc5 12 ♗g5 ♗e7 13 ♕e2 ♕c7 (13 ... b6? 14 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 15 ♕e4) 14 ♖ad1 ♖d8 15 ♘e5 ♗d7 (better 15 ... h6) 16 ♗xh7+! ♔xh7 17 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 (17 ... ♗e8 holds out longer.) 18 ♕h5+ ♔g8 19 ♕xf7+ 1-0 Colle-Buerger, Hastings 1928.

C3

4 ... ♗d6
5 ♘bd2 ♘bd7

Alternatively:

a) 5 ... b6 6 e4 ± Koltanowski-Ryden, 1957 (blindfold simul).

b) 5 ... c6 6 0-0 ♘bd7 7 ♖e1 0-0 8 e4 de 9 ♘xe4 ♘xe4 10 ♗xe4 ♕c7 11 c3 (Koltanowski-Silverman, Birmingham 1937) 11 ... ♘f6 or 11 ... b6 – Koltanowski.

6 0-0

Or 6 e4 de 7 ♘xe4 b6 (7 ... ♘xe4 8 ♗xe4 0-0 9 0-0 see note b) to Black's 6th) 8 ♘xd6+!? (instead of 8 0-0 ♗b7 = Blackburne-Lasker, London 1879) 8 ... cd 9 ♗f4 ± ECO.

6 ... e5?!

After 6 ... 0-0 7 e4 Koltanowski analysed:

a) 7 ... e5?! 8 ed ed 9 ♘e4 ♘e5 10 ♗g5 ♗g4 11 ♗xf6 ♗xf3 (11 ... gf 12 ♗e2) 12 ♗xd8 ♗xd1 13 ♘xd6 ♘xd3 14 ♖fxd1 ♖fxd8 15 ♖xd3 ♖xd6 16 ♖xd4 and Black cannot copy any longer.

b) 7 ... de 8 ♘xe4 ♘xe4 9 ♗xe4 f5 (9 ... e5 10 de ♘xe5 11 ♘xe5 ♗xe5 12 ♗xh7+! ♔xh7 13 ♕h5+) 10 ♗d3 e5 **11 ♗c4+** ♔h8 12 ♘g5 ♕e8 13 de ♘xe5 (13 ... ♕xe5 14 ♕h5 ♘f6 15 ♕h4 ♕e7 16 ♗d2 h6 17 ♖ae1 ♘e4 18 ♕h5) 14 ♖e1 ± e.g. 14 ... h6 (14 ... ♕g6 15 ♖xe5; 14 ... f4 15 ♕d4) 15 ♗f4 hg 16 ♗xe5 ♗xe5 17 ♖xe5 ♕g6 18 ♕d5 c6 19 ♕d4 with pressure on the open central files. Also good is **11 ♗g5** ± Alekhine-Köhnlein, Dusseldorf 1908.

7 e4! de

7 ... ed 8 e5 forking two pieces.

8 ♘xe4 ♘xe4
9 ♗xe4

Black has a difficult game already, because castling loses a pawn to the typical Colle trap 9 ... 0-0?! 10 de ♘xe5 11 ♘xe5 ♗xe5 12 ♗xh7+ Koltanowski-Golmayo, Sitges 1934.

Summary

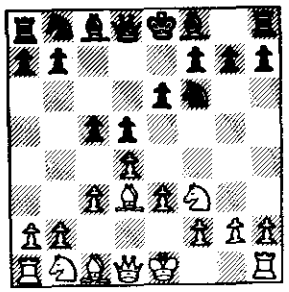
The Colle-Zukertort variation (A) leads to interesting and complex middle games, offering objectively level chances. The King's Indian set-up against the Colle is probably good, but Black should aim for ... e5 rather than the reversed Catalan. The ... c5, ... ♕c7 and ... e5 plan is somewhat in White's favour – but ♕a4 (to prevent ... e5) is inadvisable. Finally the lines in C by and large show the inadvisability of Black's omitting ... c5 if he intends to develop his bishop on e7 or d6. In the next two chapters we proceed to those lines of the Colle that were the most popular in its heyday (late twenties and thirties).

3 Main Line Colle (with ...d5)

1	d4	♘f6
2	♘f3	e6
3	e3	d5
4	♗d3	c5
5	c3*(13)*	

Of the several move-orders that lead to the diagram position, the above is probably the most precise from both players' points of view. Early deviations were dealt with in chapter 2, and lines without ... d5 are in the next chapter.

13 B



The variations which follow are distinguished by Black's development of the queen's knight (to c6 or d7) and the king's bishop (to d6 or e7). Although some transpositions are possible, we shall look at the variations in the following sequence:

A 5 ... ♘c6 –
A1 with ... ♗d6
A2 with ... ♗e7
B 5 ... ♘bd7 –
B1 with ... ♗d6
B2 with ... ♗e7

Odd-fits in brief:

a) 5 ... **♗d7** 6 ♘bd2 ♗c6 7 dc ♗xc5 8 b4 ♗d6 9 b5 ♗d7 10 0-0 a6 11 c4 0-0 12 ♗b2 ± Schlechter-Napier, Monte Carlo 1903.

b) 5 ... **♗e7** 6 ♘e5 0-0 7 0-0 b6 8 ♕e2 ♗b7 9 ♘d2 ♘bd7 10 f4 ± Karaklajic-Andric, Belgrade 1961.

c) 5 ... **b6!?** when:

c1) **6 ♘bd2** ♗b7 7 ♘e5 ♘bd7 8 f4 ♗d6 9 ♕f3! 0-0 10 0-0 ♖c8 11 g4 ♖c7! 12 g5 ♗xe5 13 fe (13 de ♘e8! 14 ♗xh7+ would give no advantage.) 13 ... ♘e4! 14 h4? (14 ♘xe4 de 15 ♗c4 ±) 14 ... f5 15 ef gf 16 g6 f5 17 ♗xe4 de 18 ♕g3 ♖f6 19 h5 hg 20 ♖f2 ♘f8 21 ♘c4 cd 22 ♘e5 dc 23 bc (23 ♘g4 ♖d7 24 ♘xf6+ ♕xf6 ∓) 23 ... ♖h7 24 ♗a3 ♖xh5 25 ♖f1 f4! ∓∓ 26 ♘g4 fg 27 ♘xf6+ ♔h8 28 ♘xh5 ♘d7 29 ♘xg3 ♕g5 30 ♔g2 ♕xe3 was the continuation in Colle v. Znosko-Borowski, Nice 1930 (0-1, 40).

c2) **6 0-0** ♗b7 7 ♘e5 ♗d6 8 f4 ♕c7 9 ♗d2 ♘c6 10 ♗e1 a6 11 ♘d2 ± Damjanovic-Korchnoi, Palma de Mallorca 1969.

A1

5	...	♘c6
6	♘bd2	♗d6

Alternatively:

a) In Gottilf-Romanovsky, Tourney of Leningrad Masters 1930, Black tried 6 ... ♕b6 7 0-0 ♗d7. If his intention was to castle ♕-side, he soon thought better of it: 8 dc ♗xc5 9 e4 ♖d8 10 ed ed 11 ♘b3 ♗e7 12 h3 0-0 13 ♗e3 ♕c7 (completing the ignominious retreat) 14 ♘bd4 and the position is a Tarrasch French in which Black's pieces are too passively placed to compensate for the isolation of his d-pawn (1-0, 42).

b) **6 ... a6** 7 0-0 ♕c7 8 ♕e2 ♗e7 9 dc ♗xc5 10 e4 ± Przepiorka-Gilfer, Hamburg 1930.

c) **6 ... cd** 7 ed ♗d6 8 0-0 0-0 9 ♖e1 ♕c7 (9 ... ♖e8 10 ♘e5) note b1) to Black's 7th.

With ... ♗d6 Black adopts his most classical minor piece set-up. The position is in effect a reversed Queen's Gambit, Semi-Slav (Chigorin's Half-Meran) in which the extra tempo means a lot to White: he will be the first to advance his e-pawn.

7 **0-0**

7 e4 is premature because after 7 ... cd 8 cd de 9 ♘xe4 ♘xe4 10 ♗xe4 ♗b4+ the position becomes too simplified and White has an isolated d-pawn.

7 ♕e2 0-0 8 dc!? (8 0-0 below) 8 ... ♗xc5 9 e4 is an attempt to get on with the centre push: if **9 ...** ♕c7 either 10 0-0 (transposing) or 10 e5!?. Koltanowski-Domenech, Sitges 1934, went instead **9 ... de** 10 ♘xe4 ♘xe4 11 ♗xe4 ♗d7 (11 ... ♕c7!?) 12 0-0 ♖c8 13 ♗f4 ±.

If 7 dc ♗xc5 8 b4?! (8 0-0 0-0 below) 8 ... ♗d6 9 b5 ♘e7 (9 ... ♘e5! ∓ ECO) 10 0-0 0-0 11 ♕b3 e5 12 e4 ♖e8 (Rozic-Krestini, Yugoslavia 1932) is unclear.

7 ... *0-0(14)*

Black can transpose by 7 ... ♕c7 8 dc ♗xc5 9 e4 0-0, but should avoid:

a) 7 ... e5?! was played in the stem-game Charousek-Suchting, Berlin 1897 (see p. 7); only thirty years later was the variation rediscovered and popularised by Colle!

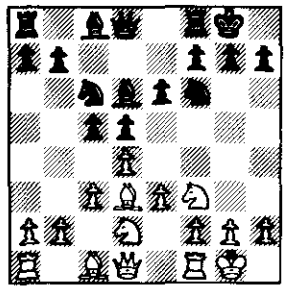
Charousek-Suchting continued **8** dc ♗xc5 9 e4 d4?! 10 ♘b3 ♗b6 11 cd ed 12 e5! ♘d7 13 ♗g5 ♕c7 14 ♖c1 ±, but possibly **9 ... de** 10 ♘xe4 ♘xe4 11 ♗xe4 ♕xd1 12 ♖xd1 ♗g4 (12 ... f6 13 b4 ♗b6 14 a4 ±) 13 h3 ♗xf3 14 ♗xf3 would have restricted White to a minimal endgame advantage. Neikirkh and Tsvetkov, the Bulgarian analysts, suggest that White would do better with **8 de** ♘xe5 9 ♘xe5 ♗xe5 10 f4 ♗c7 11 e4 de 12 ♘xe4 ♘xe4 13 ♗xe4 ♕xd1 14 ♖xd1 e.g. 14 ... ♖b8 15 ♗e3 b6 16 ♗c6+ ♔e7 17 ♖e1 ±. Another idea is **8 e4** 'and White will use the e-file first' – Koltanowski.

b) **7 ... cd** 8 ed produces an Exchange Variation of the Caro-

Kann with Black's queen's bishop locked inside his pawn structure. Two examples after 8 ... ♕c7 9 ♖e1:

b1) 9 ... 0-0 10 ♕e2 ♖e8 11 ♘e5 ♖e7 12 ♘df3 ♘fd7 13 ♘g5! ♘f8 14 ♘xh7! ± Colle-Soultanbeieff, Liege 1930.

b2) 9 ... ♗d7 10 ♕e2 0-0-0 11 ♘e5 ♗e8 12 ♘df3 ♘d7 13 ♗d2 ♘f8 14 c4 f6 15 cd ed 16 ♘xc6 bc 17 b4 followed by ♖fc1, ♖ab1, a4 and b5, opening up Black's ♕-side – Koltanowski.



A11 8 dc

A12 8 ♕e2!?

Other tries:

a) 8 b3 (inconsistent) 8 ... e5! Wahltuch-Atkins, London 1922.

b) 8 h3 ♕e7 (8 ... e5!?; 8 ... b6 Vidmar-Bogoljubow, London 1922) 9 ♕e2 e5 10 dc ♗xc5 11 e4 ♗e6! (11 ... ♘h5 12 ed! ♘g3 13 ♕e1 ♘xf1 14 ♘xf1 ♘d8 15 ♕xe5) 12 ed ♗xd5 = Vidmar-Reti, London 1922.

c) 8 e4 and now:

c1) 8 ... de 9 ♘xe4 cd 10 ♘xf6+ gf (10 ... ♕xf6?? 11 ♗g5) 11 ♗h6 with attacking chances; Romanovsky-Rotlevi, St Petersburg 1909.

c2) 8 ... cd! when:

c21) if 9 ♘xd4 ♘xd4 10 cd de 11 ♘xe4 ♘xe4 12 ♗xe4 ♗xh2+! the laugh is on White for a change.

c22) 9 cd de 10 ♘xe4 ♗e7! is assessed as ∓ by Pachman because of the isolated d-pawn (11 ♘eg5 h6!). Or possibly 10 ... ♘xe4 11 ♗xe4 ♗d7 12 ♖e1 h6 13 ♗b1 ♕c7 14 ♕d3 f5 15 ♗d2 with complications; Lukic-Djantar, Yugoslav Ch 1959.

A11

8 dc

This is designed to avoid the isolated d-pawn and to decoy the black king's bishop away from ♔-side defence. The move was played by Capablanca in a simultaneous display in 1914, but the credit for its development rightly goes to Colle who rediscovered it.

8 ... ♗xc5

9 e4

Thus White achieves his first objective.

An experimental idea was 9 b4!? ♗d6 10 a3 e5 11 e4 ♗g4 12 ed ♘xd5 13 ♘e4 ♗e7 with an unclear position; Colle-Euwe, match 1924.

9 ... ♕c7

To prevent e4-e5. Others:

a) 9 ... d4? 10 ♘b3 ± Koltanowski-Domenech, Barcelona 1934.

b) 9 ... ♕b6!? might be met by 10 e5, angling for a sacrifice on h7 – Neikirkh and Tsvetkov.

c) 9 ... e5 and now:

c1) 10 ♕e2 ♖e8 (Kostic-Marshall, Stockholm 1937) 11 h3!? ± – Neikirkh and Tsvetkov.

c2) 10 ed when:

c21) 10 ... ♕xd5?! 11 ♕e2 ♗g4 (11 ... ♗b6 12 ♘e4 or 11 ... ♖e8 12 ♗c4 ♕d7 13 ♘g5 ♖f8 14 ♘de4 ± Colle-Rubinstein, Budapest 1926) 12 ♘e4 ♖fd8 13 ♘xf6+ gf 14 ♗e4 ± Colle-Sir George Thomas, Nice 1930.

c22) 10 ... ♘xd5 11 ♘e4 ♗e7 12 ♘g3 f5 13 ♗c4 ♗e6 14 ♖e1 e4 15 ♗g5 ♔h8 16 ♗xe7 ♘cxe7 17 ♘d4 ± Colle-Euwe, 1st match game 1928.

d) 9 ... de (or 9 ... ♘xe4) 10 ♘xe4 when:

d1) 10 ... ♗e7 11 ♕e2 ♕c7 12 ♘xf6+ ♗xf6 13 ♗g5 ♕e7 14 ♕e4 g6 (Colle-Maroczy, San Remo 1930) 15 h4! e5 16 ♕e3 ± Toth and Halupetsky.

d2) 10 ... ♘xe4 11 ♗xe4 and now:

d21) 11 ... ♕xd1 12 ♖xd1 with a ♕-side majority and a slight lead in time. Colle-Rubinstein, Berlin 1926, continued 12 ... f6 13 b4 ♗e7 14 a3 a5 15 b5 ±.

d22) 11 ... ♗e7 12 ♕xd8 ♖xd8 13 ♗f4 likewise favoured White in Rudenko-Zubarev, All-Union tourney of Spartak clubs 1939.

d23) 11 ... ♕c7 12 ♘g5 h6 13 ♗h7+ ♔f8 14 ♗c2 e5 15 ♕h5 ± (threats are ♘e4 and ♗xh6) Gilg-Holzhausen, Breslau 1925.

e) 9 ... ♗e7 and 9 ... ♗b6 have been played, but the loss of tempo helps White.

10 ♕e2*(15)*

This renews the e5 threat. Probably 10 ed is too quiet, e.g. 10 ... ♘xd5 11 ♘e4 ♗e7 = as recommended by Euwe and Pachman.

However Colle's opponents used to reply 10 ... ed!? reaching positions akin to the Tarrasch French which are well-known nowadays (e.g. the 1974 Karpov-Korchnoi match). Compared with the line 1 e4 e6 2 d4 d5 3 ♘d2 c5 4 ed ed 5 ♘gf3 ♘c6 6 ♗b5 ♗d6 7 dc ♗xc5 8 0-0 ♘ge7 9 ♘b3 Black here has his knight on f6 which gives him chances based on ... ♘e4 or ... ♘g4. Still, the following examples should be reviewed in the light of modern ideas in the French:

10 ... ed 11 ♘b3 (11 h3? ♗xh3! ∓∓ Scafarelli-Lundin, Helsinki 1952) and now:

a) 11 ... ♗d6 12 h3 ♖e8 13 ♘bd4 ♘xd4 14 ♘xd4 ♗d7 15 ♕f3 ± a6 16 ♘f5 ♗e5 17 ♗e3 ♘e4 18 ♖ad1 ♖e6 19 ♗c2 ♗c6 20 ♗d4 ♖f6 21 ♕h5 ♗xd4 22 ♘xd4 ♖h6 23 ♕e2 ♖e8 24 ♖fe1 ♗d7 25 ♖d3 ♖f8 26 ♖e3 ♘f6 27 ♗f5 (1-0, 42) Colle-Yates, Budapest 1926.

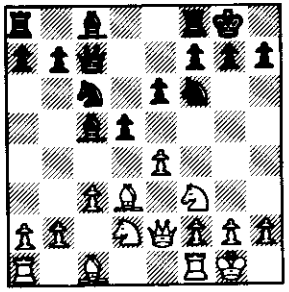
b) 11 ... ♗b6 12 ♕c2 ♖e8 13 ♗g5 ♘e4 14 ♖ae1 ♗f5 = (Black has an easy development.) 15 ♗e3 ♗g6 16 ♘h4 (16 ♗xb6!?; 16 ♘bd4!?) 16 ... ♘xf2!? 17 ♗xf2 (17 ♔xf2 ♖xe3 18 ♖xe3 ♕f4+) 17 ... ♗xf2+ 18 ♔xf2 ♕b6+ 19 ♔g3 ♖e3+ 20 ♖xe3 ♕xe3+ 21 ♖f3 ♕g5+ 22 ♔h3 ♘e5 23 ♖g3 ♕h6 Colle-Kashdan, Bled 1931. Now White should have played 24 ♗xg6 ♘xg6 25 ♖xg6 hg 26 ♔g3 and Black probably has nothing better than 26 ... ♕g5+ 27 ♔h3 ♕h6 repeating positions - Koltanowski.

10 ... ♗d6

Others:

a) 10 ... ♘g4 is a major alternative:

15
B



a1) 11 h3 ♘ge5 and now:
a11) 12 ♗xe5 ♘xe5 13 ♗c2? (13 ed ed 14 ♘f3 = – Sokolsky; 14 ... ♘g6! – Koltanowski) 13 ... d4! 14 cd ♗xd4 15 ♗b3 b6 16 ♘f3 ♗a6! 17 ♕xa6 ♘xf3+ 18 gf ♕g3+ 19 ♔h1 ♕xf3+ 20 ♔g1 ♕g3+ 21 ♔h1 ♕xh3+ 22 ♔g1 ♗e5! 0-1 Yasvoin-Kopayev, Team Ch of VTsPS 1947.
a12) 12 ♗c2 b6 13 ♖e1 (13 ♘b3 ♗a6! 14 ♕xa6 ♘xf3+ 15 gf ♕g3+ – Neikirch and Tsvetkov) 13 ... d4 14 ♘xe5 ♘xe5 15 cd ♗xd4 16 ♘b3 ♗a6! 17 ♕d1 with a double-edged game. Halibeily-Lipnitsky, USSR 1954, continued 17 ... ♗xf2!? 18 ♔xf2 ♖fd8 19 ♗d2 ♘c4 20 e5 ♘xd2 21 ♘xd2 ♕c5+ 22 ♖e3 ♕b4 23 ♗xh7+! with White escaping.
a13) 12 ed ed 13 ♘xe5 ♕xe5!? = – Yudovich.
a2) 11 ed ed 12 ♘b3 ♗b6 13 ♗g5 (recommended by Ravinsky) is correct, bringing about a more favourable form of Tarrasch French than in the note to White's 10th. The black king's knight cannot reach e4 and the white queen's bishop will achieve the standard manoeuvre ♗g5-h4-g3. If 13 ... ♗d7 14 ♗h4 ♖ae8 15 ♕c2 h6 16 ♗g3 and 17 ♖ae1, or if 13 ... ♘ce5 (or 13 ... ♘ge5) then 14 ♗f4! is promising – Harding.
b) 10 ... e5? 11 ed ♘xd5 12 ♗xh7+ ♔xh7 13 ♕e4+ and 14 ♕xd5.
c) 10 ... de 11 ♘xe4 ♗e7 12 ♘fg5 ± – Neikirkh and Tsvetkov.
d) 10 ... ♖e8? 11 e5 and now:
d1) 11 ... ♘d7 12 ♘b3 (12 ♖e1?! f6! 13 ♘g5? ♕xe5! ∓ Winter-Lasker, Nottingham 1936) 12 ... ♗b6 (12 ... ♗f8! which White meets by ♘bd4, ♗f4 or ♗b5) 13 ♗f4 f6 14 ♖ae1 ♘dxe5? (14 ... ♖f8 was essential) 15 ♘xe5 ♘xe5 16 ♗xh7+ ♔f8 (16 ... ♔xh7 17 ♕h5+ and 18 ♕xe8) 17 ♗g6 ♖d8 18 ♕h5 ♔e7 19 ♘d4! ♗d7 20 ♖xe5! fe (20 ... ♖h8 21 ♘f5+) 21 ♗xe5 1-0 Koltanowski-O'Hanlon, Dublin (match) 1937.
d2) 11 ... ♗g4 12 ♘b3 ♗e7 (12 ... ♗b6 13 ♗f4 f6 14 h3) 13 ♖e1 f6 14 ef ♗xf6 (14 ... gf!? – 64) 15 h3 ♘ge5 16 ♘xe5 ♕xe5 17 ♗xh7+ winning a pawn (Bellavenets-Fomina, USSR women's zonal 1975) because if 17 ... ♔xh7 18 ♕c2+.

11 ♖e1 ♘g4
12 h3

Not 12 ♘f1 de 13 ♗xe4 f5 ∓ Engelmann-Soultanbeieff, Belgian Ch 1934.

12 ... ♘ge5
13 ♘xe5

13 ♗c2 h6 14 ♘xe5 ♘xe5 15 ♘f3 ♘xf3+ 16 ♕xf3 de 17 ♕xe4 f5 = Gilg-Alekhine, Kecskemet 1927.

13 ... ♘xe5
14 ed

Moving the bishop loses needful time:
a) 14 ♗b1? ♗d7 15 ed ed 16 ♘f3 ♖ae8 ∓ Colle-Ahues, Frankfurt 1930.
b) 14 ♗c2 d4 15 cd ♕xc2 16 de ♗xe5 17 ♘f3 ♕xe2 18 ♖xe2 (Yudovich-Kirillov, 7th USSR Ch 1931) 18 ... ♗c7 ∓ – ECO.

14 ... ed
15 ♘f3 ±

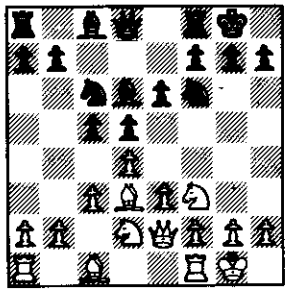
White has a solid position, while Black must either sacrifice or defend his IQP. White can concentrate his forces against the weakness by ♗e3, ♖ad1, ♗c2-b3 and doubling rooks on the d-file. Examples:
a) 15 ... ♘xd3 16 ♕xd3 ♕c4!? 17 ♖d1 ♕xd3 18 ♖xd3 ♖fd8! 19 ♗e3 ♗e6 20 ♖ad1 (½:½, 44) Koltanowski-Soultanbeieff, 4th match game 1935; White was happy with his game at this stage.
b) 15 ... ♘xf3+ 16 ♕xf3 ♗e6 17 ♗e3 and now:
b1) 17 ... ♖ad8 18 ♗c2 b5!? 19 ♗d4 ♗c5 20 ♖ad1 b4 21 ♗e5 ♗d6 22 ♗xh7+! ♔xh7 23 ♕h5+ ♔g8 24 ♗xg7!! ♔xg7 25 ♕g5+ ♔h7 26 ♖d4 ±± Koltanowski-Defosse, Belgian Ch 1936.
b2) 17 ... ♗e5 (to meet 18 ♗d4 by 18 ... ♗xd4) and if 18 ♗xa7 ♗h2+ (18 ... ♖xa7 19 ♕e3) 19 ♔h1 ♖xa7 20 g3 ♗xg3 21 fg = – Koltanowski. White might do better with 18 ♔h1 (threatening both 19 ♗xa7 and 19 ♗xh7+) 18 ... ♗f6 19 ♖e2 followed by ♖ae1 and ♗b1.

A12

8 ♕e2!? *(16)*

This transposition of moves allows (or should one say 'invites'?) Black to get his blow in first.

16
B



8 ... e5!?

Alternatively:
a) 8 ... ♕c7 9 dc returns to A11.
b) 8 ... b6 9 e4 de 10 ♘xe4 ♗b7 11 ♘xf6+ ♕xf6 12 ♘g5 ± Filipcic-Vidmar jr., Yugoslav Ch 1945.
c) 8 ... ♘d7 9 e4 (9 dc ♘xc5) 9 ... cd 10 cd ♘b4 11 ♗b1 b6 (unclear – ECO) 12 ♖e1 ♗a6 13 ♕e3 ♖c8 ∓ – Pachman.

9 dc

9 de is inferior. Franklin-Dodson, Ward-Higgs corres 1973-4, continued 9 ... ♘xe5 10 ♘xe5 ♗xe5 11 e4 (11 f4!? – Dodson) 11 ... ♕c7 12 h3 ♖e8 13 ♕f3 ♗e6 14 c4 d4 ∓ (0-1, 37).

9 ... ♗xc5
10 e4

With some initiative to White, according to Euwe and Pachman. Examples:
a) 10 ... ♖e8 11 h3 ± – Pachman.
b) 10 ... ♗g4 11 ed (11 h3 ♗h5 Wahltuch-Morrison, London 1922) 11 ... ♕xd5 12 ♗c4 (better 12 ♘e4 first – Koltanowski) 12 ... ♕d7 13

h3 (13 ♘xe5? loses the exchange after 13 ... ♗xe2 14 ♘xd7 ♗xf1.) 13 ... ♗h5 14 ♘e4 ♘xe4 15 ♕xe4 ♕c7 16 ♘h4 ♘e7 17 ♗g5 ♔h8 18 ♗xe7 ♗xe7 19 ♗d3 g6 20 ♘f3 ♗d6 21 ♕c4 (21 g4? f5) 21 ... ♕xc4 22 ♗xc4 ♗xf3 (22 ... f5 23 ♘g5) 23 gf ♖ac8 = Koltanowski-Fine, Hastings 1935-6.

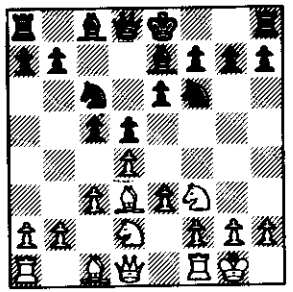
c) **10** ... ♕e7 11 ed ♘xd5 12 ♘b3 ♗d6 13 ♗g5 f6 (13 ... ♕c7 looks safer.) 14 ♕e4 g6 15 ♕xd5+ ♗e6 16 ♕e4 fg 17 ♗c4 ♖f4 18 ♗xe6+ ♕xe6 19 ♘xg5 ± (1-0, 40) Ivanov-Padevsky, Bulgarian Ch 1955.

A2

5 ... ♘c6
6 ♘bd2 ♗e7
7 0-0*(17)*

Klaman-Vladimirov, USSR 1963, was unclear after 7 a3 0-0 8 b4 b6 9 ♗b2 ♗b7 10 0-0 ♕c7 11 ♖c1 ♖ae8 12 ♕a4 c4 13 ♗b1 ♗d6 14 ♕c2 ♘e7.

17 B



7 ... 0-0

Other tries include:

a) 7 ... ♕c7 is known from the game Alekhine-Flohr, Berne 1932: 8 ♕e2 0-0 9 e4 (9 dc ♗xc5 10 e4 see A1) 9 ... de (Here 9 ... cd permits 10 e5! e.g. 10 ... ♘d7 11 cd ♘b4 12 ♗b5! a6 13 ♗a4 ± Neikirkh and Tsvetkov) 10 ♘xe4 cd 11 ♘xd4 ♘xd4 12 cd when:

a1) Flohr played 12 ... ♘xe4 13 ♗xe4 f5?! (13 ... ♗d7 14 ♕f3 ♗c6 = - Alekhine) 14 ♗f3 ♗f6 15 ♖d1 ♖d8 16 ♗e3 ± f4? 17 ♖ac1 ♕d6 18 ♗d2 ♗xd4 19 ♗a5 ♖d7 (19 ... ♖e8 20 ♕c4) 20 ♖xd4 ♕xd4 21 ♕xe6+ etc.

a2) **12 ... ♕d8** (or 12 ... ♗d7 13 ♗g5) 13 ♘xf6+ ♗xf6 14 ♕e4 and White has a strong initiative – Koltanowski.

a3) **12 ... ♘d5** might be met by 13 ♕h5 (Koltanowski) or 13 ♕f3 (Alekhine).

In these variations White is well compensated for his isolated d-pawn by his lead in development and the misplaced black queen.

Other alternatives:

b) 7 ... **♗d7** 8 dc ♗xc5 9 e4 de 10 ♘xe4 ♘xe4 11 ♗xe4 ♗e7 12 ♕c2 h6 13 ♗f4 0-0 14 ♖ad1 ♕e8 15 ♕d2 f5 16 ♗c2 ♗c8 17 ♖fe1 ± Colle-Piccardt, Amsterdam 1931.

c) 7 ... **c4** 8 ♗c2 b5 9 e4 de 10 ♘xe4 0-0 11 ♕e2 ♗b7 12 ♘fg5 ± – ECO.

8 ♕e2

If 8 dc ♗xc5 see A1, or 8 ♘e5 ♕c7 (8 ... ♘d7!? 9 f4 f5 Estrada-Ciric, Rostov 1961) 9 f4 b6 (9 ... g6!? 10 g4 with a ♔-side attack) 10 ♖f3 a5 11 ♖h3 g6 12 ♘df3 ♘e4 with complications; Romani-Benitez, Lugano 1968.

8 ... b6

Or:

a) 8 ... ♕c7 see Alekhine-Flohr, above.

b) **8 ... ♖e8** 9 dc ♗xc5 10 e4 ♘d7 11 ♘b3 (11 ♖e1? ♘de5! ∓ Riumin-Lasker, Moscow 1936) 11 ... de 12 ♗xe4 ± – ECO.

c) **8 ... ♘d7!** (compare A12) 9 e4 cd 10 cd ♘b4 11 ♗b1 b6 12 ♖e1 ♗a6 13 ♕e3 ♖c8 14 a3 ♘c6 (14 ... ♘c2? 15 ♗xc2 ♖xc2 16 ed ± – ECO) 15 b4 de 16 ♘xe4 ♘f6 17 ♘c3 ♘d5 18 ♘xd5 ed is unclear; Kan-Chekhover, 14th USSR Ch 1945.

9 dc

Others:

a) **9 e4?!** cd 10 cd ♘b4 ∓.

b) **9 ♖e1** ♗b7 10 b3 ♖c8 11 ♗b2 cd 12 ed ♘d7 13 ♘f1 ♗f6 (but 1-0, 41) Watson-Morrison, London 1922.

9 ... bc
10 e4 ♕c7

Alternatively:

a) **10 ... de?!** 11 ♘xe4 ♗b7 12 ♗g5 ♘xe4 13 ♕xe4 g6 14 ♗h6 ♖e8 15 ♖ad1 ♕b6 (Ragozin-Stahlberg, Moscow 1935) 16 ♕f4! (threatening ♘g5) with an attack – ECO.

b) Sliwa-Salo, Helsinki 1952, went instead **10 ... ♗b7** 11 ♖e1 ♖e8? 12 ♘g5 h6 13 ed ♕xd5 14 ♘ge4 ♘e5 15 ♘xf6+ ♗xf6 16 ♗e4 ♕d7 17 ♗xb7 ♕xb7 18 ♘e4 ±.

After the column, **10 ... ♕c7**, White should try 11 ♖e1. The immediate 11 e5? fails to 11 ... ♘g4! 12 ♖e1 f6! 13 ef ♗xf6 14 ♘e4?! ♗d4!! (14 ... de 15 ♕xe4) 15 ♘eg5 (15 cd? ♘xd4; 15 h3 de 16 ♕xe4 ♖xf3!) 15 ... ♗xf2+ 16 ♔h1 ♗xe1 0-1 (17 ♕xe1 h6 18 ♘h3 ♖xf3) Franklin-Carleton, England 1971.

B1

5 ... ♘bd7
6 ♘bd2

If 6 ♘e5 (Kupchik-Ed.Lasker, Bradley Beach 1928) ECO recommends 6 ... ♘xe5 7 de ♘d7 8 f4 ♗e7 =.

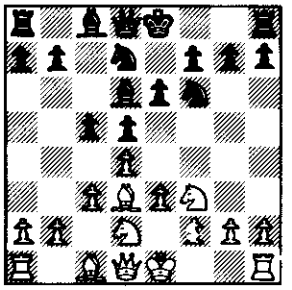
6 ... ♗d6*(18)*

Other tries:

a) **6 ... ♕c7** (6 ... ♗e7 see B2) 7 0-0 b6 8 e4 de 9 ♘xe4 ♗b7 10 ♕e2 ♗e7 (Bisguier-Portisch, Zagreb 1965) 11 ♗g5! ±.

b) **6 ... b6!?** might be met by 7 ♘e5 ♘xe5 (7 ... ♗b7 8 f4 ±) 8 de ♘d7 9 f4 ♕h4+ 10 g3 ♕h3 11 ♕f3 f5 12 ef ♘xf6 13 e4 ♗b7 14 e5 ♘d7 15 ♗f1 ♕f5 16 ♗g2 ♗e7 17 0-0 0-0 18 g4 ♕g6 (18 ... ♕f7 19 ♕e2 and f5) 19 f5 ef 20 gf ♕g5 21 ♘c4! with a dominating spatial advantage for White; Apostopoulos-E.Madsen, *Fernschach* 1959.

18 W



Compared with variation A1, Black is ready to answer dc by ... ♘xc5, and is better placed to blockade an isolated d-pawn (by ... ♘fd5 and ♘7f6).

7 0-0

a) If **7 e4?!** cd (7 ... de is also good.)

8 cd de 9 ♘xe4 ♘xe4 10 ♗xe4 ♘f6 11 ♗c2 ♗b4+ 12 ♗d2 ♗xd2+ 13 ♕xd2 0-0 14 0-0 b6 15 ♕f4 ♗b7 16 ♖ad1 ♖c8 ∓ Goglidze-Lisitsin, 7th USSR Ch 1931.

b) An interesting alternative is **7 ♕e2** ♕c7 (or 7 ... e5!? 8 e4 with a sharp struggle in the centre) 8 0-0:

b1) **8 ... e5?** 9 ♘xe5 ♘xe5 10 de ♗xe5 11 f4 and the bishop is unhappily placed, e.g. 11 ... ♗d6 12 e4! ♗xf4 13 ♖xf4 ♕xf4 14 e5 ± – Rellstab.

b2) **8 ... 0-0** 9 e4 cd 10 cd de 11 ♘xe4 when:

b21) **11 ... ♗f4** 12 g3 ♗xc1 13 ♖fxc1 ♕b6 was unclear in Prins-Keres, Zandvoort 1936.

b22) **11 ... ♗e7** would be more prudent.

b23) **11 ... ♘d5** 12 ♘xd6 ♕xd6 13 ♕e4 ♘7f6 14 ♕h4 and White, having prevented ... ♘f4, has a fine attacking position. O'Kelly-Book, *Dubrovnik 1950, continued* 14 ... ♗d7 15 ♖e1 ♖fc8 16 ♖e5 g6 17 ♗d2 a6 18 ♖ae1 ♗a4 19 b3 ♗b5 20 ♗b1 a5 21 ♘g5! ♖e8 22 ♗e4 ♗c6 23 ♗xd5 ♗xd5 24 ♘xe6! ♘d7 25 ♘g5! ♘xe5 26 ♕xh7+ ♔f8 27 de ♕b6 28 e6! 1-0.

7 ... 0-0

The pleasant miniature game Koltanowski-Catala, Spain 1934 went 7 ... b6?! 8 e4 de 9 ♘xe4 ♘xe4 (better 9 ... ♗e7) 10 ♗xe4 ♖b8 11 dc! ♘xc5 12 ♗c6+ ♔e7 13 b4 ♘b7 14 ♘d4 ♕c7 15 ♕h5 ♘d8 16 b5 f6? (16 ... ♗b7 17 ♗xb7 ±) 17 ♖e1 e5 18 ♖xe5+!! ♗xe5 19 ♗a3+ ♗d6 20 ♖e1+ ♘e6 21 ♘f5+ 1-0.

After 7 ... 0-0 White has:

B11 8 e4

B12 8 ♖e1

a) **8 ♕e2!?** e5 (8 ... ♕c7 see note to White's 7th) 9 de (9 e4 ed ∓) 9 ... ♘xe5 10 ♘xe5 ♗xe5 11 h3 (11 f4?! ♗c7 12 e4? ♗g4!) 11 ... ♖e8 12 ♘f3 ♗c7 ∓ Filipovic-Sokolov, Yugoslavia 1953.

b) **8 h3** (Alekhine) 8 ... ♕c7 (8 ... e5 was analysed in Tartakower's *Die Hypermoderne Schachpartie.*) 9 e4 de 10 ♘xe4 ♘xe4 11 ♗xe4 ♘f6 followed by ... b6, ... ♗b7 – A. Zeitsa, *Shakhmatny Listok*, 1929.

B11

8	**e4!?**	**cd**
9	**cd**	**de**
10	**♘xe4**	**♘xe4**
11	**♗xe4**	**♕b6!**

Or:

a) **11 ... ♘f6** 12 ♗d3! (better than 12 ♗c2 h6 13 ♕e2 b6! ∓ Riumin-Capablanca, Moscow 1936) 12 ... *h6 13 ♘e5 ♕e7 (13 ... b6 14 ♕f3!)* 14 ♕f3 ♖b8 15 ♕g3 ♔h8 16 ♗f4 ± e.g. 16 ... ♘e8 17 ♕g6! f5 18 ♗b5! ♘c7 19 ♕g3 ♗xe5 20 ♗xe5 ♘xb5 21 ♗xb8 ♘xd4 22 ♕d3 ♖d8 23 ♗xa7 ♘c6 24 ♕e3 Prins-Grünfeld, Zandvoort 1936. Black should not have enough for the exchange, although he drew in 75 moves.

b) **11 ... h6** 12 ♗c2 b6 13 ♕d3 ♘f6 14 ♖e1 ♗b7 15 ♘e5 ♖c8 16 ♗f4 ♗b4 17 ♖e2 ♕d5 18 f3 ♗a6 (½:½, 31) Smyslov-Romanishin, USSR 1976.

12 ♘e5

Alternatives include:

a) **12 ♗c2!?** ♘f6 13 ♕d3 ♗d7 14 ♘e5? (14 a4 ♗c6 ∓ ECO, despite 15 ♘g5 *g6 16* ♕h3....?) 14 ... ♗b5 15 ♕h3 ♕xd4! ∓ e.g. 16 ♗g5 ♕xe5 17 f4 (17 ♗xf6 ♕xh2+!) 17 ... ♕e2 18 ♖f2 ♗c5! 0-1 Colle-Bogoljubow, Berlin 1926.

b) **12 ♗d3** ♘f6 13 ♕e2 ♗d7 14 ♖d1 ♗c6 15 ♘e5 and now:

b1) **15 ... ♗d5?** 16 ♗g5 ♗e7 17 ♗xf6 gf 18 ♗xh7+ ±± Colle-Tackels, match 1927.

b2) **15 ... h6** 16 ♘g4 ♘xg4 17 ♕xg4 f5! = – ECO.

c) **12 ♕e2!?**, intending ♗e3, comes into consideration – *Shakhmatny Listok.*

12 ... f5

If 12 ... ♘xe5 (or 12 ... ♘f6 13 ♗c2) 13 de ♗xe5 14 ♗xh7+ (14 ♕h5 f5) 14 ... ♔xh7 15 ♕h5+ and 16 ♕xe5 with attacking chances for White.

13 ♘xd7

Marshall-Alekhine, Bradley Beach 1929, went now 13 ... ♗xd7 14 ♗f3 ♗c6 15 ♖e1 ♔h8! 16 ♗g5 (best?) 16 ... ♖ae8 (16 ... h6!? 17 ♗h4 g5) 17 ♖ac1 (17 b3!?) 17 ... ♗xf3 18 ♕xf3 ♕xb2 19 ♖cb1 ♕xa2 20 ♖xb7 ♖eb8 21 g3 f4! (0-1, 59).

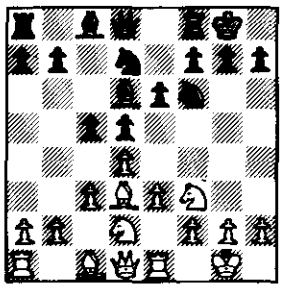
White cannot improve with **13 ♘c4** because of 13 ... ♗xh2+! 14 ♔xh2 ♕c7+ etc.

B12

8 ♖e1 *(19)* **♕c7**

Other possibilities are:

a) **8 ... ♕b6!?** 9 b3 (9 e4 cd 10 cd de 11 ♘xe4 ♘xe4 12 ♖xe4!? ECO) 9 ... e5 10 e4 cd 11 cd de 12 ♘xe4 ♘xe4 13 ♗xe4 ed 14 ♗b2 ♘f6 15 ♗xd4 ♗c5 16 ♗xc5 ♕xc5 17 ♖c1



♕a5 18 ♕d2 ♕b6 = Fine-Keres, Kemeri 1937.

b) **8 ... ♖e8?!** 9 e4 de 10 ♘xe4 ♘xe4 11 ♗xe4 cd (better 11 ... ♘f6 ± Tartakower and Du Mont) and now White's correct plan, objectively, is 12 ♘xd4 or 12 cd. Colle, however, won a brilliancy prize against O'Hanlon (at Nice 1930) with 12 ♗xh7+!? ♔xh7 13 ♘g5+ ♔g6 (13 ... ♔g8 14 ♕h5 ♘e5 15 cd! ♘g6 16 ♕h7+ ♔f8 17 h4! ± ECO) 14 h4 ♖h8? (14 ... f5! might have refuted the attack – Vukovic, The Art of Attack in Chess.) 15 ♖xe6+! ♘f6 (15 ... fe 16 ♕d3+) 16 h5+ ♔h6 17 ♖xd6 ♕a5 18 ♘xf7+ ♔h7 19 ♘g5+! ♔g8 20 ♕b3+ 1-0.

c) **8 ... e5** is too hasty. After 9 e4 cd 10 cd de 11 ♘xe4 ♘xe4 12 ♗xe4 ed 13 ♕xd4 White has the freer game; Colle-Thomas, Carlsbad 1929.

d) **8 ... b6** is too slow, e.g. 9 e4 de 10 ♘xe4 ♘xe4 11 ♗xe4 ♖b8 12 ♕c2 f5 13 ♗d3 ♖e8 14 ♗c4 with pressure; Reilly-Tumurbator, Moscow 1956.

9 e4

Goglidze-Sozin, 7th USSR Ch

1931, went 9 ♕e2 ♖e8 10 h3?! e5 11 de ♘xe5 12 ♘xe5 ♗xe5 13 ♘f3 ♗d6 14 ♕c2 ♗d7 15 c4 dc 16 ♗xc4 b5 ∓.

9	...	cd
10	cd	de
11	♘xe4	♘d5!

a) 11 ... ♘xe4? 12 ♖xe4 ♖e8 13 ♖h4 ♘f8 14 ♘g5 h6 15 ♕h5! e5 16 ♗d2 ed 17 ♖c1 ♕e7 18 ♘e4 ♘g6 19 ♗g5! ♕e5 20 f4 ♕d5? (20 ... ♕a5 21 b4 ±) 21 ♘f6+! Landau-Book, Kemeri 1937.

b) 11 ... b6 12 ♗g5 (Przepiorka-Prokes, Budapest 1925) 12 ... ♗f4! ± – Pirc.

c) 11 ... ♗f4 and now:

c1) 12 g3 ♗xc1 13 ♖xc1 ♕a5 ⩱ Neikirch and Tsvetkov.

c2) 12 ♘xf6+!? ♘xf6 13 ♘e5 ♗xc1 14 ♖xc1 followed by g4 ± – ECO.

c3) 12 ♗e3! ♘d5 13 ♖c1 ♕b6 14 ♕d2 ♗xe3 15 fe ♘5f6 16 ♘c5 ♘xc5 17 ♖xc5 ♗d7 18 ♕f2 ♘d5 19 ♕h4 f5 20 e4? (weakens the d-pawn) 20 ... ♘b4 21 ♗c4 ♘c2 22 ♖c1 ♘e3! 23 ♗b3 ♖f6 (Crepeaux-Prokes, The Hague 1928) and now 24 ♕f4 was necessary.

12	♘xd6	

ECO suggests 12 ♗d2!? followed by ♖c1 ±.

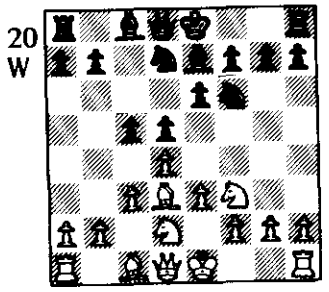
12	...	♕xd6

White has two bishops but Black has a very solid blockade of the d-pawn. Koltanowski-Feigin, Hastings 1936-7, continued 13 ♘e5 (13 ♘g5 ♘7f6 14 ♕f3 ♕b4 ∞, Dus-Hotimirski) 13 ... b6 14 a3 ♗b7 15 ♗b2 a5 16 ♕f3 ♗a6 17 ♘c4 ♗xc4 18 ♗xc4 ♘7f6 ∓.

B2

5	...	♘bd7
6	♘bd2	♗e7*(20)*

A comparatively infrequent defence, albeit the one recommended as safest by both Euwe and Pachman.



7	0-0	

7 ♕e2 0-0 need not transpose if instead of 8 0-0 White plays:

a) 8 e4 (or 8 dc ♘xc5) 8 ... de 9 ♘xe4 cd 10 ♘xd4 (or 10 cd ♗b4+) 10 ... ♗b4+ with a free game for Black.

b) 8 ♘e5!? ♘xe5 (8 ... ♕c7 9 f4) 9 de ♘d7 10 f4 f5 (10 ... f6 11 e4 fe 12 ed rather than 11 ♕h5 f5 12 g4!? – Tartakower and Du Mont) 11 b3 ♘b8! 12 ♗b2 ♘c6 13 0-0 ♗d7 14 ♔h1 ♔h8 15 g4 g6 16 ♖g1 ♖g8 17 ♖g3 ♕f8 18 ♖ag1 ♕f7 19 ♘f3 (no better 19 gf gf or 19 g5 ♔g7) 19 ... ♖ad8 20 h4 a6 21 c4? (better 21 ♖h3) 21 ... dc 22 dc ♘b4 23 ♗b1 ♗c6 24 a3 (24 g5 relatively best) 24 ... ♘d3! (25 ♗xd3? fg) and Black took the initiative; Landau-Berger, match 1932.

7	...	0-0

Or 7 ... ♕c7 when:

a) 8 ♕e2 a6!? 9 b3!? (9 e4 de 10 ♘xe4 b5 11 ♗g5 ♗b7 12 ♖fe1 ± – ECO) 9 ... 0-0 10 ♗b2 b5 11 c4 bc 12 bc cd 13 ♘xd4 dc 14 ♘xc4 ♘c5 15 ♗c2 ♗b7 16 f3 ♖ac8 17 ♖ac1 ♗d5 = Stoltz-Lilienthal, Saltsjöbaden 1948.

b) 8 e4 de 9 ♘xe4 ♘xe4 10 ♗xe4 ♘f6 11 ♗c2 0-0 12 ♗g5 ♖d8 = Gottilf-Rozental, Tourney of Leningrad Masters 1934.

8	♘e5!?	

Alternatively:

a) 8 ♕e2 and now:

a1) 8 ... b6 9 e4 de 10 ♘xe4 ♗b7 11 ♖d1 ♕c7 12 ♗g5 ♖fe8 13 dc ♗xe4 14 ♗xe4 ♘xe4 15 ♕xe4 ♘xc5 16 ♕c4 ♗xg5 17 ♘xg5 ♕e7 18 ♘f3 = Kashdan-H.Steiner, Pasedena 1932.

a2) 8 ... ♕c7 9 e4 de 10 ♘xe4 ♘xe4?! (10 ... b6!? ± ECO) 11 ♕xe4 g6 12 ♗h6 ♖e8 13 ♘e5 ♘xe5 14 de ♗d7 15 ♖fe1 ♖ed8 16 ♖e3! ± Havasi-Gemzoe, Hamburg 1930.

b) 8 ♖e1 when:

b1) 8 ... ♕c7 9 e4 de 10 ♘xe4 ♘xe4 11 ♖xe4 ♘f6 12 ♗c2 b6 13 ♗g5 ♗b7 14 ♕d3 g6 15 ♘e5 ♖ac8 16 dc ♖fd8 17 ♕h3 ± Colle-Rubinstein, San Remo 1930.

b2) 8 ... b6 9 e4 de 10 ♘xe4 ♗b7 11 ♗f4?! (11 ♕e2 = ECO) 11 ... cd 12 cd ♘xe4 13 ♗xe4 ♗xe4 14 ♖xe4 ♘f6 15 ♖e1 ♘d5 ∓ Voellmy-Staehlin, Berne 1932.

c) 8 e4 de (not 8 ... cd? 9 e5) 9 ♘xe4 when:

c1) 9 ... cd?! 10 cd (10 ♘xd4 ♘xe4 = Larrain-Lundin, Leipzig 1960) 10 ... ♘xe4 11 ♗xe4 ♘f6 12 ♗d3! (better than 12 ♗c2 b6 of Konstantinopolsky vs Tolush, 16th USSR Ch 1948) 12 ... b6 13 ♘e5 ♗b7 14 ♖e1 ♕c7 15 ♗f4 with some initiative as compensation for the isolated d-pawn; Koltanowski-Lau, Zurich 1936.

c2) 9 ... ♘xe4! (9 ... b6!? – Zeitsa) 10 ♗xe4 ♘f6 11 ♗c2 b6 = – Euwe.

d) 8 b3 (8 dc ♘xc5 ∓ ECO) 8 ... b6 9 ♗b2 ♗b7 10 ♕e2 ♘e4 11 ♖fd1 f5 12 c4 ♗a6 = Eliskases-Engels, Bad Oeynhausen 1938.

8	...	♘xe5
9	de	♘d7
10	f4	f5
11	ef	

Here Black has continued:

a) 11 ... ♖xf6 12 e4 ♘f8 13 ♘f3 ♘g6 14 e5 ♖f8 15 ♕c2 ♕e8 16 c4 d4 17 h4 with pressure (1-0, 32) Breyer-Maroczy, Berlin 1920.

b) 11 ... ♘f6 12 e4 c4 13 ♗c2 (better 13 ♗e2 – Aitken) 13 ... e5! 14 ed (14 fe ♘g4) 14 ... ♘g4 15 ♘e4 ♗f5 (Anderson-Nairn, Scottish Ch 1955) 16 d6 = – Aitken.

Summary

The less-explored lines in which Black plays ... ♘bd7 offer Black better chances of equalizing than the ... ♘c6 plans. White still has several new ideas to test, however.

4 Colle v. Queen's Indian (...b6)

In this chapter we look at those lines of the Colle System in which Black defers or entirely renounces ... d5, preferring a ♕-side fianchetto. In most of these variations White could transpose to the Queen's Indian by playing c4.

1 d4 ♘f6
2 ♘f3 e6

2 ... b6 can have an independent significance. For 3 ♗f4!? ♗b7 4 ♘bd2 c5 5 e3 e6 (Tarrasch-Reti, Semmering 1926) compare chapter 5.

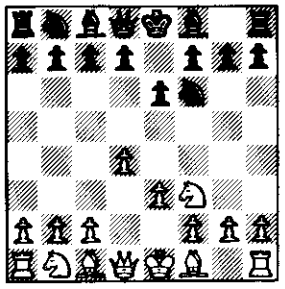
Some lines peculiar to 2 ... b6 3 e3 ♗b7 4 ♘bd2 are:

a) **4 ... c5** 5 c3 g6 6 ♗d3 ♗g7 7 e4 d6 8 0-0 0-0 9 ♕e2 cd 10 cd ♘c6 11 a3 ♘d7 12 ♘b3 a5 = Koltanowski-Alekhine, Hastings 1936-7.

b) **4 ... g6** 5 ♘bd2 d5 (5 ... c5!?) 6 ♘e5 ♗g7 7 f4 0-0 8 ♕f3 ♘fd7 9 ♘g4 f5 10 ♘e5 c5 11 c3 ♘xe5 12 fe ♗a6 = Popov-Sliwa, Tsopot 1951.

c) **4 ... d6** 5 b3 ♘bd7 6 ♗b2 g6 7 ♗d3 ♗g7 8 ♕e2 0-0 9 h4!? (9 e4 e5 10 de ♘g4 =) 9 ... ♖e8 (Neikirkh and Tsvetkov prefer 9 ... c5) 10 0-0-0 e5 11 de de 12 ♗c4 h6 13 ♘f1 ♕e7 14 ♘g3 e4 15 ♘d4 ♘e5 = Popov-Arlamovsky, Tsopot 1951.

3 e3*(21)*



Black now has:

A 3 ... b6
B 3 ... c5 4 ♘bd2 b6

A

3 ... b6
4 ♘bd2

4 ♗d3, though often played, is possibly less precise in view of 4 ... ♗a6!?

4 ... ♗b7

Against 4 ... c5, Koltanowski suggested 5 ♗b5!? but 5 c3 and 5 ♘bd2 (see below) and line B are more usual replies.

5 ♗d3 c5

For 5 ... d5 see chapter 2, C1.

Also possible:

a) **5 ... ♗e7** 6 0-0 0-0 (6 ... d5 chapter 9) 7 b3 d6 8 ♗b2 ♘bd7 9 ♕e2 c5 10 c4 ♕c7 11 ♖ad1 ♖ad8 12 ♗b1 ♖fe8 13 ♘g5 ± Popov-Baltsarek, Tsopot 1951.

b) **5 ... d6** 6 b3 ♘bd7 7 ♗b2 ♗e7 8 0-0 c5 9 ♕e2 0-0 10 ♖ad1 ♕c7 11 c4 ♖fe8 (11 ... ♖ad8 see a) 12 e4 e5 13 d5 g6 14 ♔h1 ♘h5 15 g3 ♖f8 16 ♘e1 ♘df6 17 f4 ♖ae8 18 ♘g2 ♗c8 19 f5 ♘g7 20 g4 g5 21 h4 h6 22 hg hg 23 ♘e3 ♖d8 24 ♕h2 ♖fe8 25 ♔g2 ♗b7 26 ♖f3 b5 27 ♖h1 ±± Riumin-Sozin, 7th USSR Ch 1931.

6 0-0

The immediate 6 c3 is also possible, but not necessary. Then:

a) **6 ... ♘c6** 7 a3 (7 e4 cd 8 cd ♘b4 9 ♗c2 ♗a6) 7 ... ♕c7 8 e4 cd (8 ... e5 9 d5) 9 cd ♗e7 10 0-0 0-0 11 b4 ♖ac8 12 ♗b2 d6 13 ♖c1 ♕b8 better 13 ... ♕d8) 14 ♕e2 ♖fe8 15 ♘b3 ♗f8? (15 ... h6 essential) 16 e5 ♘d5 17 ♗xh7+! (1-0, 29) Koltanowski-Reilly, Barcelona 1935.

b) **6 ... ♗e7** when:

b1) **7 ♕e2** ♘d5! 8 dc (8 e4 ♘f4 or 8 c4 ♘b4) 8 ... bc 9 ♘f1 ♕c7 10 ♘g3 ♘c6 11 ♗d2 g5! and Black has a fine game; Ahues-Alekhine, San Remo 1930.

b2) **7 e4** (7 0-0 below) 7 ... d6 8 ♕e2 cd 9 ♘xd4 = Schenk-Spielmann, Ebensee 1933.

c) **6 ... cd** 7 ed (7 cd ♘c6 8 0-0 ♘b4 =) 7 ... ♘c6 8 0-0 ♗e7 (8 ... ♕c7 9 ♖e1 h5?! 10 ♘c4 ♘g4 11 ♗g5! ±) 9 ♕e2 when:

c1) **9 ... 0-0** 10 ♘e4?! ♘xe4 11 ♕xe4 f5 12 ♕e2 ♗d6 13 ♗g5 ♘xd4! 14 ♘xd4 ♕xg5 15 f3 ♖f6 16 ♗b5 ♖h6 17 f4 ♗xf4 0-1 (18 g3 ♗xg3! 19 hg ♕xg3+ 20 ♔g2 ♕h4 and ... ♖g6) Mouracheff-Soultanbeieff, Liege Ch 1930.

c2) **9 ... ♕c7** 10 ♘e5 0-0 11 f4 d6 12 ♘g4 ♘b8 13 f5 e5 14 ♘xf6+ ♗xf6 15 ♘e4 ♘d7 ± Popov-Koch, Sopot 1951.

6 ... ♘c6

Others:

a) **6 ... ♗e7** 7 c3 (7 b3 see B) 7 ... 0-0 (maybe premature) 8 e4 and now:

a1) **8 ... cd** 9 ♘xd4?! d6 10 ♕e2 ♘bd7 11 f4 ♘c5 12 ♗c2 ♗a6 13 c4 ♖c8 14 b4 e5 15 bc ed 16 cd ♕xd6 17 ♗d3 ♘d7 ½:½ Colle-Mattison, Budapest 1926.

a2) **8 ... ♘c6** see below.

b) **6 ... d6** 7 ♕e2 ♘bd7 8 c3 ♗e7 9 e4 cd 10 cd a6 11 b3 0-0 12 ♗b2 g6 13 ♖fd1 ♕b8 14 h3 ♖d8 15 ♘f1 ♘h5 16 ♕e3 e5 17 de de 18 ♗c4 b5 19 ♖xd7! ♖xd7 20 ♘xe5 bc 21 ♘xd7 ♕c7 22 ♘b6 ♖d8 23 ♘xc4 ♗c5 24 ♕f3 ±± Denker-Ervin, Lone Pine 1976.

c) **6 ... cd**? 7 ed d5?! 8 ♘e5 ♘c6 9 ♘df3 ♕c7 10 ♘g5 ♘xe5 11 de ♘d7 (11 ... ♕xe5 12 ♗b5+) 12 ♕h5 g6 13 ♕f3 ♘xe5 14 ♕f6 ♘g♮ 15 ♗b5+ ♗c6 16 ♗xc6+ ♕xc6 17 ♕xf7+ ♔d8 18 ♘xe6+ ♔c8 19 ♘xf8 ♕d6 20 ♕e6+ ♔c7 21 ♕xg4 ♖axf8 22 ♕g3 1-0 Denker-Chernev, USA Ch 1942.

7 c3

For 7 b3 see B. 7 c4, transposing to the Queen's Indian, is still possible.

7 ... ♗e7*(22)*

Alternatively:

a) 7 ... cd 8 ed see note c to White's 6th move.

b) 7 ... ♕c7 does not always transpose:

b1) 8 ♖e1 ♖c8 9 a3 ♗e7 see below.

b2) 8 e4!? and if 8 ... cd 9 ♘xd4 (but not 9 cd ♘b4 10 ♗b1 ♖c8) was suggested by Kan.

b3) 8 a3 ♗e7 9 e4 d6 10 ♖e1 h6 11 ♘f1 0-0-0?! (better 11 ... g5 Δ ... g4; if 12 e5 de 13 de ♘d5 Δ ... 0-0-0 ∞ – Kan) 12 d5 ed 13 ed ♘e5 14 ♘xe5 de 15 c4 ♗d6 16 ♗d2 ♖de8 17 ♗c3 h5 and Black stands no worse; Lilienthal-Kan, Moscow 1936.

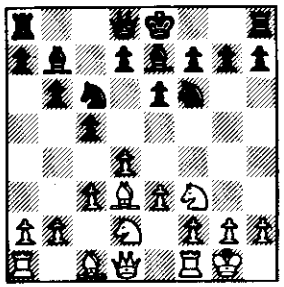
b4) 8 ♕e2 ♗e7 9 e4 and now:

b41) 9 ... cd 10 ♘xd4 ♘e5 11 ♗c2 ♕c8 12 h3 ♘c6 13 ♘df3 ♘xd4 14 ♘xd4 d6 and Black had a very solid position, Spielmann-Eliskases, 9th match game 1936.

b42) 9 ... d6 10 e5 de 11 de ♘d5 12 ♘c4 h6 13 a4 g5 14 h3? 0-0-0 15 a5 ♖dg8 16 ab ab 17 ♘a3 g4 18 hg ♖xg4 19 ♘h2? (better 19 ♗a6) 19 ... ♖xg2+! 20 ♔xg2 ♘d4! 21 ♕e4 (21 cd ♘f4+ 22 ♔g3 ♘xe2+ 23 ♗xe2 ♖g8+ 24 ♔f4 ♗g5+ ∓∓) 21 ... f5 22 ♘b5 ♕d8 23 cd fe 24 ♗xe4 ♘f4+ 25 ♗xf4 ♗xe4+ 26 f3 ♗b7 27 ♖a7 ♕d7 28 ♖fa1 ♕xb5 29 ♖a8+ ♔c7 30 ♖xh8 ♕xb2+ 0-1 Iglitsky-Kan, Moscow 1928.

This is the critical position of the Colle v. Queen's Indian. Black has avoided premature castling, which might allow White to build up a strong attack. Instead he posts his

22
W



pieces ready to deal with the advance e3-e4, (without which White's build-up would be senseless.

8 ♕e2

White has also tried:

a) 8 dc bc! 9 e4 ♕c7 10 ♕e2 d6 11 ♘c4 0-0 12 e5 de 13 ♘cxe5 ♘xe5 = Colle-Pirc, Frankfurt 1930.

b) 8 ♘e5 d6 9 ♘xc6 ♗xc6 10 ♕e2 e5 11 e4 0-0 12 d5 ♗d7 13 c4 ♕c8 14 f3 ♘h5 15 g3 g6 16 ♖f2 f5 17 ♘f1 f4 18 g4 ♗xg4! 19 fg f3 20 ♖xf3 ♕xg4+ 21 ♖g3 ♖xf1+! 22 ♔xf1 ♘xg3+ 23 hg ♕xg3 ∓∓ Aliega-Alekhine, Paris 1914; comparison with Riumin-Sozin (above) reveals that Black's queen's bishop was better placed here, but also that White played unduly passively after the centre was blocked.

c) 8 e4 and now:

c1) 8 ... ♘c6 9 a3 (9 ♕e2 below) 9 ... cd 10 cd ♕c7 11 b4 ♖ac8 12 ♗b2 ♖fd8 13 ♖c1 ♕b8 14 ♕e2 with a good game for White; Koltanowski-Anderson, Columbus 1957.

c2) 8 ... cd! 9 ♘xd4 (9 cd ♘b4 10 ♗b1 ♗a6) and now:

c21) 9 ... ♘e5!? 10 ♗c2 ♗a6 11 ♖e1 ♕c7 (Euwe suggested 11 ... ♘d3 12 ♖e3 ♘xc1 and 13 ... ♕c7.) 12 ♘2f3 ♘g6 ± Colle-L.Steiner, Niendorf 1927.

c22) 9 ... 0-0 10 ♕e2 (better 10 ♘xc6 first) 10 ... ♘e5 11 ♗c2 ♕c8! 12 f4 ♗a6 13 ♕d1 ♘c6 (not 13 ... ♗xf1? 14 fe with two pieces for the rook) and White's control of the centre will be undermined. Colle-Capablanca, Carlsbad 1929, continued 14 ♖f3?! (14 e5 ♘d5 and not 15 ♗xh7+? ♔xh7 16 ♕h5+ ♔g8 17 ♖f3 because of 17 ... f5 18 ♖h3 ♘xf4.) 14 ... g6! 15 ♘2b3 ♘xd4 16 ♘xd4 ♗b7 17 ♕e2 ♗c5 18 ♖h3 ♕c6! 19 e5 ♘d5 20 ♕f2?! (Vukovic suggested 20 ♗e3 ♗xd4 21 cd ♖ac8 22 ♗b3! =.) 20 ... ♗xd4?! (20 ... f5 ∓ is sounder – Vukovic.) 21 cd ♖ac8 22 ♗d1! f6! 23 ♕h4? (Vukovic pointed out that 23 ♗d2! might even favour White.) 23 ... ♖f7 24 ♗f3 ♕c4 (∓∓) 25 ♗e3 ♘xe3 26 ♗xb7 ♘f5! 27 ♕e1 ♖c7 28 ♗e4 ♕d4+ 29 ♔h1 fe 30 ♗xf5 ef 31 fe ♖e7 32 ♖e3 ♕xb2 33 e6 de 34 ♖xe6 ♔f7! 0-1.

d) 8 ♖e1 ♖c8 9 a3 and now:

d1) 9 ... ♕c7 10 e4 cd 11 cd d6 12 b4 e5 13 ♗b2 ed 14 ♘xd4 ♘xd4 15 ♗xd4 0-0 16 ♖e3 ♖fd8 17 ♖h3 g6 18 ♕f3 ♘h5 19 g4 ♘g7 20 ♕e3 g5 21 ♗b2! f6 22 e5 de 23 ♗xh7+ ♔f7 24 ♘e4 ♕d7 25 ♕f3! (1-0, 37) Soultanbeieff-Kramer, Beverwijk 1950.

d2) 9 ... d5 (9 ... cd!? – Pritchett) 10 e4 (10 dc!? bc 11 e4 ♕c7 or 11 ... d4!?) 10 ... de 11 ♘xe4 cd 12 cd 0-0 and now 13 ♘c3! is relatively best (½:½, 26 in Harding-Pritchett, Dublin 1976) but White is about two tempi down on normal isolated d-pawn lines (e.g. from the Nimzo-Indian) so, if anything, stands at a disadvantage here. Possibly the immediate 8 a3, or 9 e4 (instead of 9 a3) could be tried.

8 ... 0-0

However Black could play 8 ... d5 as in d) above. Neikirkh and Tsvetkov then suggest that White should adopt a Stonewall set-up by 9 ♘e5 ♕c7 10 f4 (like Bird's Opening or a reversed Dutch). Also possible is 8 ... d6 and if 9 e4 ♕c7 transposing to Iglitsky-Kan above.

9 a3

9 dc might be a little better. 9 ♖e1 is superfluous, e.g. 9 ... ♕c7 10 e4 cd 11 ♘xd4 ♘e5 12 ♗c2 ♘g6 13 ♘f1 ♖ac8 14 ♗g5 ♘d5 15 ♗xe7 ♘xe7 16 ♘e3 d5 17 ed ♘f4! 18 ♕f3 ♘xd5 19 ♘xd5 (19 ♗e4 ♘xe3 20 ♗xb7 ♘xg2 21 ♖ed1 ♘h4! etc.) 19 ... ♗xd5 20 ♗e4 ♗c4 and Black has some initiative (but ½:½, 40) Maroczy-Colle, San Remo 1930.

9 ... ♖e8

9 ... d5!? might still be best (possibly with 8 ... ♖c8 instead of 8 ... 0-0).

10 e4 cd

11 cd d6

12 b4 ±

With the same plan as in Koltanowski-Reilly in note a) to White's 6th move above. The game Koltanowski-Flohr, Antwerp 1932, went on 12 ... ♘h5 13 g3 g6 14

♗b2 d5 15 e5 ♘g7 16 ♘b3 a5?! 17 b5 ♘b8 18 ♖fc1 ♘d7 19 ♖xc8 ♕xc8 20 ♖c1 ♕b8 21 ♕c2 ♘e8 22 ♕d2 (Black is tied up.) 22 ... ♔g7 23 ♖c2 h6 24 ♗c1 ♖h8 25 h4 ♘f8 26 ♕f4 ♕d8 27 ♖c3 ♗c8 28 ♘a1 ♗d7 29 ♘c2 a4 30 ♘b4 ♗xb4 31 ab ♔g8 32 ♕d2 ♘c7 33 ♕e2 ♗e8 34 ♘h2 ♕d7 35 ♘g4 ♘h7 36 ♗xh6 ♕e7 37 ♕c2 1-0.

B

3 ... c5

4 ♘bd2

4 ♗d3 usually transposes – but see the note to White's 5th and Enevoldsen-Nimzowitsch, p. 6. Also 4 b3 has been played, and should also transpose into one of the lines below.

4 ... b6

4 ... d5 see chapter 3.

If 4 ... ♘c6, 5 ♗e2 (Watson-Rubinstein, London 1922) is too defensive. 5 ♗d3 can be played because 5 ... ♘b4 6 ♗e2 b6 7 c3 ♘c6 8 ♗d3 comes to the same thing as A above; 5 c3 is also possible.

5 ♗d3

If White wants to avoid the line ... ♗a6 (note to Black's 5th) he must play 5 c3 here and transpose to A.

5 ... ♗b7

Stahlberg-Kottnauer, Budapest 1952, however went 5 ... ♗a6!? 6 ♗xa6 ♘xa6 7 c3 ♗e7 8 0-0 0-0 9 ♕e2 ♕c8 10 a3 (not 10 e4 cd 11 cd ♘b4) 10 ... ♕b7 11 ♖d1 ♖ac8 12 ♘f1 ♘b8 13 ♘g3 ♗e4 14 ♘xe4 ♕xe4 15 a4! but now Black lost the initiative by the pointless move 15 ... ♕b7? and White won after further errors.

6 0-0

6 b3 can be played first but usually transposes. However, after 6 ... ♘c6 7 ♗b2 these examples are also available:

a) 7 ... cd 8 ed ♘b4 9 ♗f1! (but not 9 ♗e2 ♘bd5 and ... ♘f4) Rubinstein-Capablanca, Carlsbad 1929, continuing 9 ... ♖c8 10 c4 ♘c6 11 ♗d3 d5 12 0-0 ♗d6 13 a3 0-0 14 ♖e1 dc 15 bc ♗f4 16 ♘f1! ♘a5 17 ♕e2 ♕c7 (17 ... ♗h6 18 ♘e5!) 18 d5! ♘xc4! 19 ♗xf6 gf 20 de fe! 21 ♘d4! ♗d5! 22 ♘xe6 ♗xe6 23 ♕xe6+ ♔h8 24 ♖e4! ♘e5! 25 ♗a6! ♖ce8 26 ♕f5 ♗h6 27 ♖ae1 ♖d8! 28 ♖h4 ♕g7 29 ♖h3 ♖d4! 30 ♕h5 ♖g4 31 ♘g3 ♗f4 32 ♖d1 ♗xg3 33 ♖xg3 ♖xg3 34 hg ♕e7 35 ♕f5! ½:½.

b) 7 ... ♗e7 8 dc!? (possibly 8 c4 is best?) 8 ... bc 9 0-0 0-0 10 c4 ♕c7 11 h3 ♘e8 12 a3 f5 13 ♕c2 ♗f6 ∓ Rubinstein-Geiger, Rogaska Slatina 1929.

6 c3 can also be played. Nenarokov-Grigoriev, Moscow Ch 1924, continued 6 ... ♘c6 7 0-0 (7 e4 cd 8 cd ♘b4 9 ♗c2 ♗a6) 7 ... ♗e7 8 dc bc! (8 ... ♗xc5 9 e4 d5 10 e5 ♘g4 11 ♗b5 ±) 9 e4 ♕c7 10 ♖e1 d5! 11 ed (11 e5 ♘g4 12 ♕e2 c4 13 ♗c2 ♗c5) 11 ... ed 12 ♘f1 0-0 13 ♘g3 ♗d6 14 ♗g5 ♘d7 15 ♘f5 ♗f4 and now 16 ♕a4!? ∞ – Rabinovich.

6 ... ♗e7

7 b3 cd

Alternatively:

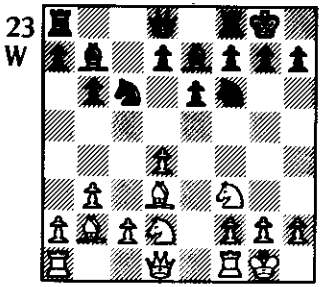
a) 7 ... ♘c6 8 a3 (or 8 ♗b2 d5 9 a3 0-0 10 ♕e2 ♕c7 11 ♘e5 ♘d7 = N and T) 8 ... 0-0 9 ♗b2 d6 10 c4 ♖c8 11 ♖c1 ♕c7 12 ♕c2 h6 13 ♖fd1 ♕b8 14 ♕b1 cd 15 ♘xd4 ♘xd4 16 ♗xd4 d5 17 ♕b2 ♘g4! Averbakh-Chekhover, Ch of VTsPS 1946.

b) 7 ... 0-0 8 ♗b2 d6 9 ♕e2 a6 10 ♖ad1 ♘bd7 11 c4 ♕c7 12 ♗b1 ♖fd8 13 e4 cd 14 ♘xd4 ♗f8 15 ♖ac1 ♖ac8 16 b4 ♕b8 17 f4 e5! = (0-1, 44) Janowski-Spielmann, Marienbad 1925.

8 ed 0-0

8 ... d6 is dubious because of 9 ♗b2 ♘bd7 10 c4 0-0 11 ♖c1 ♖e8 12 ♖e1 (Colle-Grünfeld, Berlin 1926) with a favourable form of Queen's Indian. White has a space advantage without being committed to any rigid formation.

9 ♗b2 ♘c6 *(23)*



This position also tends to turn into a kind of Queen's Indian as White is bound to play c2-c4 sooner or later, as the following examples show:

a) Soultanbeieff-Dunkelblum, Spa 1926: **10 c4** d5 11 a3 ♕c7 12 ♕c2 dc 13 bc h6 (better 13 ... ♖fd8) 14 ♖ad1 (14 d5 ♘d8!) 14 ... ♖fd8 15 ♖fe1 ♖ac8 16 h3 ♘e8 17 ♘b3 ♔f8? (17 ... ♗f6 or 17 ... a5 – Soultanbeieff) 18 ♕e2 a5 19 d5! ed 20 cd ♘b8 (20 ... ♖xd5 21 ♕e4!) 21 ♕e4?! (simpler 21 ♗f5) 21 ... ♘f6 22 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 23 ♕h7 g6 24 ♘h4!? ♗g7? (24 ... ♗xd5 25 ♗xg6! ♗xb3 26 ♘f5! draws.) 25 ♗g6! ♖d5 26 ♖xd5 ♗xd5 27 ♘f5! fg 28 ♖e7 gf? (28 ... ♕e7 29 ♘e7 ♖d8 30 ♘g6+ ♔f7 31 ♘d4 ♖d6 32 ♘e5+) 29 ♕xg7 mate.

b) Platonov-Karpov, 39th USSR Ch 1971: **10 a3** ♕c7 11 ♖e1 ♖ac8 12 c4 d5 13 ♖c1 ♖fd8 14 ♕e2 dc 15 bc ♕f4! 16 g3 ♕h6 17 ♖c2 ♕h5 18 ♕f1 ♖c7 19 ♗e2 ♕f5 20 ♗d3 ♕h5 21 ♗e2 ½:½; however, White did not make the most of his chances in this game. He was probably happy to draw with Karpov.

Summary

Black can get good chances against the Colle system by fianchettoing his queen's bishop, delaying both castling and ... d5. White usually finds it necessary to play a2-a3 to avoid dangers of ... cd, ... ♘b4 and play on the c-file. His best plan may well be to play b3 rather than c3 and transpose into the Keres system against the Queen's Indian (in which White's knight is at least as well placed on d2 as on c3).

5 London System (♗f4), Introduction

The London System resembles the Colle, but with one important difference. White develops his queen's bishop more actively, on f4. There it is outside the c3-d4-e3 pawn wedge and bears down on the black ♕-side. The drawback is that its absence from White's own ♕-side may encourage Black to find counterplay on that wing, e.g. by ... ♕b6 attacking the now unprotected pawn at b2 – as indeed happens in some lines of the Torre Attack.

White most often adopts the London System against the King's Indian (see chapter 6) as in the original game Watson-Euwe, London 1922 and others from that same tournament. However, White can also play an early ♗f4 against other black formations – as in Watson-Capablanca from round 12 of the London tournament, although this was not a new idea even then.

More recently, the London System has been a speciality of some Scottish players – such as Bonner, Fairhurst, Fallone and McAlpine – and of the Yugoslavian masters Gasic and Rakic. Against the King's Indian (1 ... ♘f6 2 ♘f3 g6) the English master M.J.Franklin has refined many of the ideas in two decades of experience with the system – as we shall see in chapter 6.

Where Black does not play ... g6, two move-orders need to be distinguished:

A 1 d4 d5 (to London)

B 1 d4 ♘f6 (to London)

of which the former is much the more important. It is true that both of the main move-orders 1 d4 d5 2 ♘f3 ♘f6 3 ♗f4 and 1 d4 ♘f6 2 ♘f3 e6 3 ♗f4 do involve some weakening of the h2-b8 diagonal which White hopes to exploit, but where Black is not committed to ... d5 he has more flexible counters at his disposal. The slight rigidity in White's position is more likely to be disadvantageous when Black himself does not have a rigid stance.

A

1 d4 d5

2 ♘f3

'Knights before bishops' – or rather knight before bishop – in the approved fashion. Nevertheless 2 ♗f4 is playable, and sometimes can be independently significant:

a) **2 ... c5!?** 3 e3 (3 ♘f3 below) 3 ... ♘c6 4 c3 e6 (For 4 ... ♕b6 see von Scheve-Marshall, Chapter 1, p. 5) 5 ♘d2 ♗d6 6 ♗g3 ♘f6 7 f4 cd (7 ... ♕c7 = ECO) 8 ed ♕c7 9 ♕f3 ♗d7 10 ♗d3 ♘a5 11 ♘h3 ♘c4 12 ♗xc4 dc 13 ♕e2 b5 14 a4 ± Janowski-Marshall, match 1916.

b) **2 ... ♘f6** 3 e3 when:

b1) 3 ... ♗g4 4 ♗e2 (4 f3 ♗f5) 4 ... ♗xe2 5 ♕xe2 c6 6 ♘d2 e6 7 c3 ♘bd7 8 e4 (8 ♘gf3, intending ♘e5, is also possible.) 8 ... ♘xe4 9 ♘xe4 de 10 ♕xe4 ± Alapin-Rubinstein, Carlsbad 1911.

b2) 3 ... c5 4 c3 ♕b6 5 ♘f3 below.

b3) 3 ... e6 and now:

b31) 4 ♘d2 c5 5 c3 ♗d6 6 ♗xd6 ♕xd6 7 f4 0-0 8 ♗d3 b6 9 ♕e2 cd 10 cd d5 11 ♘gf3 ♗a6 12 0-0 ♗xd3 13 ♕xd3 ½:½ Kovacevic-Ciric, Yugoslav Ch 1967.

b32) 4 ♗d3 c5 5 c3 ♕b6 6 ♕c2 and:

b321) 6 ... ♘bd7 7 ♘d2 ♗d6 8 ♗xd6 (8 ♘gf3!?) 8 ... ♕xd6 9 f4 ♘g4?! (ECO suggests 9 ... b6.) 10 ♘f1 cd 11 cd ♕b4+ 12 ♔e2! ± (½:½, 71) Janowski-Ed.Lasker, New York 1924.

b322) 6 ... ♘c6 7 ♘f3 ♗d7 8 0-0 ♖c8 9 dc! ♗xc5 10 ♘bd2 ♗e7 11 a3 threatening e4 ± – Alekhine.

After 2 ♘f3 White can meet three distinct systems:

A1 2 ... e6 3 ♗f4

A2 2 ... c5 3 ♗f4

A3 2 ... ♘f6 3 ♗f4

Black has also tried 2 ... c6 3 ♗f4 ♗f5 (3 ... ♕b6!? see Rakic-Bagirov, Chapter 1, p. 2) 4 e3 e6 5 ♗d3 ♘f6 6 ♗xf5 (better 6 0-0 ♗e7 7 ♘bd2 – Kotov) 6 ... ef 7 ♕d3 ♘e4 and Black has stolen his opponent's thunder by obtaining the e-file himself; Nestler-Smyslov, Venice 1950.

A1

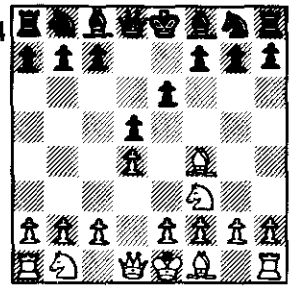
2 ... e6

3 ♗f4 *(24)*

For other moves, see chapter 7.

Alekhine's general comment on 3 ♗f4 was 'This interesting and not easily handled variation leads to complicated play in the centre with the chances rather favourable to White, chiefly on account of the strength of his black squares.' The exchange of White's dark-squared bishop (essentially a bad bishop) for his 'good' opposite number – especially on f4 – enhances this advantage. By making a nuisance of the bishop, White increases the chances that his opponent will decide to exchange it.

24
B



3 ... ♗d6

Or 3 ... c5 (a natural reaction) 4

c3 ♕b6 5 ♕b3 and now:
a) 5 ... c4?! 6 ♕xb6 ab 7 ♘bd2 ♘c6 8 a3!? (to freeze the ♕-side) 8 ... ♘f6 9 h3 ♗e7 10 g4 0-0 11 ♗g2 ♘e8 12 0-0 ♗d6 13 ♗xd6 ♘xd6 14 ♘e1?! (14 ♖ae1! f5 15 ef ± – Pribyl) 14 ... f5! ∓ (1-0, 41) Pribyl-Urzica, Bucharest 1975.
b) 5 ... ♕xb3 6 ab cd 7 cd ± – Pribyl. White's pressure on the a-file is good compensation for the doubled b-pawns.
c) 5 ... ♘f6 6 e3 see below (Janowski-Tarrasch).

4 e3

White has also tried:
a) 4 ♗g3!? ♘f6 5 e3 ♗xg3 6 hg c5 7 dc ♕a5+ 8 ♘bd2 ♘c6 9 c3 ♕xc5 10 ♗d3 ♘g4! 11 ♘g5!? (11 ♖xh7? ♖xh7 12 ♗xh7 g6) 11 ... ♘ce5 12 ♘df3 ♗d7 13 ♘xe5 ♘xe5 14 ♗e2 f6 15 ♘f3 ♘c6 16 ♕c2 g6 17 0-0-0 (17 ♕xg6+!? ∞) 17 ... 0-0-0 Marco and Fahndrich–Charousek and Halprin, Vienna 1897.
b) 4 ♗xd6 ♕xd6 5 ♘bd2 ♘f6 6 c3 ♘bd7 7 ♕c2 e5 8 e3 0-0 9 de ♘xe5 10 ♗e2 (10 ♘xe5 ♕xe5 11 ♘f3 = Reti) 10 ... ♗g4 11 h3 ♗h5 12 ♘xe5 ♗xe2! 13 ♘ef3 ♕a6 14 ♘b3 ♗d3 15 ♕d1 b6 16 ♘c1 ♗c4! 17 ♘e5 (17 b3 ♕a5) 17 ... ♖ad8 ∓ Blackburne-Charousek, Berlin 1897.

4 ... ♗xf4

Or: 5 ... ♘c6 6 ♗d3 (6 ♘bd2 ♗d6 see A2) 6 ... ♕b6! 7 ♕c1 (7 ♕c2 ♗d7 Δ ... ♖c8, ... cd, ... ♘b4; 7 ♕b3? c4 8 ♕xb6 ab Δ ... b5-b4 ∓) 7 ... ♗d7 8 0-0 ♖c8 9 ♘bd2 ♗e7 10 ♖b1 (10 ♘e5 cd) 10 ... 0-0 11 ♕d1 ♖fd8 12 ♘e5 ♘xe5 13 de ♘e8 14 ♕h5 f5 (Marshall-Rubinstein, Lodz 1908) 15 ef ♘xf6 16 ♕e2 = – Reti, *Masters of the Chess Board.*

5 ef ♘f6

Alternatively:
a) Bogoljubow-Marshall, New York 1924, continued 5 ... c5?! 6 dc ♕a5+ 7 c3 ♕xc5 8 ♗d3 ♘f6 9 0-0 0-0 10 ♘bd2 ♘c6 11 ♘e5 ♖d8 12 ♖e1 ♗d7 13 ♘df3 ± (1-0, 56)
b) Alekhine said that 5 ... ♕b6 would be more logical, and after 6 ♕d2 or 6 g3 then 6 ... c5 forcing White to go sooner or later.

6 c3 0-0
7 ♗d3 ♕d6

8 g3 c5 9 dc ♕xc5 10 ♘bd2 ♘c6 11 0-0 ♖d8 12 ♕e2 ♕b6 13 ♘b3 ♗d7 14 ♘bd4 ♘xd4 15 ♘xd4 ♖e8 (to forestall f4-f5) 16 ♖fe1 ♖ac8 17 ♖ad1 a6 18 ♖d2 ♕d6 19 ♘f3 ♕e8 20 ♘d4 ♕c5 ½:½ Selesniev-Marshall, Mahrisch-Ostrau 1923.

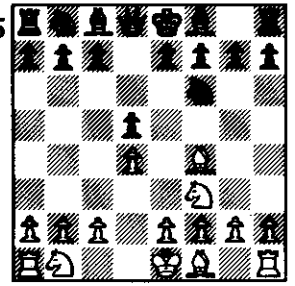
A2

2 ... c5
3 ♗f4

For alternatives see chapter 7. Now for 3 ... e6 see A1 above. Other moves are:
a) 3 ... cd 4 ♗xb8 ♖xb8 5 ♕xd4 b6 6 e4 de? 7 ♕xd8+ ♔xd8 8 ♘e5 1-0 Alekhine-Kaufman, Odessa 1918.
b) 3 ... ♘c6 4 e3 ♘f6 and now 5 c3 (below) or 5 ♘c3?! ♗g4 6 ♗b5 e6 7 h3 ♗h5 (7 ... ♗xf3 8 ♕xf3 a6 9 ♗xc6+ bc ∓ – Neikirkh and Tsvetkov) 8 g4 ♗g6 9 ♘e5 ♕b6 10 a4! a5 11 h4! h5 12 ♘xg5 fg 13 gh gh 14 ♕e2 0-0-0 15 0-0-0 ♗d6 16 ♗xd6 ♖xd6 with an unclear position; Nimzowitsch-Alekhine, Vilnius 1912.
c) 3 ... ♕b6 4 dc ♕xb2 5 ♗e5 ♕b4+ 6 ♘c3 e6 7 ♖b1 ♕xc5 8 ♘b5 ♘a6 9 e3 f6?! 10 ♗d4 ♕e7 11 ♘xa7 ♘c5 12 ♘xc8 ♖xc8 13 ♗b5+ ♔f7 14 0-0 ♕c7 15 c4 dc 16 ♗xc4 ♘e7 17 ♘e5+! fe 18 ♕f3+ ♔g6 19 ♗xc5 ♕xc5 20 ♗xe6 h5 21 ♗f7+ 1-0 Schlechter-Leonhardt, Carlsbad 1911.

A3

2 ... ♘f6
3 ♗f4*(25)*



From the diagrammed position Black has tried:
A31 3 ... c5
A32 3 ... e6
Others:
a) 3 ... g6 see chapter 6 (note a to Black's 3rd and line B, *passim*).
b) 3 ... ♗f5 when:
b1) 4 e3 c6 5 ♗d3 e6 6 c3 ♗xd3 7 ♕xd3 ♗e7 8 0-0 ♘h5 9 ♗xb8 ♖xb8 10 ♘bd2 f5 11 ♘e5 0-0 = Karaklajic-Trifunovic, Yugoslav Ch 1956.
b2) 4 c4 e6 5 ♕b3 ♕c8 6 e3 gives White chances for the initiative according to Horowitz.

A31

3 ... c5

White can now choose between:
A311 4 c3
A312 4 e3

A311

4 c3 ♕b6

4 ... cd 5 cd transposes to the Slav Exchange variation of the Queen's Gambit. see 45 Right hand column
For 4 ... e6 see A32. Not 4 ... c4? 5 ♘bd2 ♗f5 6 ♘h4 e6 (6 ... ♗g6 7 ♘xg6 hg 8 e4! ±) 7 ♘xf5 ef 8 b3 cb? (The last chance was 8 ... b5 9 a4 b4! – Czerniak.) 9 ♕xb3 ♕d7 10 ♖b1 b6 11 ♗xb8! ♖xb8 12 e4 ♕e6 13 ♗b5+ ♔d8 14 e5 ♘e4 15 ♘xe4 fe 16 0-0 f6 17 ♖fd1 ♖c8 18 ♖bc1 g6 19 c4! 1-0 Fairhurst-Keogh, Tel Aviv 1964.

5 ♕b3 ♘c6
6 e3 e6

If 6 ... c4 7 ♕xb6 ab 8 ♘a3 e5 9 ♘b5.

After 6 ... e6:
a) 7 h3 ♗e7 8 ♘bd2 ♗d7 9 ♗e2 0-0 10 0-0 ♖fc8 11 ♘e5 ♗e8 12 ♗g3 ♘d7 13 ♘df3 ♘f8 14 ♖fd1 ♘a5 15 ♕c2 c4 16 ♘d2 f6 17 ♘ef3 ♗g6 18 ♕c1 h6 19 ♘h2 ♕d8 20 ♗f3 (1-0, 37) Janowski-Tarrasch, Ostend 1905.
b) 7 ♕xb6 ab 8 ♗c7?! c4 9 ♗xb6 ♗d6 10 ♗e2 ♘d7 11 ♗c5 ♗xc5 12 dc ♘xc5 13 ♘bd2 e5 14 e4 (desperately trying to break out) 14 ... de 15 ♘g5 ♘d3+ 16 ♔f1 b5 17 ♘gxe4 ♘xb2 18 ♘d6+ ♔e7 19 ♘xb5 ♖a5 20 a4 ♗e6 21 ♘c7 ♖d8 22 ♘xe6 ♖xd2 23 ♘c7 ♘xa4 24 ♗xc4 ♘xc3 25 ♖c1 ♖c2! 26 ♖e1 ♔d7 27 ♘a6 e4 28 g3 ♘e5 29 ♘b4 ♖b2 30 f4 ♘xc4 0-1 Cederquist-Rantanen, Stockholm 1976.

A312

4 e3 ♘c6*(26)*

Also:

a) 4 ... cd is recommended as safest by Horowitz. After 5 ed a Caro-Kann (Exchange Variation) can arise if White plays c3.

b) 4 ... e6 5 c3 when:

b1) 5 ... ♗e7?! 6 ♘bd2 0-0 7 ♗d3 see A322.

b2) 5 ... ♘c6 6 ♘bd2 ♗d6 and now:

b21) 7 ♗g5 0-0 (7 ... h6!?) 8 ♕c2 (8 ♗e2 e5!?) 8 ... h6 9 ♗h4 ♗e7!? 10 ♗e2 b6 11 ♖d1 ♗b7 12 ♗g3 ♗d6 13 0-0 ♗xg3 14 hg ♕e7 15 ♘e5 ♘xe5 16 de ♘d7 17 f4 f6 18 ef ♖xf6 19 e4 e5! (Bronstein-Dzhindzhihashvili, 39th USSR Ch 1971) is unclear.

b22) 7 ♗g3 when:

b221) 7 ... ♗xg3 8 hg ♕d6 9 ♗b5! ± – ECO.

b222) 7 ... ♕e7 8 ♘e5 ♗xe5 9 de ♘d7 10 ♘f3! ± – ECO.

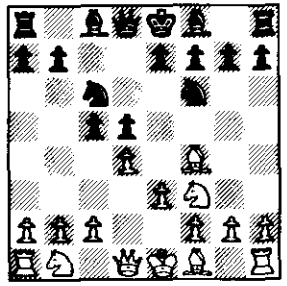
b223) 7 ... 0-0 8 ♗d3 b6 9 ♘e5 ♗b7 10 0-0 (10 f4!?) 10 ... ♕c7 11 f4 ♘e7 12 ♕b1 g6 13 ♗h4 ♘e8 14 ♘g4 f6 15 h3 ♘f5 16 ♗f2 ♖d8 with complications; Winter-Ignatiev, USSR 1970.

b3) 5 ... ♕b6 6 ♕c1!? (6 ♕b3 see A11; 6 ♕c2 ♘c6 7 ♘bd2 ♗d7 = – ECO) 6 ... ♘c6 7 h3 (7 ♗d3 ♗d7 8 0-0 ♖c8 = Marshall-Rubinstein, Lodz 1908) and now:

b31) 7 ... ♗e7 8 ♗d3 0-0 9 0-0 (Vidmar-Rotlevi, Carlsbad 1911) 9 ... ♗d7 followed by ... ♖ac8 and ... ♖fd8 is unclear – ECO.

b32) 7 ... ♗d7 8 ♗e2 ♖c8 9 0-0 ♗e7 10 ♘bd2 0-0 11 ♕b1 ± – Horowitz. Compare chapter 7 (A12) with colours reversed.

c) 4 ... ♕b6!? 5 ♕c1 (5 ♘c3 ♕xb2? 6 ♘b5 but 5 ... c4 6 ♖b1 ♗f5 ∓) 5 ... ♘c6 6 c3 ♗f5 7 ♘bd2 (7 dc?! ♕xc5 8 ♘bd2 ♖c8 ∓ Capablanca-Maroczy, New York 1924) 7 ... cd 8 ed ♖c8 9 ♗e2 e6 10 0-0 ♗e7 11 h3 (11 ♖d1!? intending ♘f1-g3 – ECO) 11 ... 0-0 12 ♖d1 ♖fd8 13 ♘f1 ♘e4 14 ♘g3 ♗xg3 15 ♗xg3 ♘a5 16 ♘h4 ♗e4! 17 f3 ♗g6 18 ♘xg6 hg = Bernstein-Szabo, Groningen 1946.



5 c3

Or 5 ♘c3!? ♗g4 6 ♗b5 e6 7 h3:

a) 7 ... ♗h5?! 8 g4 ♗g6 9 ♘e5 ♕b6 10 a4! a5 11 h4! h5 12 ♘xg6 ± Nimzowitsch-Alekhine, Vilnius 1912.

b) 7 ... ♗xf3 8 ♕xf3 cd 9 ed ♗e7 = – ECO.

5 ... ♕b6

Alternatively:

a) 5 ... g6!? 6 ♘bd2 (6 dc!? – ECO) 6 ... ♕b6 (Kärner-Bronstein, Tallinn 1973) 7 ♕b3! ± – ECO.

b) 5 ... ♗g4 when:

b1) 6 ♘bd2 e6 7 ♕a4 ♗xf3 8 ♘xf3 ♕b6 9 ♖b1 ♗e7 10 ♗d3 0-0 11 0-0 ♖fd8 = Keres-Reshevsky, Kemeri 1937.

b2) 6 ♕b3 ♘a5 7 ♗b5+ ♗d7 8 ♕a4 ♘c4 9 ♘e5 ♘b6 10 ♘xd7! ♘fxd7 (10 ... ♘xa4?? 11 ♘xf6 mate) 11 ♕c2 a6 12 ♗e2 e6 13 0-0 ♖c8 14 ♘d2 ♗e7 15 a4 f6 16 a5 e5 17 de fe 18 ♗h5+ ♔f8 (18 ... g6 19 ♗xg6+) 19 ♗g3 ♘f6 20 ♗f3 e4? 21 ♗e2 ♘a8 22 f3! ef 23 ♖xf3 ♘c7 24 e4! de 25 ♘xe4 ♕d5 26 ♖d1 ♕c6 27 ♗c4 1-0 Napolitano-Bernstein, ½-final 1st World Corres Ch 1947-49.

6 ♕c1?!

For 6 ♕b3 see A11.

6 ... ♗f5

7 ♘h4

Or:

a) 7 dc ♕xc5 8 ♘bd2 ♖c8 9 ♘b3 ♕b6 10 ♕d2 e6 11 ♗d3 ♗e4 ∓ (½:½, 30) Capablanca-Maroczy, New York 1924.

b) 7 ♗e2 e6 intending ... ♖c8 ∓ – Alekhine.

7 ... ♗e4

8 ♘d2 e6

9 f3?! (harmless) 9 ... ♗g6 10 ♘xg6 hg 11 ♘b3? (better 11 ♗g3) 11 ... c4 12 ♘d2 ♘h5 13 ♗e2 ♘xf4 14 ef ♗d6 15 g3 g5! ∓ Watson-Capablanca, London 1922.

A32

3 ... e6

A more conservative plan.

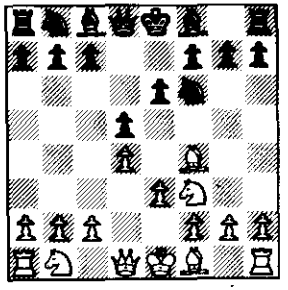
4 e3*(27)*

4 ♘bd2 usually transposes. Now:

A321 4 ... ♗d6

A322 4 ... ♗e7

Or 4 ... c5 (4 ... ♘bd7 should lead to A322) 5 c3 ♘c6 (5 ... ♕b6 see A31) 6 ♘bd2 ♗d6 when:



a) 7 ♗d3? ♗xf4 8 ef cd 9 cd ♕b6 10 ♘b3 a5! – Grünfeld and Becker, in their book of the Teplitz-Schönau 1922 tournament. This occurred half a century later in Timoschenko-Kupreichik, Rostov 1976 and Black won in 40 moves!

b) 7 ♗g3 0-0 (7 ... ♗xg3 8 hg ♕d6 intending ... e5 – Grünfeld and Becker) 8 ♗d3 ♕e7 9 ♘e5 ♗xe5 (0-1, 49) Schlechter-Rotlevi, Carlsbad 1911.

c) 7 ♗xd6 ♕xd6 8 ♗b5 0-0 9 0-0 ♗d7 10 ♕e2 a6 11 ♗xc6 ♗xc6 12 ♘e5 cd 13 ed ♗b5 14 c4 ♗xc4 15 ♘dxc4 dc 16 ♕xc4 ♖ac8 17 ♕d3 ♕c7 (White's IQP is weak.) 18 ♕b3 ♖fd8 19 ♖ad1 b5 20 ♖d3 ♘d5 21 ♖fd1 ♘f4 22 ♖3d2 ♖xd4! (fork on e2 and than back rank mate) Burlyaev-Prokhorovich, Moscow 1973.

A321

4 ... ♗d6

5 ♘bd2

No move is clearly best here. Others that have been tried:

a) 5 ♗xd6 cd 6 c3 ♘c6 7 ♘bd2 0-0 8 ♗e2 e5 and the exchange on d6

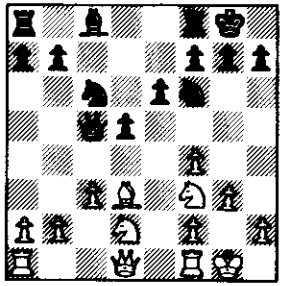
appears to have helped Black; Maroczy-Tartakower, London 1922.
b) 5 ♗g3!? ♘e4 (5 ... a6 or 5 ... ♘bd7 6 ♗d3 = ECO) 6 ♗d3 b6?! (ECO recommends 6 ... ♘d7 with the idea ... ♘xg3, ... h6 and ... e5.) 7 c4 0-0 8 ♘c3 ♗b7 9 ♕c2 f5 10 ♗xd6 ♕xd6 (10 ... cd 11 cd ♘xc3 12 bc ♗xd5 13 e4! ± Neikirkh and Tsvetkov) 11 0-0 c6 12 ♘e5 ♘xc3 13 ♕xc3 ♘bd7 14 ♘xd7 ♕xd7 15 c5 b5 16 a4 ± Makagonov-Kupchik, radio match USSR-USA 1945.
c) 5 c3 ♗xf4 6 ef 0-0 7 ♗d3 ♕d6 8 g3 c5 = – ECO.
d) 5 ♗d3 when:
d1) 5 ... 0-0 6 ♘bd2 ♗xf4 7 ef c5 8 dc ♕c7 9 g3 ♕xc5 10 0-0 ♘c6 11 c3 transposes to diagram 28 below.
d2) 5 ... c5 6 c3 ♘c6 is preferable, according to Grünfeld and Becker.
e) 5 ♘e5 is worth more tests. Two examples:
e1) 5 ... 0-0 6 ♘d2 c5 7 c3 ♘c6 8 ♗d3 ♕c7 9 ♘df3 ♘e4 10 0-0 cd 11 cd f6 12 ♘xc6 ♗xf4 13 ef bc 14 g3 ♕b6 15 ♕e2 c5 16 ♕e3 cd 17 ♘xd4 e5 18 ♘b3 ef 19 ♕xf4 ♘g5 20 ♗f5 (1-0, 41) Sazonov-Hasin, Spartak Club Ch, Kislovodsk 1967.
e2) 5 ... ♘bd7 6 ♗d3 ♘f8 7 ♘d2 ♘g6 8 c4 (8 ♗g3!? – ECO) 8 ... ♗xe5 9 ♗xe5 ♘xe5 10 de ♘d7 11 f4 ♘c5 = Hodzhayev-Blumenfeld, USSR 1931.

5 ... ♗xf4

Alternatively:
a) 5 ... b6 6 ♗d3 ♗b7 7 0-0 0-0 8 c3 c5 9 ♘e5 ♘e4 10 ♖e1 ♗xe5 11 ♗xe5 ♘d7 12 ♗f4 ♘xd2 13 ♕xd2 ± Rubinstein-Cohn, Carlsbad 1907.
b) According to Maroczy, Black could play 5 ... ♕e7, followed by ... ♘bd7 and perhaps ... e5.

6	**ef**	**c5**
7	**dc**	**♕c7**
8	**g3**	**♕xc5**
9	**♗d3**	**♘c6**
10	**c3**	**0-0**
11	**0-0***(28)*	

28 B



11 ... b5

Other tries:
a) Selesniev-Lasker, Mährisch-Ostrau 1923, went **11** ... ♖d8 12 ♕e2 ♕b6 13 ♘b3 ♗d7 14 ♘bd4 ♘xd4 15 ♘xd4 ♖e8 16 ♖fe1 ♖ac8 17 ♖ad1 ±.
b) After **11 ... h6** 12 ♘b3 ♕b6 Black has no real play on the ♕-side. Rubinstein-Tartakower, London 1922, continued 13 ♖e1 ♗d7 14 ♕e2 ♖ac8 15 ♘e5 ♘xe5 16 fe ♘h7 whereupon Maroczy commented, in the tournament book, that 'The position which Black has now attained does not show in an advantageous light the opening chosen by him.' White won in 46 moves, and though Maroczy indicated subsequent improvements for the defence, no doubt White's play could also have been more precise. The text move was introduced by Capablanca in a later round of the same event.

12 ♕e2

Rubinstein-Capablanca went 12 ♘e5 ♗b7 13 ♕e2; Maroczy commenting 'Formerly Rubinstein never played so anxiously'. The draw was agreed on the World Champion's proposal, according to Grünfeld and Becker in their book of Teplitz-Schönau 1922. They remark that this was an error by Rubinstein, not only from the sporting standpoint (his acceptance made first prize certain for Capablanca) but also from a chessic standpoint.

12 ... ♖b8

If 12 ... b4 13 c4 is still ±.

13 b4!

Sämisch-Kostic, Teplitz-Schönau 1922, went instead 13 ♘b3 and the game was drawn in 66 moves.

The text move was recommended by Grünfeld and Becker. They pointed out that 13 ... ♕xc3? is a blunder because of 14 ♖ac1, while 13 ... ♕b6 14 ♘b3 yields White a clear positional advantage, e.g. 14 ... a5 15 a3 ♘d7 16 ♘fd4 ab 17 ab ♗a6 18 ♖fb1 followed by ♘c5! at the right moment. White has a firm grip on the dark squares and Black's bishop is a very poor piece.

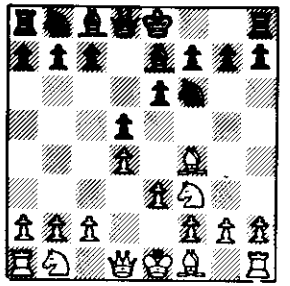
A322

4 ... ♗e7*(29)*

Black intends to preserve his ♔♗ and develop in straightforward fashion.

5 ♘bd2

29 W



5 ♗d3 0-0 (or 5 ... ♘bd7) 6 ♘bd2 ♘bd7 below. Possibly better is 6 ... c5 when 7 c3 transposes to A31.

5 ... c5

Alternatively:
a) 5 ... ♘bd7 6 ♗d3 0-0 and now:
a1) 7 c3!? ♖e8 8 ♕c2 ♘f8 9 ♘e5 ♘6d7 10 ♘df3 (Ufimtsev-Seredenko USSR 1970) 10 ... f6!? ± or 10 ... c5 ± – ECO.
a2) 7 ♘e5! ♖e8 8 ♕f3 ♘f8 9 g4 ♘g6 10 g5 ♘xe5 11 ♗xe5 ♘d7 12 ♗xh7+! ♔xh7 13 ♕xf7 ♘xe5 14 ♕h5+ ♔g8 15 de ±± Brameyer-Dietze, E.German Ch 1971.
a3) 7 h4!? ♖e8 8 g4 ♘f8 9 g5 ♘6d7 10 ♘e5 ♗d6 11 g6!? (11 h5 – Rabar, *Informator 4*) 11 ... hg (11 ... ♘xg6 12 ♕h5!) 12 h5?! (Rabar preferred 12 ♘df3.) 12 ... ♗xe5? (Rabar's 12 ... g5! 13 ♖g1 f6 would give an unclear position.) 13 de g5 14 ♖g1! f6 (14 ... gf!? 15 ♕g4 g6 16 hg f5! was the last chance – Rabar.) 15 ef gf 16 ♘f3 ♖e7 17 ♘xg5 ♖g7 18 h6 ♖xg5 19 ♗xg5 fg 20 ♕h5 ♕e7 21 ♖xg5+ ♔h8 22 ♖g7 ♕f6 23 0-0-0 ♕xf2 24 ♕g5 1-0 Rakic-Marovic, Yugoslavia 1967.

b) 5 ... b6 6 ♗d3 c5 7 c3 0-0 8 ♘e5 below.

6 c3 0-0

Stadler-Aronson, Subbotica 1967, went instead 6 ... ♘c6 7 ♗d3 b6 8 h3 ♗b7 9 0-0 a5? (Simply 9 ... 0-0 is better – Maric, *Informator 4*.) 10 ♘e5 ♘xe5 11 ♗xe5 ♗d6? 12 ♗b5+ ♔e7 13 f4 ± (1-0, 30).

7 ♗d3 ♘bd7

7 ... b6 allows 8 ♘e5 ♗b7 (8 ... ♗a6?! 9 ♘c6! ± – Hort) 9 ♕f3 e.g.: a) 9 ... ♘bd7 10 ♕h3 g6 11 ♗h6 ♖e8 12 f4 and Black has little counterplay against White's ♔-side pressure. Rakic-Cvetkovic, Yugoslavia 1968, went on 12 ... c4 13 ♗c2 b5 14 ♘df3 ♘xe5 15 fe ♘e4 16 0-0 f5 17 ef ♗xf6 18 ♘e5 ♗xe5 19 de ♕c7 20 ♗xe4 de 21 ♖f6 ♕e5 22 ♖af1 ♖ad8 23 ♕g4 (threatens 24 ♖xg6+ hg 25 ♕xg6+ ♔h8 26 ♖f7) 23 ... ♕c7 24 ♕xe6+! 1-0 (24 ... ♔h8 25 ♕xe8+ ♖xe8 26 ♖f8+).

b) 9 ... ♘c6 is only a slight improvement. White continues with his attack in the same way, but Black at least has d7 as a retreat square for his other knight at move 12; Pribyl-Penrose, Nice 1974 (1-0, 38).

8 ♘e5!?*(30)*

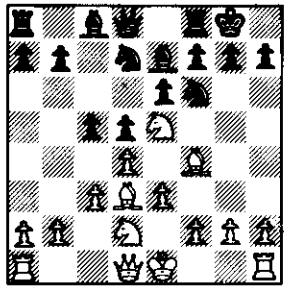
Just the same! This is probably better than:

a) 8 g4?! ♘xg4 9 h3 ♘gf6 10 ♘e5 ♘e8 11 ♕c2 f5 (0-1, 40) Rakic-Janosevic, Novi Sad 1973.

b) or 8 h4!? ♖e8 9 g4 cd 10 cd ♗b4 11 ♕c2 ♘f8 12 g5 ♘e4 13 a3 ♘xd2 14 ♘xd2 ♗d6 15 ♗xd6 ♕xd6 16 f4 ♗d7 17 h5 ♕b6 18 h6 g6 (½:½, 37) Rakic-Bikhovsky, Belgrade 1967.

c) However 8 ♕e2 is worth considering, Black's choice then resting between 8 ... b6 (when ♗a6 by White is in the air) and 8 ... ♘h5 (9 ♘g5!?). A good example of how Black should not play such positions was given by Spielmann, who should have known better, at Baden-Baden 1925. He played 8 ... c4? and Tarrasch immediately seizes the initiative in the centre by 9 ♗c2 b5 10 e4 de 11 ♘xe4 ♗b7 12 0-0 (It is not clear whether 12 ♘d6!? is better.) 12 ... ♘xe4 13 ♗xe4 ♗xe4 14 ♕xe4 ♘f6 15 ♕e2 ± (Black's ♕-side pawns are weak.) and 1-0 in 40 moves.

30
B



8 ... ♘xe5
9 ♗xe5 b6
10 ♕f3 ♗b7

Once again, because of the blocked centre, White has good prospects of ♔-side attack, and if Black defends weakly the game will not last long. Jovanovic-Baumstarck, women's zonal, Karlovy Vary 1975, continued 11 ♕g3 ♘e8 12 ♕h3 g6 13 ♘f3 ♗f6 14 ♕h6. Now White threatens simply h2-h4 followed by ♘f3-g5 and mate on h7. So Black is

reduced to desperation; she played 14 ... ♗xe5 15 ♘g5 ♕xg5 16 ♕xg5 ♗g7 and White won in 31 moves.

B

1 d4 ♘f6
2 ♘f3

2 ♗f4 looks premature. Ribeiro-Seret, Nice 1974, continued 2 ... e6 3 e3 c5 4 c3 ♗e7 5 ♘bd2 b6 6 ♘gf3 0-0 7 ♗d3 cd 8 cd ♗a6 with a good game for Black.

2 ... e6

Or 2 ... b6 (compare chapter 4) 3 ♗f4 ♗b7 4 ♘bd2 c5 5 e3 e6 6 ♗d3 ♗e7 7 h3 cd 8 ed ♘c6 9 c3 d6 10 ♕e2 ♕c7 11 0-0-0 a6 12 ♔b1 b5 13 ♘e4 (1-0, 41) Tarrasch-Reti, Semmering 1926. For 2 ... g6 3 ♗f4 see chapter 6.

3 ♗f4 c5

3 ... d5 transposes to A32.

Black's best policy may be to follow Bleiman-Korchnoi, Beersheva 1978: 3 ... b6 4 e3 ♗b7 5 h3 d6 6 ♘bd2 ♘bd7 7 ♗h2 ♕e7 8 a4 c5 9 ♗b5 g6 10 0-0 ♗h6 11 ♕e2 0-0 12 ♖fd1 ♘d5 = (0-1, 40 after ups and downs). Note, however, that by 4 or 5 c4 White can transpose into the irregular variation of the Queen's Indian Defence with which Miles twice defeated Spassky in 1978. (1 d4 ♘f6 2 c4 e6 3 ♘f3 b6 4 ♗f4 ♗b7 5 e3 ♗e7 6 h3 0-0 7 ♘c3 d5 8 cd ed 9 ♗d3 c5 10 0-0 ♘c6 11 ♘e5 ±).

4 c3

4 e3 cd (4 ... ♘f6 see A) 5 ed ♘c6 6 c3 ♗e7 7 ♗d3 d5 (e.g. Georgadze-Blatny, Decin 1975) is a transposition to the Exchange Variation of the Caro-Kann: 1 e4 c6 2 d4 d5 3 ed cd 4 c3 ♘c6 5 ♗f4 etc.

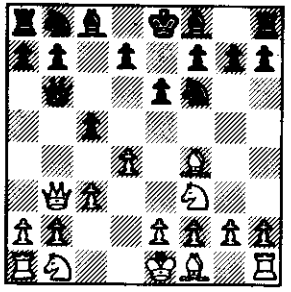
4 ... ♕b6

Against other moves White builds up much as in A, with e3, ♘bd2, ♗d3 etc.

5 ♕b3!*(31)*

Bronstein's move, which improves upon 5 ♕c2 cd 6 cd ♘c6 7 e3 ♗d7 8 ♘c3 ♖c8 9 ♗e2 ♘f6 10 0-0 ♗e7 = von Scheve-Tarrasch, Dresden 1892.

31
B



Now Black can double the white b-pawn, giving White control of the a-file, or face the possibility of ♕xb6. White is rather better placed to exploit a doubled b-pawn because of his lead in development.

5 ... ♘d5

This is an ingenious attempt to resolve the dilemma. 5 ... ♕xb3 6 ab cd would be answered by 7 ♘xd4 Δ 8 ♘b5.

Another example is the game Bronstein-Farago, Moscow-Budapest match 1971: 5 ... ♘c6 6 e3 ♕xb3 7 ab b6 8 h3 ♗e7 9 dc bc 10 ♗b5 ♗b7 11 ♘bd2 a6 12 ♗a4 ♘d5 13 ♗h2 ♘b6 14 ♘c4 ♘xc4 15 bc d6 16 0-0-0 0-0-0 17 ♗c2 ♘b8 18 e4 e5 19 b3 g6 20 ♘d2 ♗g5 21 ♖hf1 ♗f4

22 g3 ♗h6 23 f4 ♘c6 24 ♔b2 ef 25 gf (Bronstein has been consistently capturing towards the centre.) 25 ... ♗g7 26 e5 de 27 f5! ♖d7 (27 ... gf 28 ♗xf5+ ♔b8 29 ♘e4) 28 ♘e4 ♖hd8 29 ♖xd7 ♖xd7 30 ♘xc5 ♖c7 31 ♘e4 ♖d7 32 ♗g1 ♗h6 33 c5 ♗f4 34 ♘d6+ ♔c7 35 b4 ♘e7 36 f6 ♘g8 37 ♘xb7 ♔xb7 38 c6+! (the *coup de grace*) 38 ... ♔xc6 39 ♗a4+ ♔c7 40 ♗xd7 ♔xd7 41 ♖a1 ♘xf6 42 ♖xa6 ♘d5 43 b5 e4 44 c4 ♘c7 45 ♖a7 e3 46 b6 1-0.

With 5 ... ♘d5 we follow Bronstein-Averbakh, 32nd USSR Ch 1964-65. The notes are based on those by Mikenas in the tournament bulletin:

6	♗g3	f5

This move is consistent with the previous one, as it prevents e4 and so maintains central position of the knight. The drawback is that it gives control of e5 to White and makes the development of the ♗c8 even more difficult.

7	e3	♘c6
8	♗c4	

This is a good continuation, forcing the exchange of queens under favourable circumstances.

8	...	♘a5
9	♕xb6	♘xb6
10	♗e2	♘c6
11	♘bd2	d5

Black hopes to give the position a blocked, drawish character. However, as in the preceding game against Farago, Bronstein instructively makes use of his long-term advantages – better bishops and control of e5....

12	0-0	♗d7
13	dc	♗xc5
14	c4!	dc
15	♘xc4	♘xc4
16	♗xc4	♗e7

16 ... 0-0 17 ♖fd1 ♗c8 18 ♖ac1 ±

17	♖ad1	♖d8
18	h4	

With the idea of 19 ♘g5.

18	...	♗c8

18 ... h6 is met by 19 h5 with the threat of 20 ♘h4!

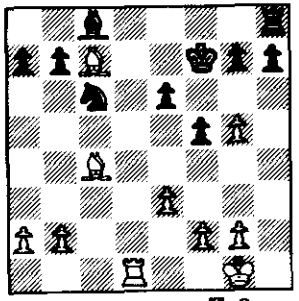
19	♖xd8+	♗xd8
20	♖d1	♗f6

20 ... h6 21 h5 ♔f7 22 ♘h4! ♗xh4 23 ♗xh4 is also very difficult for Black.

21	♘g5	♗xg5
22	hg	♔f7
23	♗c7*(32)*	

This prevents Black from playing ... ♖d8. White's advantage consists in his two good bishops against a bad bishop and a knight, whose sphere of action is severely circumscribed. The realisation of this superiority was surprisingly swift.

32 B



23	...	♖e8
24	f4	♖e7
25	♗d6	♖d7
26	♔f2	♖d8

Up to now Black has defended well, but here he chose the wrong plan. 26 ... a6 was better, so that 27 g4 could be met by 27 ... ♘a5 28 ♗e2 b5.

27	g4	fg

Here 27 ... g6 was a better defence, enabling Averbakh to answer 28 gf gf 29 ♗e2 or 29 e4 by 29 ... ♔g6!

28	♔g3	b6

28 ... g6 was still better.

29	f5	

Threatening 30 fe+ ♗xe6 31 ♖f1+.

29	...	♘e5
30	♗b3	b5
31	fe+	♗xe6
32	♗xe5	♖xd1
33	♗xd1	1-0

Summary

The London (♗f4) system has not yet been investigated as deeply as the Colle, but it appears to offer White more chances than the latter of outplaying strong opposition. The best methods for both sides may still be awaiting discovery. For the time being, the relative rarity of the opening is a great argument in its favour from White's point of view. In the next chapter I show how it can also be used against ... g6 as well as ... e6.

6 London v. King's Indian (...g6)

When White avoids c4 against the King's Indian Defence, and develops his queen's bishop to f4, Black is often inclined to take his task too lightly. Yet the London System is a major line against the Reti Opening, and here White has it with an extra tempo! Grandmasters sometimes employ the London when they hope to take their opponent out of 'the books' but, as this chapter shows, some of the variations have in fact been investigated well into the middle-game.

1	d4	♘f6
2	♘f3	g6
3	♗f4	

The characteristic introductory move of the London System. 3 c3 is sometimes played first but there is no need to sacrifice flexibility so early, since there is no immediate threat against d4.

The Pseudo-London System, 3 ♘c3 d5 4 ♗f4, will be discussed separately at the end of this chapter.

3 ... ♗g7*(33)*

Black in turn awaits developments, although more committal plans are also sometimes seen:

a) 3 ... d5 4 e3 and now:

a1) 4 ... c5 5 ♘bd2 (5 ♗e2!?) 5 ... ♘c6 is a sort of reversed Catalan; after 6 ♗e2 or 6 ♗d3 compare B below. Even 6 ♗b5!? has some point, but not 6 dc? ♕a5 7 ♗e2 ♗g7 8 c3 ♕xc5 9 ♘e5 0-0 10 h4?! ♕b6 11 ♘b3 ♗e6 12 h5 ♘e4 13 ♘f3 a5 14 ♕c1 ♗d7 15 hg hg 16 ♘fd2 e5 ∓ (0-1, 39) Thelen-Sajtar, Prague 1943.

a2) 4 ... ♗g7 5 h3 (better 5 ♘bd2 see B) 5 ... 0-0 6 ♗e2 c6!? 7 c3 ♗f5 8 ♘bd2 ♘bd7 9 ♘e5 ♘e8! 10 ♘df3 ♘xe5 11 ♗xe5 f6 12 ♗h2 ♘d6 13 ♕b3 ♕d7 14 ♗xd6 ed 15 0-0 ♖ae8 16 c4 dc 17 ♗xc4 d5 18 ♗d3 ♗e6 = Besser-Hort, Halle 1967.

b) 3 ... c5 when:

b1) 4 c3 will often transpose to lines considered below. An exception was Lasker-Alekhine, New York 1924, which continued 4 ... b6 (4 ... ♗g7 5 dc!? Bronstein-Westerinen, Tallinn 1973; or 5 e3) 5 ♘bd2 (better 5 e3 – Alekhine) 5 ... cd! 6 cd ♗b7 7 e3 ♗g7 8 ♗d3 0-0 9 0-0 ♘c6 10 h3 d6 11 ♕e2 a6 12 ♖fd1 ♕b8 13 ♗h2 ♕a7 14 a3 ♖ac8 15 ♖ac1 b5 = (½:½, 30).

b2) 4 dc ♕a5+ 5 ♘c3 ♕xc5 (5 ... ♘e4 6 ♗e5 f6 7 ♗d4 is unclear – Gheorghiu, *Chess Player 4*) 6 e4 ♗g7 7 ♘d2! d6 8 ♘b3 ♕b6 9 ♗e2 ♘bd7 10 0-0 0-0 11 ♗e3 ♕c7 12 f3 a6 13 a4 b6 14 ♘c1 ♗b7 15 ♘1a2 ♘e5 16 ♖c1 ± (1-0, 49) Taimanov-Spiridonov, Malaga 1973.

c) 3 ... ♘h5?! 4 ♗g5! (Franklin) e.g. 4 ... h6 5 ♗h4 g5 6 ♗g3 ♗g7 7 e3 c5 8 ♘bd2 d6 9 ♗c4 ♘c6 10 c3 f5?! 11 ♘e5 ♘xg3 12 ♘xc6 bc 13 hg; obtaining the two bishops is not worth the light square weaknesses Black incurs thereby.

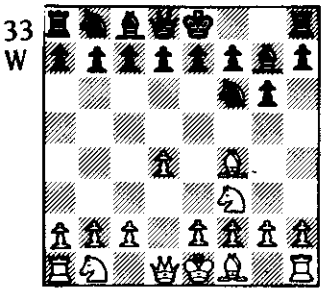
d) In *The King's Indian Defence*, Barden says that if 3 ... d6, White must play 4 h3 (see below) if he wants to maintain his dark-squared bishop. However, 4 e3 is playable. Franklin-Gligoric, Hastings 1971-2, continued 4 ... ♘h5 5 ♗g5 h6 6 ♗h4 g5 7 ♘fd2 ♘g7 8 ♗g3 ♘f5 9 ♗d3 ♘xg3 10 hg ♗g7 and Franklin said he obtained a good opening. However, somewhere in the next few moves he lost his way: 11 c3 ♘d7 12 ♘f3 ♘f6 13 ♘bd2 c6 14 ♕c2 ♕c7 15 ♗f5 (15 e4! – Gligoric) 15 ... ♗xf5 16 ♕xf5 e6 17 ♕c2 0-0-0 18 0-0-0 ♔b8 19 ♔b1 c5! ∓ (0-1, 57).

A 4 c3

B 4 ♘bd2

C 4 e3

Move-order is quite flexible in the early stages so the reader should watch out for transpositions. The main questions are: does White play h3?; does he play ♘bd2?; does he play c3?; does Black play ... d5?



4 ♘c3 transposes to the Pseudo-London System. 4 h3 is premature, and Black might possibly reply 4 ... c5!?

A

4 c3

The objection to this move is that it wastes a tempo. White should not play this unless it is really necessary.

4 ... b6!?

More usual is 4 ... d6 which would transpose to B or C.

5	e3	♗b7
6	♗e2	

Or 6 ♘bd2 c5 (6 ... d6 7 h3 see C11.) 7 h3 0-0 8 ♗e2 d6 9 0-0 ♘c6 = Smyslov-Geller, USSR Teams Ch 1961. Or 8 ♗c4 d5 9 ♗d3 ♘bd7 10 0-0 ♘e4 (Belavenets-Smyslov, Moscow-Leningrad 1939) but the immediate 8 ♗d3 may be better.

6	...	d6
7	h3	0-0
8	0-0	♘bd7

9 a4 a6 10 ♗h2 e6 11 ♕b3 ♕e7 12 ♖d1 e5 (12 ... ♖fd8 – Yudovich, *Informator 4*) 13 de de 14 ♕a3! c5 (14 ... ♖fe8 – Yudovich) 15 ♘bd2 e4 16 ♘e1 ♘e5 17 ♘c4 ♘xc4 18 ♗xc4 and White has pressure; Sorokin-Antoshin, USSR 1967.

B

4 ♘bd2

The move I favour. It keeps Black guessing whether White might play e2-e4.

4 ... d5!? *(34)*

Others:

a) **4 ... c5!?** 5 c3 (5 e3! below) 5 ... cd 6 cd 0-0 7 e3 ♘c6 8 h3 d6 9 ♗c4 ♗f5 10 0-0 ♖c8 = Keres-Gheorghiu, Varna 1962.

b) **4 ... 0-0** and now:

b1) **5 e3** *d6 transposes to C.* This may well be White's most precise move-order in the London System.

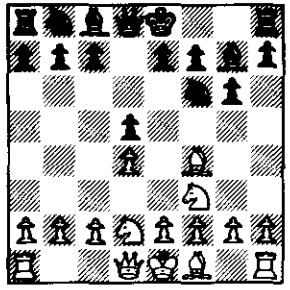
b2) **5 c3** ♘h5!? (5 ... d6 see C; if 6 h3 c5) 6 ♗e5! f6 7 g4! fe 8 gh ed 9 cd! gh (9 ... c5 10 hg cd 11 gh+ ♔h8 12 ♘h4 ♕b6 13 ♖g1 – Neistadt and Fridstein) 10 e3 d5 11 ♗d3 ♗f5 (11 ... c5!? 12 ♘g5 ♗g4) 12 ♗xf5 ♖xf5 13 ♘h4 ♖f6 (or 13 ... ♖g5 14 ♘df3 ♖g4 15 h3 ♖e4 16 ♘f5 with a strong white attack) 14 ♕xh5 e6 15 ♖g1 c5 16 ♘df3 ♘d7 17 0-0-0 ♖c8 18 ♔b1 ♖c7 19 ♖xg7+! ♔xg7 20 ♖g1+ ♔h8 21 ♘e5 (21 ♘g6+ is also possible.) 21 ... ♘xe5 22 de ♖f5 23 ♘xf5 ef 24 ♕xf5 ♖g7 25 ♖d1 ♖g5 26 ♕f4 ♖g6 27 h4 ♖b6 28 ♕f7 d4 29 e6 ♕g8 30 ♕f6+ ♕g7 31 ♕d8 ♕g8 32 e7 ♖e6 33 ♖g1! 1-0 Bronstein-Kots, 29th USSR Ch 1961.

b3) **5 e4** d6 6 c3 (6 ♗d3 Watson-Euwe, London 1922; 6 ♗e2 Quinteros-Uhlmann, Leningrad 1973) and now:

b31) **6 ... ♘bd7** 7 ♗c4 c6 8 0-0 ♘xe4 9 ♘xe4 d5 = Keres-Matulovic, USSR-Yugoslavia 1961.

b32) **6 ... ♘c6** *is inferior:* 7 ♗b5 (or 7 ♗c4 ♗g4 8 d5!? Bronstein-Hug, quick-play match 1975) 7 ... ♘d7 8 0-0 e5 9 ♗g5 ♕e8 10 ♖c1! a6 11 ♗a4 ♘b6 12 ♗b3 ♗g4 13 h3! ♗xf3 14 ♘xf3 ed 15 cd ♕xe4 16 d5 ± Keres-Polugayevsky, 26th USSR Ch 1959.

c) **4 ... d6** 5 e4 (5 e3 see C) 5 ... c6 (simpler 5 ... 0-0: Modern Defence) 6 h3 0-0 7 ♗d3 ♘bd7 8 0-0 ♘h5 9 ♗e3 e5 10 c3 ♘f4 11 ♗xf4 ef 12 ♖a1 ♖e8 13 ♘c4 ♘b6 14 ♘a5 h6 15 b4 ♕e7 16 ♗c2 ♗e6 17 ♕d2 g5 18 ♕d3 d5 19 e5 (1-0, 34) Spassky-Zilberman, USSR Spartakiad 1975.



5 e3

Best, *in view of:*

a) 5 c3 0-0 6 e3 b6 7 h3 c5 8 ♗d3 ♗b7 9 0-0 ♘c6 10 ♕b1 ♘d7 11 ♗g5 ♕b8 12 b4 e5 (centre counter to wing attack) 13 bc?! (13 ♗b5 f6 14 ♗h4 ♕d6 or 14 ... a6 is also good for Black.) 13 ... e4 14 c4 ef (14 ... ed? 15 cd threatening 16 c6) 15 cd fg 16 ♖c1 ♘xd4! 17 c6?! (17 ed bc!? 18 ♘c3 or 17 ... ♗xd4 18 c6 is still a bit unclear.) 17 ... ♘xc6 18 bc ♗xc6 19 ♗f4 ♕b7 20 ♘e4 ♘e5 21 ♗xe5 ♗xe5 22 ♕b4 ♖ad8 23 ♗c2 a5 0-1 Larsen-Olafsson, Berg en Dal 1960. More material is lost.

b) 5 **h3** 0-0 6 e3 c5 (6 ... ♘bd7 7 c4!) 7 c3 b6 8 ♗d3 ♗b7 (8 ... ♗a6!? 9 ♗xa6 ♘xa6 10 ♕a4 ±) 9 ♘e5 ♘fd7 10 ♘df3 ♘c6 (10 ... f6 11 ♘xg6!?) 11 h4 cd (11 ... f6!?) 12 ♘xc6 ♗xc6 13 cd ± Spielmann-Prins, Sitges 1934.

5 ... 0-0

Or 5 ... c5 6 c3:

a) **6 ... ♕b6?!** 7 ♕b3! 0-0 8 ♕xb6 ab 9 ♗c7 ♘fd7 10 ♗b5 ♘a5 11 ♗g3 ± Bronstein-Bertok, Vinkovci 1970.

b) ECO suggests **6 ... ♘bd7** 7 ♗d3 0-0, intending ... b6, ... ♗b7 =.

6 ♗d3

Alternatively:

a) **6 h3** see note b above.

b) **6 c4!?** possibly?

c) **6 ♗e2** (e2 is probably a better square than d3 for this piece) 6 ... c5 7 0-0 ♘bd7 (7 ... cd?! 8 ed ♘c6 9 c3 ♘h5 10 ♗e3 ♕e7 11 ♖e1 ♗g4 12 ♘b3 ∞ though White won in Keres-Bronstein, 26th USSR Ch 1959) 8 c3 b6 9 h3 ♗b7 10 ♘e5 e6 (or 10 ... ♘xe5 11 ♗xe5 ♘d7 = Doda-Hamann, Lugano 1968) 11 ♘xd7 ♕xd7 12 ♗e5 ♖fc8 13 ♕e1 ♗c6 14 f4 ♗b5 = Flatow-Byrne, Lugano 1968.

6 ... c5

Other tries:

a) **6 ... ♘bd7** 7 c3 b6 8 ♘e5 ♗b7 9 h4!? ♘h5! 10 g4 ♘xf4 11 ef ♘xe5 12 fe f6 13 h5? (13 f4 = ECO) 13 ... fe 14 hg e4 ∓ Safvat-Badilles, Moscow 1956.

b) **6 ... b6** 7 c3 ♗b7 8 ♕e2 c5 9 0-0 ♘c6 10 ♘e5 ♘h5 11 ♘xc6 ♘xf4 12 ef ♗xc6 = Kulzinski-Andric, Yugoslav Ch 1948-9.

7 c3 ♘c6

Other ideas include:

a) 7 ... **♕b6** 8 ♖b1 ♘c6 9 h3 ♖e8 10 0-0 ♗f5 11 ♗xf5 gf 12 ♘e5 ± Bisguier-Bertok, Leipzig 1960.

b) 7 ... **♘bd7** 8 h4! ♖e8 9 h5 ♘xh5 10 ♖xh5 gh 11 ♗xh7+ ♔f8 (11 ... ♔xh7 12 ♘g5+ ♔g6 13 ♘df3) 12 ♘e5 ♘xe5 13 de ♗g4 14 f3 ♗d7 15 ♘f1 e6 16 ♘g3 h4 17 ♘h5 h3 18 g4 ♕h4+ 19 ♗g3 h2 20 ♔f2 ♕h3 21 ♕h1 ♗b5 22 ♗xh2 ±± McAlpine-McCurdy, Student Olympiad, Orebro 1966.

c) 7 ... **b6!?** was an old Barden recommendation. Gulko-Vaganian, Niksic 1978, continued 8 a4 ♗a6 9 ♗xa6 ♘xa6 10 0-0 ♕c8 11 ♕e2 ♕b7 12 h3 ♖fd8 13 ♖fe1 ♖ac8 14 ♗e5 ♘b8! (intending ... ♘c6) 15 e4 cd 16 ♗xd4 de 17 ♘xe4 ♘xe4 18 ♕xe4 ♕xe4 19 ♖xe4 ♘c6! = (19 ... ♗xd4? 20 ♘xd4 e6 21 a5) ½:½.

8 0-0 ±

Here Black has tried:

a) **8 ... ♘d7** 9 ♗b5 ♗d6 10 ♕a4 a6 11 ♗xc6 bc 12 b4 c4 13 e4 ♘f6 14 ♘e5 ♕b5 15 ♕xb5 cb 16 a4 ♗b7 17 f3 ± Kan-Cherepkov, ½-final 17th USSR Ch 1949.

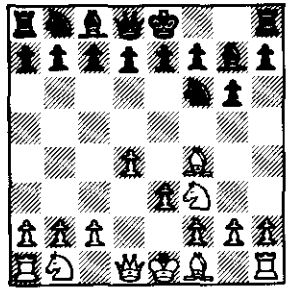
b) **8 ... ♘h5** 9 ♗g4 ♕d6 10 dc ♕xc5 11 e4 ♘f6 12 h3 de 13 ♘xe4 ♘xe4

14 ♗xe4 ♗e6 15 ♕a4 ♗c4 16 ♗e3 ♕b5 17 ♕xb5 ♗xb5 18 ♖fd1 ♖fd8 19 ♖xd8+ ♘xd8 20 ♖d1 (1-0, 41) Belyavsky-Faibisovich, Leningrad Club Ch 1967.

C

4 e3*(35)*

35
B



C1 4 ... 0-0
C2 4 ... d6

Or 4 ... c5 5 c3 0-0 6 ♘bd2 ♘c6!? (6 ... d6 or 6 ... b6) 7 dc! h6 8 h3 ♕a5 9 ♗g3 ♕a4 10 ♗e2 b6!? 11 0-0 ♗a6 12 cb ab 13 ♖e1 ♗xe2 14 ♕xe2 g5 15 ♗e5 (or 15 ♗h2 g4 16 hg ♘xg4 17 ♗g3 ± Gheorghiu) 15 ... ♘xe5 16 ♘xe5 de 17 ♘d4! ♘e4 18 ♘ec6 e6 19 ♕b5! ♕xb5 20 ♘xb5 ♘f6 21 f3 ♘d2 22 e4 de 23 fe ♘c4 24 e5! ±± *Voiculescu-Puscasu*, Romanian Ch 1974.

C1

4 . . . 0-0
5 ♘bd2

Spassky-Bukic, Bugojno 1978, featured a novel plan for White: 5 ♗e2 d6 6 0-0 ♘bd7 7 h3 ♕e8 8 c4!? e5 9 ♗h2 ♕e7 10 ♘c3 e4 11 ♘d2 ♖e8 12 ♘b5 ♕d8 13 c5. Spassky now sacrificed a piece by 13 ... a6 14 cd! and eventually won. See the game in Chapter 1, p. 1.

5 ♘bd2 is still the most flexible choice otherwise. Lines without ♘bd2 are discussed in C2 if Black replies ... d6. If instead he chooses ... d5 see these examples:

a) 5 c3 d5 6 ♗d3 ♘c6 7 ♘e5 ♘xe5 8 ♗xe5 c6 9 ♘d2 ♗e6 10 0-0 ♕d7 = Spiridonov-Malich, Zinnowitz 1967.

b) 5 ♗c4 d5 6 ♗b3 c5 7 c3 b6 8 0-0 ♘c6 Volynskaya-Dimshits, Leningrad Cup 1972.

c) 5 h3 c5 (5 ... b6, see below) 6 c3 and now:

c1) 6 ... d5 (6 ... b6!?) 7 ♘bd2 b6 8 b4 ♘e4 9 ♘xe4 de 10 ♘d2 ♗b7 11 bc bc is unclear, or even favours Black, Hindle-Taulbut, London 1975.

c2) 6 ... d6 7 ♗d3 b6 8 0-0 ♗b7 9 ♕e2 ♘e4 10 ♕c2 d5 11 ♘bd2 (Chiburdanidze suggested 11 ♗xe4 de 12 ♘g5.) 11 ... ♘d6 12 ♖fe1 ♘d7 13 ♘e5 ♖c8 14 ♗h2 ♘f6 15 ♖ad1 b5 16 dc?! ♖xc5 17 ♘b3 ♖c8 18 ♕e2 ♕b6 ∓ (0-1, 46) Kushnir-Chiburdanidze, Candidates 1978.

c3) 6 ... cd 7 cd ♘c6 8 h3? (O'Kelly suggested 8 ♗e2 ♘h5 9 ♗e3 with the threat 10 d5, in his book on Petrosian.) 8 ... d6 9 ♘c4?! b5! 10 ♘e3 b4 11 d5 (11 c4 d5 ∓) 11 ... bc!! ∓ Kotov-Petrosian, Moscow 1952.

5 . . . d6*(36)*

This is the main London System pattern. However, 5 ... b6 is also possible, e.g.:

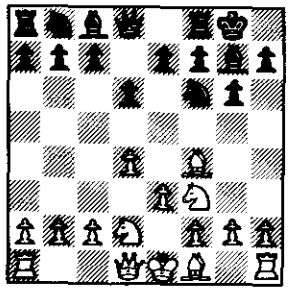
a) 6 c3 c5 7 h3 d6 8 ♗e2 ♗a6 9 ♗xa6 ♘xa6 10 0-0 ♕d7 11 ♕e2 ♘c7 12 dc bc 13 e4 e5 (0-1, 32) Bondarevsky-Bronstein, 31st USSR Ch 1963.

b) 6 ♗e2 ♗b7 7 0-0 c5 8 c3 d6 9 h3 ♘c6 (9 ... ♘bd7!? 10 a4 a6 11 ♘c4 ♕c7 is unclear - Taimanov, *Chess Player 9.*) 10 a4 a6 (10 ... ♕c7 intending ... ♖ad8) 11 ♗h2 h6?! (11 ... ♕c7 intending ... e5) 12 ♖e1 ♖c8 13 ♗f1 d5?! 14 ♖b1! ♘e8 15 ♘b3! ± (1-0, 44) Taimanov-Lechtynsky, Decin 1975.

c) 6 h3 c5 7 c3 ♗b7 8 ♗d3 (8 ♗e2 is not much better.) 8 ... d6 (or 8 ... d5!? Slujssar-Karpov, Caracas 1970) 9 ♕e2 ♘c6 10 0-0 ♕c7 11 ♗a6 ♗xa6 12 ♕xa6 e5 13 de de 14 ♗h2 ♖ad8 15 ♖ad1 ♖d5 16 e4 ♖d7 17 ♕e2 ♖fd8 18 ♖fe1 ♕d6 ∓ Gasic-Szabo, Sarajevo 1972.

In most of these examples Black did well. However, White should perhaps not play h3 and should *probably develop his king's bishop* on c4 (though Black's delaying ... d6 makes this a riskier proposition).

36
W



C11 6 h3
C12 6 c3
C13 6 ♗c4

C11

6 h3 c5!?

It is natural to react vigorously to a slow move like h3, but perhaps Black should seek his counterplay in a different way? Consider:

a) 6 ... ♕e8 7 ♗h2 ♘fd7 8 ♗c4 ♘c6 9 0-0 e5 10 de ♘dxe5 (The pawn recapture might leave Black's position congested.) 11 ♘xe5 ♘xe5 12 ♗b3 ♗e6 13 ♘f3 ♘xf3+ 14 ♕xf3 ♕b5 and Black had the initiative; Franklin-Alexander, British Ch 1956.

b) 6 ... ♘c6 7 ♗h2 (7 c3 or 7 ♗b5 would be more positive.) 7 ... ♕e8 8 ♗e2 e5 9 de ♘xe5 is at least equal for Black; Smyslov-Gligoric, Venice 1957.

c) 6 ... ♘bd7 7 c3 c5 below. Maybe 6 ... ♘fd7!?

d) 6 ... b6 7 c3 see C12.

7 ♗e2

A *major alternative is* 7 c3 ♘c6 8 ♗c4. As Maroczy wrote in the London 1922 tournament book: 'By *far the best square for the* bishop. If Black now plays ... d5, White's QB's diagonal is cleared of all obstacles. On the other hand ... e5 leaves the KB in his strong position.' Examples:

a) 8 ... ♖e8 9 0-0 e5 10 de:

a1) 10 ... ♘xe5? 11 ♗xe5! de 12 ♘g5! ♗e6 (rather better is 12 ... ♖f8 13 ♘de4! ♕xd1 14 ♖fxd1 ♘e4 15 ♘xe4 b6 - Alekhine) 13 ♗xe6 ± Alekhine-Euwe, London 1922.

a2) 10 ... de 11 ♗h2 ± (because there is a hole at d5) - Alekhine.

b) 8 ... ♕e8 9 ♗h2 e5 10 de de 11

♗b5 ♘d7 12 ♘e4 ♕e6 13 ♕d6 ♕xd6 14 ♘xd6 ♘db8 15 0-0-0 b6 16 ♗c4 ♗d7 17 ♗d5 ♗e6 18 ♗xe6 fe 19 ♘b5 ♘a6 20 ♖d6 ♘d8 ± Kan-Kamyshov, ½-final 17th USSR Ch 1949.

c) **8 ... ♘d7** (Alekhine) 9 d5 (9 0-0 e5) 9 ... ♘ce5 10 ♗e2 ♘b6 11 ♕b3 ♘xf3+ 12 gf e5 (12 ... e6!?) 13 ♗g3 f5 14 f4 ♕e8 15 a4 e4 16 ♗h4 ♖f7 17 a5 ♘d7 18 ♗b5 ♕f8 19 ♘c4 ♘f6 20 a6 ♖b8 21 ♗c6 b5 22 ♖a5 b4 23 ♘e5!? (1-0, 38) Rupp-Arseniev, Ist ICCF Cup corres.

d) **8 ... a6** 9 a4 cd 10 ed?! (or cd ♗f5 =) 10 ... ♖b8 11 0-0 b5 ∓ - Boleslavsky.

7	...	**♘c6**
8	**dc!**	

A noteworthy improvement upon the unambitious 8 ♗h2. Smyslov-Boleslavsky, Zurich 1953, continued 8 ... cd 9 ed ♗d7 10 0-0 ♖c8 11 ♖e1 a6 12 ♗f1 b5 13 c3 ♘a5 14 ♘g5 ♖e8 15 ♘ge4 ♘xe4 16 ♘xe4 ♘c4 17 ♖b1 ½:½.

8	...	**dc**
9	**♘c4**	**♘d5!?**
10	**♗h2**	

Now:

a) **10 ... b5?** 11 ♘ce5 ♘xe5 12 ♘xe5 ♕a5+ 13 c3 ♗b7 14 0-0 ± Harding-Quinn, British Ch Qualifying 1974.

b) **10 ... b6** 11 0-0 ♗b7 12 c3 ♖e8 13 e4 ♘f6 14 e5 (14 ♕c2 ♘a5!) 14 ... ♘d5 (14 ... ♘d7 15 e6!?) 15 ♕b3 ♘c7 16 ♘g5! ♖f8 17 ♖ad1 ♕e8 18 e6 ± Harding-Franks, London League 1975.

C12

6	**c3**	

This shores up the black squares, but encourages counterplay on the light ones by a ♕-fianchetto.

6	...	**b6**

Or:

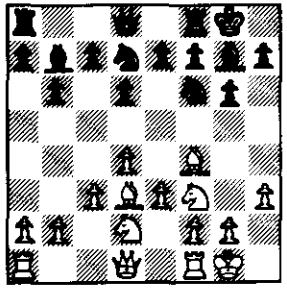
a) **6 ... ♘bd7** 7 ♗c4 ♕e8 8 c3 see C13.

b) **6 ... ♘c6** 7 h3 see C11.

7	**h3**	**♗b7**
8	**♗c4**	**♘bd7**
9	**0-0** *(37)*	

This is an important position as it can be reached by many widely-differing move-orders. Although it is generally considered good for Black - who has a flexible position thanks to the choice available between ... c5 and ... e5 - Michael Franklin is still willing to take the white pieces.

37
B



9	...	**♕e8**

Black continues to play as in a reversed Reti Opening. The point of this move is to prepare ... e5 without ... c5 but other plans also come into consideration:

a) **9 ... ♘e4** 10 ♘xe4 ♗xe4 11 ♕e2 (Passive; 11 ♘d2 is considerably better.) 11 ... e5 12 ♗h2 ♕e7 13 ♖ad1 ♔h8 14 ♗b5 ♖ad8 15 ♖d2 ♗b7 16 ♗xd7 ♗xf3! 17 ♕xf3 e4! ∓ Rubinstein-Euwe, London 1922.

b) **9 ... c5** when:

b1) **10 ♕e2** a6 11 a4 d5!? 12 ♗d3 ♘e4 13 ♗c2 ♘xd2 14 ♕xd2 ♖c8 15 ♖fe1 ♘f6 16 ♕e2 e6 17 ♘e5 ♕e7 18 ♗g5 = Franklin-Botterill, London 1975.

b2) **10 ♖e1** a6 11 a4 ♕c7 12 ♗h2 ♗c6 13 e4 e5 14 ♕e2 White has some initiative and eventually won; Franklin-Rayner, Aaronson Masters London 1978.

b3) Franklin has also suggested **10 a4** 'to be followed by b4 and ♕b3 - but obviously White's plan depends upon how Black continues after move 9. The usual plan is ... ♕c7 and ... e5'. (But 9 ... a6 first is probably necessary, as in the Reti, to be able to answer 10 a5 by 10 ... b5; then 10 b4 would be interesting but perhaps premature - Harding.)

10	**♗h2**	**e5**
11	**a4**	**a6**
12	**b4**	**♕e7**

Black's ♕-side is more solid than in the previous note because ... c5 has been avoided. Chances seem balanced but more tests are needed.

White should not imitate Bisguier-Korchnoi, Hastings 1975-76, which went on 13 ♕b3 ♖b8 14 b5 a5 15 ♕a3 e4 16 ♘e1 ♔h8 17 ♔h1 ♗h6 and now the deteriorating position was further compromised by 18 f4? ef (0-1, 51).

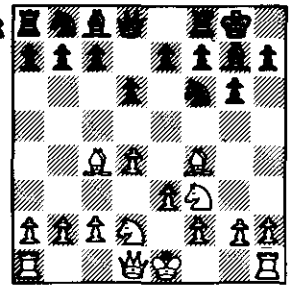
An alternative would be 12 ♕e2, to play a waiting game and keep a watch on the black a-pawn.

C13

6	**♗c4** *(38)*	

The move Franklin normally plays.

38
B



C131 6 ... ♘bd7

C132 6 ... ♘c6

Also:

a) **6 ... c6** 7 a4 (7 0-0 ♘bd7 8 c3 b5) 7 ... ♘bd7 8 h3 a5 9 0-0 ♘b6 10 ♗b3 ♘bd5 11 ♗h2 b5 12 e4 ♘b6 13 ab cb 14 ♖e1 ♗b7 15 c3 and 16 e5 Harding-Adams, London League 1975.

b) **6 ... b6** 7 c3 c5:

b1) **8 b4** ♘c6 9 ♕b3 a6 10 a4 ♗f5 11 0-0 d5 12 ♗e2 ♘h5! 13 ♗g5 h6 14 ♗h4 g5 15 ♗g3 ♘xg3 = Bisguier-N.Weinstein, USA Ch 1974.

b2) **8 ♕e2** (8 h3!?) 8 ... a6 9 a4 ♘h5! 10 ♗g5 h6 11 ♗h4 cd 12 cd ♘c6 13 0-0 ♘b4 ∓ Bondarevsky-Boleslavsky, 15th USSR Ch 1947.

c) **6 ... ♘fd7** (dubious against ♗c4) 7 h4!? is promising for White. According to Franklin, 7 ... ♘f6 is probably best, because if 7 ... e5 (7 ... ♕e8 8 h5) then 8 ♗g5 is strong. If 7 ... h5 Black's position is weakened, and White can play c3, ♕b1 (threatening ♕xg6), a4, ♕a2

and also ♘g5, building up against f7.

C131

6	...	♘bd7
7	h3	♕e8

In conjunction with this, ... ♘c6 would have been more logical.

Here 7 ... b6 is more logical, e.g. 8 0-0 ♗b7 9 c3 reaching the position in Diagram 37 in the important line C12.

8	♗h2	

Other moves here:

a) **8 ♗b5?!** ♗b7 or 8 ... ♘h5 9 ♗h2 e5 - TDH.

b) **8 d5?!** ♘a5 (8 ... ♘h5 9 ♗h2 ♗xb2? 10 dc; 8 ... ♘b8!?) 9 ♗h2 ♘xc4 ∓ (two bishops) - Harding.

c) **8 0-0** e5 9 de de! (9 ... ♘xe5 below) see the illustrative game Franklin-Ree, below.

8	...	e5
9	de	♘xe5

Possibly 9 ... de is better when 10 0-0 transposes to Franklin-Ree. 10 e4 ♘h5 could be a critical line.

10	♘xe5	de
11	0-0	

Here Black has:

a) **11 ... ♗d7** see illustrative game Franklin-Botterill, below.

b) **11 ... ♕e7** (=?) 12 c3 ♔h8 13 a4 a5 14 ♕b3 ♘d7 15 ♖fd1 f5 16 ♗f1 ♘b6 17 ♔h1 ♗e6 18 ♕b5 ♗d7 19 ♕b3 ♗e6 repeating moves; Franklin-Hartston, Hastings 1971-72.

Illustrative Games:

The annotations to the following two games were kindly contributed specially by British Master Michael Franklin, the acknowledged expert in this opening.

Franklin-Ree
England-Holland 1964

1 d4 ♘f6 2 ♘f3 g6 3 ♗f4 ♗g7 4 e3 0-0 5 ♘bd2 d6 6 ♗c4 ♘bd7

This opening brings about a quiet positional struggle. It causes Black no immediate problems but for the unwary it has a nasty sting in the tail. The following two games are against players well versed in the openings but it is not long before they lose their way.

If Black wishes to play an eventual ... e5 the knight is best placed at c6, where it does not obstruct the ♕♗'s view. If ... ♘bd7 is played then it should be followed by ... b6, ... ♗b7 and ... c5.

7	h3	♕e8
8	0-0	e5
9	de	

When Black plays the London System (i.e. against the Reti - TDH) it is usual to consolidate the centre by 5 ... c6 instead of ... ♘bd7, 6 ... ♗e7 instead of ... ♗c5, and develop the ♕♘ at a6 after first playing ... a5. In this variation one maintains a pawn at d5. The exchange of the d-pawn and playing e3-e4 by White is my own idea, evolved in over-the-board play and I have had considerable success with this variation over many years.

9	...	de
10	♗h2	♕e7

[TDH note: Black could try 10 ... e4!? with the idea 11 ♘d4 ♘e5 12 ♘b5!? ♕e7! but not 12 ... ♘xc4 13 ♘xc7 ♕c6 14 ♘xc4 (intending ♘xa8) or 13 ... ♘xb2 14 ♕b1. If the black ♕♘ were on c6 instead of d7, then the white ♔♘ would have to retreat to the passive square e1 (see C132).]

11	e4	♘h5
12	♕e2	♘c5

[12 ... ♗h6!? comes into consideration - TDH.]

13	♕e3	c6

[It is still possible to prepare ... ♗h6 by means of 13 ... ♖e8, 14 ... ♕f8 - TDH.]

14	♖fe1	

This allows the ♗c4 to return home where it not only helps to defend the ♔-side but supports a ♕-side advance. It also inhibits Black's efforts to play ... f5 because of pressure on e5.

14	...	b5
15	♗f1	♘a4
16	b3	♘b6
17	♖ac1	♘d7

Almost an admission that he has misplayed the opening.

18	c4	b4
19	c5	♘hf6

19 ... a5 is probably a little better but 20 ♘c4 is still very strong.

20	♘c4	♘e8
21	♘a5	♘b8

22 ♕d2 f6 23 ♕xb4 ♘c7 24 ♕a3 g5 25 ♘c4 g4 26 hg ♗xg4 27 ♘d6 ♗xf3 28 ♘f5 ♕e8 29 gf ♕h5 30 b4 ♗h6 31 ♖cd1 ♔h8 32 ♗c4 ♗f4 33 ♗xf4 ef 34 ♔f1 a5 35 ♔e2 ab 36 ♕b2 [This threatens 37 ♖d8! and 38 ♕xf6+, so it is no surprise that Black succumbs to a little combination - TDH.] **36 ... ♖a3 37 ♗b3 ♘b5 38 ♕xf6+ 1-0.**

Franklin-Botterill
Surrey-Oxfordshire 1971

1 d4 ♘f6 2 ♘f3 g6 3 ♗f4 ♗g7 4 e3 0-0 5 ♘bd2 d6 6 ♗c4 ♘bd7 7 h3 ♕e8 8 ♗h2 e5

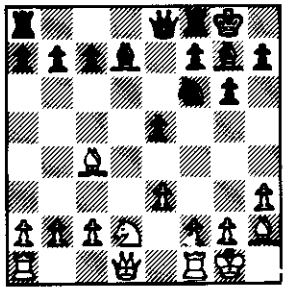
9	de	♘xe5

Black, possibly sensing the resulting cramped position after 9 ... de, decides to offer the exchange of knights. In this variation White does not have to play e3-e4. Although the position looks fairly harmless White is able to conjure up a few threats.

10	♘xe5	de
11	0-0	♗d7*(39)*

[11 ... ♕e7 transposes to Franklin-Hartston, above. Botterill suggests 11 ... b5!? or 11 ... ♗e6 = (and if 12 ♗xe5 ♗xe4 13 ♘c4 b5 ∓).]

39 W



12	♕e2	♕e7
13	♗b3	♔h8?

Black is so conditioned to playing ... f5 in the King's Indian Defence that this wasted move can almost be said to be an automatic reflex against the pin. [Better 13 ... ♗c6 = according to Botterill.]

14 Ïfd1 Ïad8
15 ♕c4 ♗c6
16 ♕h4

The ♕-side attack with ♘c4-a5 is once again causing Black problems. Note how it combines with threats on e5.

16 ... ♕c5
17 a3

The idea is ♕b4 to exchange queens. The resulting ending would favour White.

17 ... a5
18 ♘f3 Ïxd1+?

[Botterill: 18 ... Ïde8 19 ♕c4 ♕xc4 20 ♗xc4 ♘e4 = but I couldn't endure such a boring line!]

19 Ïxd1 ♗xf3

Once again Black feels obliged to give White the advantage of the two bishops. Note how Black is tied to the defence of his f-pawn due to his 13 ... ♔h8?

20 gf b5
21 a4! c6
22 Ïa1 e4!?

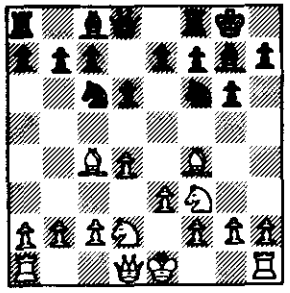
23 ♕f4 (23 fe g5! is unclear, but 23 Ïd1! ± - Botterill) 23 ... ef? (23 ... g5!? - Botterill) 24 ♕xf3 ba 25 Ïxa4 ♘d5 26 Ïc4 ♕e7 27 Ïxc6 (winning) 27 ... ♘b4 28 Ïc7 ♕g5+ 29 ♔h1 f5? (A blunder due to time pressure) 30 Ïxg7! ♔xg7 31 ♕b7+ ♔f6 32 ♕b6+ ♔g7 33 ♗e5+ Ïf6 34 ♕c7+ 1-0.

C132

6 ... ♘c6!*(40)*
7 c3

Probably necessary in this position, because if White allows the Franklin plan 7 h3 ♕e8 8 ♗h2

40
W



e5 9 de Black obtains the initiative by 9 ... de! e.g. 10 e4 ♘h5 (Botterill) or 10 0-0 e4 since the black ♘c6 controls d4.

How is White to circumvent this difficulty? One possibility is to delay the knight development (C2). White might also look further into 7 0-0!? ♕e8 (7 ... ♘h5!? 8 ♗g5) 8 e4!? e5 9 de de 10 ♗e3 which is somewhat like a Classical Pirc.

7 ... ♕e8

Or 7 ... ♘fd7 8 h4 ♘f6! 9 ♕c2 ♘h5 10 ♗h2 e5 11 0-0-0 e4?! 12 ♕xe4 ♗f5 13 ♕d5 ± Franklin-Perkins, London 1975.

8 e4

A quieter treatment is 8 0-0, e.g. 8 ... e5 9 ♗g3 ♕e7 10 h3 ♔h8 11 b4 e4 12 ♘e1 ♘h5 13 ♗h2 f5 Franklin-Ligterink, Aaronson Masters, London 1978 - which game ended in a draw.

8 ... e5
9 de ♘h5!

9 ... de allows White more scope, e.g. 10 ♗e3 b6 (10 ... ♕e7 11 h3 ±) 11 h3 ♗b7 12 ♕c2 Ïd8 13 b4 ♘h5 14 0-0 ♘f4 =, and White can

probably improve on this.

10 ♗e3 ♘xe5
11 ♘xe5 ♕xe5

12 0-0 ♘f6 13 f3 ♕e7 14 Ïe1 c6 15 a4 ♗e6 16 ♕b3 d5 = (½-½, 35) Franklin-Dueball, Great Britain-West Germany 1971.

C2

4 ... d6
5 h3

Other ideas:

a) 5 ♗c4 0-0 6 c3 a6? (6 ... ♘bd7 C131) 7 a4 ♘bd7 8 0-0 ♕e8 9 h3 e5 10 ♗h2 ♕e7 (Goldin-Kupreichik, USSR 1974) 11 a5! - Boleslavsky and Kapengut.

b) 5 ♗e2 ♘h5!? 6 ♗g5 h6 7 ♗h4 g5 8 ♘fd2 (8 ♗g3 ♘xg3 9 hg ♘d7):

b1) 8 ... ♘f4 9 ef gh 10 ♘f3 c5 11 c3 cd 12 ♘xd4 ♘c6 13 ♘f3 ♕b6 (½-½, 26) Spiridonov-Grefe, Slanchev Breag 1974.

b2) 8 ... gh 9 ♗xh5 e5 10 de (10 c3!?) 10 ... ♘c6! 11 ♘c3 ♘xe5 12 ♕e2 0-0 13 0-0-0 (13 0-0 d5) 13 ... b5! 14 f4 (14 ♕xb5 ♗e6) 14 ... b4 15 ♘d5 c6! (0-1, 33) Klaman-Gufeld, Sebastopol 1976.

5 ... 0-0*(41)*

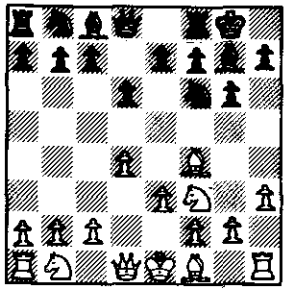
Or 5 ... ♘bd7 6 ♗e2 (passive) 6 ... c5 7 c3 b6 8 ♘bd2 ♗b7 9 0-0 0-0 10 ♕c2 Ïc8 Naegeli-Bogoljubow, German Ch 1933.

Now, apart from 6 ♘bd2 (C1) White can play:

C21 6 ♗e2
C22 6 c3

Janowski-Yates, New York 1924, went 6 ♗c4 when, according to Alekhine, Black should transpose to the reversed Reti by 6 ... c5 7 c3 (7

41
W



dc ♕a5+) 7 ... b6 and ... ♗b7. Instead 6 ... ♘c6 was chosen, but this left d5 weak, e.g. 7 0-0 ♘d7 (7 ... e5 8 ♗h2 is critical.) 8 ♘c3 h6 (8 ... e5? 9 ♗g5 ♕e8 10 ♘d5 ±) 9 ♕d2 e5 10 ♗g3 ♔h7 11 Ïad1 ♘b6?! 12 ♗e2 ♕e7 13 Ïfe1 ±.

C21

6 ♗e2 ♘bd7

Also possible are:

a) 6 ... c5 7 c4?! ♕b6 8 ♘c3 ♕xb2 9 ♘b5 ♕b4+ 10 ♘d2 a6 11 ♘c7 Ïa7 12 ♗g5 e6 13 ♗f4 ♘e4 (0-1, 51) Grigorov-Uhlmann, Leipzig 1974. 7 c3 is normal.

b) 6 ... ♘c6 when:

b1) 7 ♗b5 a6 8 ♗a4 b5 9 ♗b3?! (9 ♗c2 ♘d7 10 e4 e5 11 de =) 9 ... ♘a5 10 ♗c2 ♘c4 11 b3 (11 ♕c1 ♗b7 12 ♘bd2 e5 ∓) 11 ... ♘b6 12 e4 ♘fd7 13 0-0 (13 e5 ♗b7) 13 ... e5! ∓ Bisguier-Gligoric, Stockholm 1962; White has a very poor form of Ruy Lopez.

b2) 7 d5?! e5! 8 dc? ef 9 cb ♗xb7 10 ef Ïe8+ ∓ - Euwe.

b3) 7 ♗e2 ♘d7 8 ♗h2 e5 9 de de 10 ♘bd2 ♕e7 11 0-0 b6 12 ♕c2 ♗b7 13 Ïad1 f5 (0-1, 30) Sorokin-

Polugayevsky, RSFSR Spartakiad, Leningrad 1967.
b4) **7 0-0** ♕e8 8 ♗h2 a6 (8 ... e5!?) 9 d5 ♘b8 10 c4 e5 11 ♘c3 ♘d7 12 e4 f5 13 ♘g5 ♘f6 14 f4 h6 15 fe de 16 ♘f3 f4 17 c5 with an unclear position; Ranniku-Chiburdanidze, USSR Women's Cup Final 1974.
c) **6 ... b6** 7 0-0 ♗b7 and now:
c1) **8 ♘bd2** ♘bd7 9 c3 e6 (9 ... c5!? see note to Black's 7th below) 10 ♗h2 ♕e7 with a very comfortable position for Black; Prameshuber-Hübner, Clare Benedict Teams, Paignton 1970.
c2) **8 c4** ♘bd7 9 ♘c3 ♖e8 10 ♕c2 e5 11 de de 12 ♗h2 with an unclear position (1-0,60) Havin-Pogrebissky Kiev Ch 1950.

7 0-0 ♕e8

Or 7 ... b6 8 ♘bd2 c5 9 c3 ♗b7 = e.g. 10 a4 a6 11 ♗h2 ♖a7! 12 ♘e1 ♕a8 13 ♗f3 cd 14 ♗xb7 ♕xb7 15 ed (15 cd ♖c8) 15 ... ♖fa8! ∓ Trifunovic-Csom, Sombor 1972.

8 ♗h2 e5
9 ♘a3

Or 9 de de (9 ... ♘xe5!?) 10 ♘c3 ♕e7 11 ♕d2 c6 12 ♖fd1 ♘e8 13 ♗c4 ♔h8 14 e4 (½-½, 41) Yurchinska-Veroeci, Belgrade 1975.

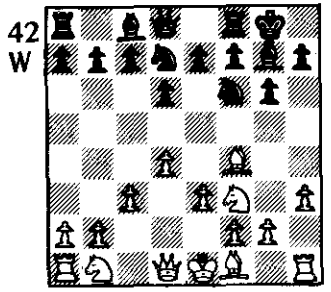
9 ... e4
10 ♘d2 ♕e7
11 ♘b5 ♘e8

12 c4 f5 13 ♕c2 a6 14 ♘c3 ♘ef6 15 ♖ae1 b6 = (½-½, 57) Ritov-Polugayevsky, Tallinn 1973.

C22

6 c3 ♘bd7 *(42)*

Or 6 ... ♕e8 7 ♗e2 ♘c6. This placing of the ♕♘ has less point now that d4 is under control from the white c-pawn. Moiseyev-Petrusiak, Havirzhov 1971, continued 8 0-0 e5 9 ♗h2 ♘h5 10 ♘e1 f5 11 ♘d3 ♘f6 12 b4 a6 13 ♘d2 g5 14 a4 with White's ♕side chances looking better than Black's on the ♔side (1-0, 36).



7 ♗e2

7 ♗c4 also comes into consideration:
a) 7 ... **♖e8??** 8 ♗xf7+ ♔xf7 9 ♘g5+ ♔g8 10 ♘e6 wins the queen.
b) 7 ... **♕e8** 8 0-0 e5 9 de (9 ♗h2 ♕e7 10 ♘bd2 Bisguier-Langeweg, Beverwijk 1962; 10 ... b6 = - Barden) 9 ... ♘xe5 10 ♗e2?! h6 11 ♗h2 g5! 12 ♘xe5 de 13 ♘a3 ♕e7 14 ♘c4 ♖d8 15 ♕c2 ♘d5 ∓ Podgorny-Stulik, Prague 1948.
c) 7 ... **e6** 8 ♘bd2 (8 0-0 ♕e7 intending ... e5 - Pachman) 8 ... ♕e7 9 e4? e5 10 de de 11 ♗e3 b6 12 ♕e2 a6 13 g4 (to forestall ... ♘h5-f4) 13 ... ♘c5 14 ♗g5 ♗b7 ∓ Vidmar-Flohr, Bled 1931.

7 ... ♕e8
8 0-0 e5
9 ♗h2 ♕e7

9 ... ♘h5 is less appropriate, e.g.

10 a4 ♔h8 11 ♘a3 f5 12 ♘b5 ♕d8 13 de de 14 g4 fg 15 hg a6 16 ♘xc7 ♕xc7 17 gh ♕c6 18 h6 ♗f6 19 c4 e4 20 ♘d4 ♕b6 21 ♕c2 ♘c5 22 a5 (1-0, 47) Moiseyev-Lepeshkin, ½-final Moscow Ch 1972.

10 a4

Here Black has tried:
a)10 ... h5!? 11 de ♘xe5 12 ♘bd2 ♘xf3+ 13 ♘xf3 ♘e4 14 a5 a6 15 ♘d2 ♘g5 16 ♘f3 ♘e6 17 ♘d4 d5 18 ♖e1 c5 (½-½, 40) Doda-Kavalek, Polanica Zdroj 1968.
b) **10 ... a5** 11 ♖e1 b6 12 ♘a3 ♗b7 13 ♘b5 ♖ac8 (better 13 ... ♘e8 =) 14 b4 ed?! 15 ed ♖fe8 16 ♗c4 ± Hort-Pribyl, Havirzhov 1971.

The Pseudo-London System

1 d4 ♘f6
2 ♘f3 g6
3 ♘c3

The idea is to induce ... d5 so that the subsequent placing of the ♕♗ on f4 will be more effective. However, White does not have a very free game for his other pieces are restricted and the knight on c3 in particular is in the way of the c-pawn.

3 ... d5

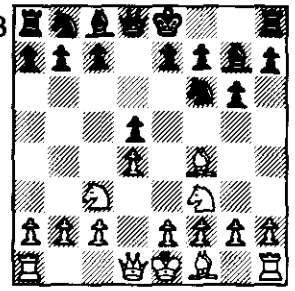
If 3 ... d6 (or 3 ... ♗g7) White will transpose to the classical Pirc by 4 e4, while if 3 ... c5 4 d5 d6 5 e4 with a favourable form of Benoni.

4 ♗f4

Other tries include:
a) **4 g3** ♗g7 5 ♗g2 0-0 6 0-0 ♘bd7 7 ♘e5 ♘xe5 8 de ♘g4 9 ♘d5 c6 10 ♘f4 ♘xe5 = Lopez-Toran, Torremolinos 1961.
b) **4 ♗g5!?** (compare chapters 2, B and 7, B):
b1) **4 ... ♗g7** (= ECO) 5 ♕d2 or 5 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 6 e4 - Neikirkh and Tsvetkov.
b2) **4 ... ♘e4** (usually good when White has played ♘f3):
b21) 5 ♗f4 ♘xc3 6 bc c5 7 e4 de 8 ♘g5 ♕a5 9 ♘xe4 ♗g7 10 ♗d2 cd 11 cd ♕d5 12 ♕f3 ♘bd7 13 ♘eg5 (13 c3 0-0 14 ♗d3 e5) 13 ... ♕xf3 14 ♘xf3 0-0 and Black has counterplay against the c- and d-pawns; Klaman-Bronstein, 24th USSR Ch 1957.
b22) 5 ♕d3!? ♘xg5 (better 5 ... ♗f5) 6 ♘xg5 ♗h6 (6 ... e6 7 h4 or 6 ... ♗g7 7 ♕f3 0-0 8 ♕xd5 ±) 7 h4 c6 8 e4 de 9 ♘cxe4 ♕a5+ 10 c3 ± Rakic-Marjanovic, Yugoslavia 1975.

4 ... ♗g7 *(43)*

Other ideas are:
a) **4 ... ♘h5** 5 ♗e5 f6 6 ♗g3 ♘xg3 7 hg ♗g7 8 e3 c6 9 ♗d3 e5? (9 ... ♔f7 was necessary) 10 ♖xh7! ♔f7 (10 ... ♖xh7 11 ♗xg6+; 10 ... e4 11 ♖xg7 ed 12 ♘h4) 11 ♗xg6+! ♔xg6 12 ♘e5+! fe 13 ♕h5+ ♔f6 14 ♕xe5+ ♔f7 15 ♕xg7+ ♔e6 16 ♕e5 mate; Palau-te Kolste, London OL 1927.
b) **4 ... c6** 5 e3 (or 5 h3) 5 ... ♗g7 6 h3 ♘bd7 (possibly 6 ... 0-0 followed by ... b6 and ... ♗a6 is better.) when:
b1) **7 ♗e2** b6 8 0-0 ♗b7 9 ♘e5 (Tartakower-Wahltuch, London 1922) 9 ... 0-0 intending ... ♘e8, ... f6.
b2) **7 ♗d3** 0-0 8 0-0 ♖e8 9 ♗h2 a6 a6 = Holmov-Gipslis, 29th USSR Ch 1961.



A 5 h3
B 5 e3
Or:
a) 5 ♘b5 ♘a6 6 e3 0-0 7 ♗e2 c6 8 ♘c3 ♕b6 = Bisguier-Tarjan, USA Ch 1973.
b) 5 ♕d2 and now:
b1) 5 ... 0-0 6 ♗h6 with the following possibilities:
b11) 6 ... b6 7 ♗xg7 ♔xg7 8 0-0-0 (or 8 g3 ♗b7 = Addison-Ujtumen, Palma de Mallorca 1970) 8 ... ♗b7 9 h4 h5 10 ♘g5 ♘bd7 11 f4 e6 12 e3 c5 is unclear; Rakic-Janosevic, Belgrade 1968.
b12) 6 ... ♘e4 7 ♘xe4 de 8 ♗xg7 ♔xg7 9 ♘g5 ♕d5 10 h4 (10 c4 ♕xc4 11 ♘xe4 - Buslayev in *64*) 10 ... h6 11 ♘h3 e5 12 e3 ♖d8 13 c4 ♕d6 14 0-0-0 ♘c6 15 d5 ♘e7 16 f3 ef (16 ... ♗xh3!?) 17 gf (Aleksandria-Chiburdanidze, 8th match game 1977) 17 ... ♗xh3 followed by 18 ... b5 with an unclear position.
b2) 5 ... ♘e4!? (Tukmakov later suggested 5 ... c5.) 6 ♘xe4 de 7 ♘e5 f6 (7 ... ♗e6 8 0-0-0! f6 9 d5! fe 10 de ±) 8 ♘c4 ♗e6 9 e3 0-0 10 ♘a5 (10 0-0-0!? ∞ - Tukmakov) 10 ... b6 11 ♗c4 ♕c8! 12 ♗xe6 ♕xe6 13 ♘b3 c6 14 0-0 ♘d7 15 ♖fd1 (15 ♖ad1!?) 15 ... f5! (instead of 15 ... ♖ad8? 16 d5! ♕xd5 17 ♕e2! ± Gurgenidze-Tukmakov, USSR 1977) 16 d5 cd 17 ♕xd5 ♕xd5 18 ♖xd5 ♘f6 = - Tukmakov, *Informator 24.*

A

5 h3 0-0

5 ... ♘e4 is interesting. Tsvetkov quotes a game that continued 6 e3 ♘xc3 7 bc c5 8 ♗e5 f6 9 ♗g3 ♕a5 10 ♕d2 c4 11 ♗e2 ♘d7 12 0-0 ♘b6 with complicated play.

6 e3 c5
7 dc

Alekhine wrote: 'At first blush this makes a strange impression, but it is based on a profound conception of the position. White may permit his only pawn to disappear from the centre, inasmuch as he commands it sufficiently with his pieces.'

Others are not so good:
a) 7 ♗e2 ♘bd7 and now:
a1) 8 dc ♕a5 9 0-0 ♕xc5 10 ♘d2 ♕b6 11 ♘b3 ♗f5 12 ♗f3 ♖fd8 = Balshan-Shamkovich, Netanya 1975.
a2) 8 ♘e5 e6 9 0-0 ♘xe5 10 ♗xe5 b6 11 a4 ♗b7 12 a5 ♗c6 13 ♘a4 (Neikirkh and Tsvetkov also give 13 ♗b5 ♕d7 14 ♕e2 c4! = and 13 ♘b5!? ♘e4! 14 ♗h2 ♕d7.) 13 ... c4 14 ♕e1 ♖fe8 15 b3 ♗xa4 16 ♖xa4 b5! 17 ♖a1 a6 18 bc (If 18 ♗f3 cb! 19 cb ♖c8, but 18 b4! ♘d7 is critical.) 18 ... dc! 19 ♗f3 ♘d5 20 ♗xg7 ♔xg7 21 e4 ♘e7 22 ♕c3+ ♔g8 23 ♖fd1 ♖ab8 24 h4 ♕c7! 25 h5 b4 26 ♕e3 e5 27 ♕g5 ♘c6! ∓

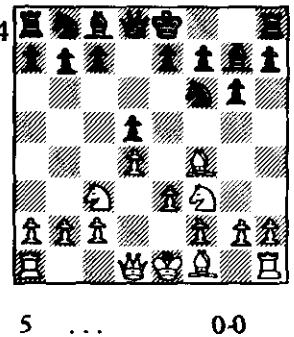
Bondarevsky-Smyslov, Moscow Ch 1947.
b) 7 ♘b5 ♘c6 8 c3 a6 9 ♘a3 c4 10 ♗e3 b5 11 ♘e5 ♗b7 12 ♗f3 ♘e4 ∓ Prins-Czerniak, Beverwijk 1955 (0-1, 46).

7 ... ♕a5
8 ♘d2 ♕xc5

9 ♘b3 ♕b6 10 ♗e5 'leading up to an exchange of pieces by which the black squares in the opposing position are considerably weakened, a circumstance which will turn out to be the determining factor in the approaching ending. This is Capablanca!' wrote his great rival. Capablanca-Yates, New York 1924, continued 10 ... e6 11 ♘b5 ♘e8 12 ♗xg7 ♘xg7 13 h4! a6 14 ♘c3 ♘c6 15 ♗d3 ± (1-0, 77).

B

5 e3*(44)*



5 ... 0-0

5 ... ♗f5 might be met by 6 ♗d3 (Alekhine) though this was not played in:
a) Marshall-Ed.Lasker, New York 1924; which went 6 h3 0-0 7 ♗d3 ♘e4 8 ♗xe4 ♗xe4 9 0-0 ♘d7 10 ♘d2 ±.
b) Nor in Suetin-Borisenko, 21st USSR Ch 1954; 6 ♗e2 c6 7 ♘e5 ♘fd7 =.

6 ♗e2

Alternatives:
a) 6 ♘b5 (6 h3 see A) 6 ... ♘a6 7 ♗e2 ♗g4 8 ♘c3 ♘b8 9 h3 ♗f5 10 g4 ♗c8 11 g5 ♘e8 12 ♕d2 c6 13 0-0-0 ♘d6 14 ♗d3 ± (1-0, 40) Bogoljubow-Rellstab, Aachen 1933.
b) Alekhine recommended 6 ♗d3. Practical examples:
b1) 6 ... c6 7 h3 ♘bd7 8 0-0 ♖e8 9 ♗h2 a6 10 b4 ♘h5 11 ♘e5 ♘xe5 12 de f6 13 g4 fe 14 gh e4 15 ♘xe4 unclear; Holmov-Gipslis, 29th USSR Ch 1961.
b2) 6 ... c5 when:
b21) 7 h3 ♕b6 8 0-0 c4 9 ♗e2 ♕xb2 10 ♕d2 ♕b4 11 ♘e5 e6 12 e4 ♘c6 13 ♖ab1:
b211) 13 ... ♕e7 14 ♗f3 is unclear; Bondarevsky-Bronstein, Parnu 1947.
b212) 13 ... ♕a5 14 ♘xc6 bc 15 ♘xd5 ♕xd2 16 ♘xf6+ ♗xf6 17 ♗xd2 ♗xd4 18 ♗c4 ± - ECO.
b22) 7 0-0 ♘c6 (7 ... ♗g4 8 h3 ♗xf3 9 ♕xf3 ♘c6 ∓ ECO) 8 dc (8 ♘e5 ♘h5 9 ♘xc6 bc 10 ♗g5 h6 ∓ Radojevic-Daskalov, Sombor 1964) 8 ... ♕a5 9 ♘d4 ♕xc5 10 ♘xc6 bc 11 ♗e5 ♕b4 12 ♖ab1 ♘g4 13 a3 ♕b6 14 ♗xg7 ♕c7 15 g3 ♔xg7 16 e4 ♖fd8 17 ed cd 18 ♗e2 ♘f6 and Black stood well; Golombek-Vaitonis, Stockholm 1952.

6 ... b6?!

Others:
a) 6 ... ♘h5!? 7 ♗g5 h6 8 ♗h4 g5 9 ♗g3? ♘c6 10 ♘e5 ♘xg3 11 ♘xc6 bc 12 hg ♕d6 13 ♘a4 e5 ∓

Bondarevsky-Liberzon, Rostov 1960. Black's control of the central squares was the critical factor. But why not 9 ♘e5!

b) **6 ... a6** 7 0-0 b6 8 ♘e5 ♗b7 9 ♗f3 e6 (Maher-Olafsson, Moscow 1956) 10 ♕e2 followed by e3-e4 = - Olafsson.

c) **6 ... c6** 7 0-0 ♗f5 8 ♘e5 ♘fd7 9 g4 ♗e6 10 ♘d3 c5 11 ♘b5 ♘a6 12 ♗g3 ♘f6! = Suetin-Borisenko, 21st USSR Ch 1954.

d) **6 ... c5** when:

d1) **7 dc!?** ♕a5 8 0-0 ♕xc5 9 ♘d2 ♘c6 10 ♘b3 ♕b6 11 ♘xd5 ♘xd5 12 ♕xd5 ♗xb2 13 ♖ab1 ♗e6 = G.Harris-Ivkov, Bognor Regis 1958.

d2) **7 0-0** cd 8 ed ♘c6 9 ♘e5 ♘d7 10 ♘xc6 bc 11 ♘a4 a5 12 c3 ♗a6 13 ♗xa6 ♖xa6 14 ♖e1 ♖e8 15 ♖e3 ♖a7 16 ♕e2 ½:½ Kottnauer-Boleslavsky, Helsinki 1952.

d3) **7 ♘e5** cd 8 ed ♘c6 9 0-0 ♕b6 10 ♘xc6 bc 11 ♘a4 ♕a5 12 c3 ♘d7 13 b4 ♕d8 14 ♗g5 f6 15 ♗h4 ♘b6 16 ♘c5 g5 17 ♗g3 e5 18 a4 ♕e7 19 de fe 20 ♖fe1 ♘d7 21 ♘xd7 ♗xd7 22 c4 (1-0, 48) Antoshin-Balashov, Moscow 1967.

7 ♘b5

Or 7 0-0 ♘h5?! (7 ... ♗b7; 7 ... c6!?) 8 ♗g5 h6 9 ♗h4 g5 10 ♘e5 gh 11 ♗xh5 ♗e6 (11 ... e6 - Antoshin) 12 f4 ♗xe5 13 de ♕d7 14 ♕f3 f5 15 ♖ad1 c6 16 ♕f3 ♗f7 17 ♗f3 ♘a6 18 e4! e6 19 ef ef 20 ♘e4! ♕e7 21 ♘f6+ ♔g7 22 ♕xh4 ♕c5+ 23 ♖f2 ♖ad8 24 ♖d3 ♕a5 25 ♗e2 ♕e1+ 26 ♗f1 ♖h8 27 ♘h5+ ♗xh5 28 ♖g3+ ♗g4 29 ♕f6+ 1-0 Antoshin-H.Olafsson, Reykjavik 1976.

7 ... ♘a6
8 c4 ♗b7

Here White has tried:

a) **9 ♖c1** c6 10 ♘c3 c5 11 0-0 cd 12 ♘xd4 ♘c5 13 ♘db5 dc 14 ♗xc4 ♘fe4 15 ♕e2 e5 16 ♗g3 a6 17 ♖fd1 ♕e7 18 ♘xe4 ♘xe4 19 ♘c3 ♘xc3 20 ♖xc3 ½:½ Harding-Sugden, Athenaeum-Cambridge University 1976.

b) **9 ♗e5** dc (best?) 10 ♗xc4 c5 11 0-0 cd 12 ♘fxd4 ♘c5 13 ♖c1 a6 14 ♘c7 ♖c8 15 b4 ± Holmov-Gligoric, USSR-Yugoslavia 1962.

Conclusion

The London and Pseudo-London systems are useful weapons for thwarting the intentions of King's Indian and Grünfeld Defence players - especially if White is happy with ♘f3 lines against the Pirc.

7 Miscellaneous after 2 ♘f3

This chapter is concerned with various plans by Black after:

A 1 d4 d5 2 ♘f3

B 1 d4 ♘f6 2 ♘f3

These are chiefly those lines in which Black plays an early ... c5 or in which he develops his queen's bishop at either f5 or g4.

A

1 d4 d5
2 ♘f3

A1 2 ... ♘f6
A2 2 ... ♗g4
A3 2 ... ♗f5
A4 2 ... ♘c6
A5 2 ... c5

If in doubt, consult the index - p. 102.

A1

2 ... ♘f6

Remaining lines only.

3 e3

Now we consider:

A11 3 ... ♗g4
A12 3 ... ♗f5
A13 3 ... c6

3 ... e6 and 3 ... c5 have largely been considered in the chapters on the Colle. However, it is worth noting this form of delayed ... ♗g4: 3 ... c5 and now:

a) **4 c3** ♘c6 5 ♗d3 ♗g4 6 h3 (6 ♘bd2 e5 7 de ♘xe5 8 ♗b5+ ♗d7 9 ♗xd7+ ♘exd7 10 0-0 ♗e7 11 ♖e1 0-0 - Neikirkh and Tsvetkov) 6 ... ♗xf3 7 ♕xf3 c4 8 ♗c2 e5 9 de ♘xe5 10 ♗a4+ (better 10 ♕d1 intending ♘b1-d2-f3 =) 10 ... ♔e7! 11 ♕d1 ♘d3+ 12 ♔e2 ♘e4 13 ♖hf1 f5 14 ♗c2 ♘e5 15 f4 ♘f7 16 ♗xe4 de 17 ♕d4 ♕xd4 18 cd ♔e6 ∓ Araiza-Alekhine, Pasadena 1932.

b) **4 ♘bd2** ♘c6 5 a3?! ♗g4 6 dc ♕a5 7 h3 ♗xf3 8 gf e5 9 b4 ♘xb4 10 ♖b1 ♘c6 11 ♖xb7 ♖ab8 12 ♖xb8+ ♘xb8 13 c4 ♗xc5 14 ♕b3 0-0 15 cd ♘bd7 16 ♗c4 ♖h8 17 ♕a2 ♘f8 18 0-0 ♕c7 19 ♖fd1 ♘g6 with a promising position for Black; Dus-Hotimirski v. Bivshev, ½-final 17th USSR Ch 1949.

A11

3 ... ♗g4
4 c4! e6

Here 4 ... dc transposes to the Queen's Gambit Accepted (D25 in ECO). As White has no advantageous way of avoiding this (though 4 ♗e2

or 4 ♗d3 are of course playable) we give here the main line: 5 ♗xc4 e6 6 h3 ♗h5 7 ♘c3 ♘bd7 (7 ... a6 is also ±; 7 ... ♘c6!? 8 ♗b5 ♗d6 9 e4 ♘d7 10 ♗e3 0-0 11 e5 ♗e7 12 ♗e2 ♘b6!? - Kotov) 8 e4 (The quieter 8 0-0 is also ±.) 8 ... ♘b6 9 ♗d3 (or 9 ♗b3 ±) 9 ... ♗xf3 (9 ... ♗e7 10 ♗e3 ±) 10 gf c5 11 ♗g5 ♕xd4 12 ♗b5+ ♘fd7 13 ♕e2 ♗e7 14 ♖d1 ♕e5 15 ♖xd7 ♘xd7 16 ♗xd7+ ♔d8 (16 ... ♔xd7? 17 ♕b5+ ±±) 17 f4 ♕c7 18 ♗a4 ♗xg5 19 fg ♔e7 20 ♕e3 ± Kozma-Smejkal, Czech Ch 1964.

Alternatively, **4 ... ♗xf3** 5 ♕xf3 e6 6 ♘c3 when:

a) **6 ... ♗e7** 7 ♗d3 0-0 8 0-0 c6 9 ♖d1 ♘bd7 10 e4 de 11 ♘xe4 ♖e8 12 ♗d2 ♘f8 13 ♗c3 ± Colle-Fairhurst, London 1927.

b) **6 ... c6** is another sort of Queen's Gambit (Orthodox Defence) in which his bugbear, the queen's bishop, has been exchanged off.

However, White has a free game with the two bishops. Bukhman-Chernikov, ½-final Leningrad Ch 1967, continued 7 ♗d3 ♘bd7 8 g4!? h6 9 ♗d2 a6 10 ♖g1 b5 11 cd cd 12 a3 ♘b6 13 b3 ♖c8 14 h4 g5 15 hg hg 16 ♔e2 ♘bd7 17 ♖h1 ♖xh1 18 ♕xh1!? ♘xg4 19 ♕h5 ♘df6 20 ♕xg5 ♘xf2 21 ♘xd5 ed (21 ... ♘xd5 is better, though White has the bishop pair for the ending.) 22 ♕e5+ ♗e7 23 ♗f5 ♘2e4 24 ♖h1 ♘g8 25 ♖h8 ♘ef6 26 ♗b4 ♖c6 27 ♕xf6! 1-0.

5 ♕b3

5 ♘bd2 and 5 ♘c3 are also playable.

5 ... ♕c8

6 ♗d2

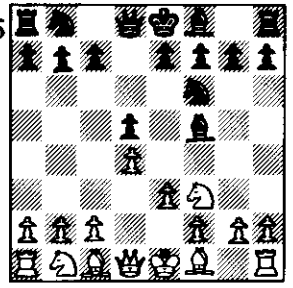
6 ♘e5 ♗f5 7 ♘c3 c6 holds Black's vital d5 square, but after 8 ♗e2 (with a threat of g4) White's game is preferable. Instead of 8 ♗e2, White could also follow Colle-P. Johner, Berlin 1926: 8 cd ed 9 ♗d2 ♗d6 10 ♖c1 ±.

After **6 ♗d2** Prins-Spielmann, Zandvoort 1936, continued 6 ... ♗d6 7 ♗b4 (still 7 ♘c3) 7 ... 0-0 8 ♘bd2 ♘c6 9 ♗xd6 (9 ♗c3, though an admission of error, is better.) 9 ... cd 10 ♗d3 dc 11 ♘xc4 (to avoid ... ♘a5) 11 ... ♗xf3 12 gf d5 13 ♘d2 e5! 14 de ♘xe5 15 f4 ♘xd3+ 16 ♕xd3 ♖e8 17 ♘f3 ♕g4 18 ♕e2 ♕f5 19 ♘d4 ♕e4! ∓ (0-1, 67); White's pawn structure is a mess; his king is homeless.

A12

3 ... ♗f5 *(45)*

This was an idea of Alekhine's to prevent the Colle. In effect Black plays a London system a tempo down.



4 ♗d3

This is usual. Others:

a) **4 c4** is sharpest. After 4 ... c6 (4 ... e6!? see A3) White can either:

a1) Transpose to the Exchange Slav by **5 cd** cd 6 ♘c3, or

a2) Continue **5 ♘c3** e6 6 ♗d3 ♗xd3 7 ♕xd3 ♘bd7 8 0-0 when:

a21) Colle-Euwe, Hastings 1923-4, went **8 ... ♗d6** 9 e4 de 10 ♘xe4 ♘xe4 11 ♕xe4 0-0 12 ♗g5 ♗e7 13 ♗d2 ♖e8 14 ♗c3 ♕c7 15 ♖ac1 ♖ad8 16 ♖fe1 ♘f8 17 h4 ♗f6 18 ♘h2 ♕b6 19 ♖cd1 ♕a6 20 ♘g4 ♗e7 21 d5 cd 22 cd ed 23 ♖xd5 ♗d6 24 ♖g5 ♖xe4 25 ♘h6+ 1-0.

a22) **8 ... ♗b4** 9 ♗d2 (Δ 10 ♘xd5) 9 ... ♗a5 10 b4 ♗c7 11 e4 dc 12 ♕xc4 e5 13 ♗e3 0-0 14 ♖ad1 ed 15 ♗xd4 ♕b8 16 h3 ♖e8 17 ♕d3 h6 18 ♘h4 ♗e5 19 ♘f5 ♖d8 20 f4 ♗xd4+ (20 ... ♗xf4 21 ♗xf6 gf 22 ♕f3 ±) 21 ♕xd4 ± (½-½, 41) Franklin-Unzicker, Hastings 1971-72.

b) **4 ♘e5!?** e6 (4 ... ♘bd7!? = ECO) 5 g4?! is probably an over-reaction as White's ♔-side was the weaker after 5 ... ♗e4 6 f3 ♗g6 7 h4 h5 8 ♘xg6 fg 9 ♗d3 ♔f7 10 g5 ♘fd7 11 c3 ♗d6. Liberman-Petukhin, Habarovsk 1967, continued 12 e4 c5 13 e5 ♗e7 14 ♕d2 ♕e8 15 c4 ♘c6 16 cd ed 17 ♘c3 ♘xd4 18 ♕f4+ ♔g8 (heading for the safety of h7!) 19 0-0 (a home with a leaky roof) 19 ... ♘b6 and Black won in 41 moves. A deceptive variation. ECO gives ± after 12 e4 and they may be right.

4 ... e6

Other ideas are:

a) **4 ... ♗g6** (Colle-Tartakower, Bled 1930) 5 ♘bd2!? e6 6 ♕e2 (intending e4) ± - ECO.

b) **4 ... ♘e4?** 5 ♘h4 e6 6 ♘xf5 ef 7 c4 c6 8 cd ♕xd5 9 0-0 ♗b4 10 f3 ♘d6 11 ♘c3 ± Bochan-Guryanov, Bulgaria 1955.

c) **4 ... ♗xd3?!** 5 ♕xd3 (or 5 cd ± Colle-Bogoljubow, San Remo 1930) and now:

c1) **5 ... c6** 6 ♘bd2 e6 7 0-0 ♗d6 8 e4 de 9 ♘xe4 ♘xe4 10 ♕xe4 ♘d7!? ± - ECO.

c2) **5 ... ♘bd7** 6 ♘bd2 e6 7 e4 de 8 ♘xe4 ♘xe4 (8 ... ♗e7 is better.) 9 ♕xe4 ♗d6 (Consistent, but 9 ... ♕c8 was better.) 10 ♕xb7! 0-0 11 0-0 ♖b8 12 ♕e4 ♖b5 13 c4 ♘f6 14 ♕e2 ♖f5 15 h3 ♕a8 16 ♖fe1 c5 17 dc ♗b8 18 ♗g5 ♕c6 19 b4 ♘h5 20 ♘d4 ♕c7 21 ♕xh5 ♕h2+ 22 ♔f1 ♖e5 23 ♖xe5 ♗xe5 24 ♖ad1 ♕h1+ 25 ♔e2 ♕xg2 26 ♘f3 ♗g3 27 ♗e3 1-0 Sultan-Khan v. Milner-Barry, British Ch 1931.

5 ♗xf5 ef

6 ♕d3

Colle-Alekhine, San Remo 1930, went instead 6 0-0 ♘bd7 7 c4 dc 8 ♕a4 ♗d6 9 ♘bd2 0-0 10 ♘xc4 ♘b6 11 ♘xb6 ab 12 ♕c2 ♕d7 with a free game for Black.

6 ... ♕c8

7 c4

Alternatives:

a) 7 b3 ♘a6 8 0-0 ♗e7 9 c4 (or 9 ♗a3 ♗xa3 10 ♘xa3 0-0 11 c4 c6 12 ♘e5 ♕e6 13 ♖ac1 ♖ac8 = Neikirkh and Tsvetkov) 9 ... 0-0 10 ♘c3 c6 11 ♗b2 ♘e4 12 ♖fc1 ♖fd8 = Alekhine-Euwe, 2nd match game 1935.

b) 7 0-0 when:

b1) 7 ... ♗e7 8 b3 0-0 9 c4 c6 10 ♘c3 ♘a6 - Tartakower and du Mont.
b2) 7 ... ♗d6 8 b3 0-0 9 c4 c6 10 ♘c3 b6 11 ♗b2 g6 12 cd ♘xd5 13 ♘xd5 cd 14 ♖fc1 ♕a6 15 ♕c3 ♖d8 16 ♘e5 ♘d7 17 b4 (Alekhine-Kostic, Bled 1931) 17 ... b5!? =.

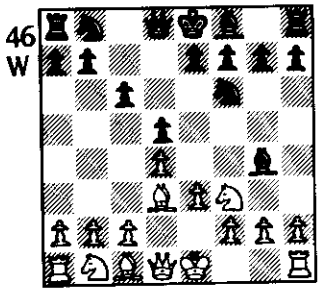
7	...	♘c6
8	a3	♕e6
9	cd	♘xd5

10 ♘c3 ♘f4 11 ♕b5 a6 12 ♕xb7 ♖b8 13 ♕xa6 ♖b6 14 ♕a8+ ♖b8 15 ♕a4 ♘d3+ 16 ♔f1 ♕d7 17 ♕c2 ♘xc1 18 ♖xc1 ♗d6 19 b4 0-0 20 ♘a4 and White won; Sultan Khan v. Milner-Barry, London 1932. Black's play was far too optimistic.

A13

3	...	c6
4	♗d3	♗g4*(46)*

An idea of Alekhine's to improve A11. White might evade it by 4 ♘bd2! and if 4 ... ♗g4 then 5 c4! as suggested by Koltanowski.



5 ♘bd2

According to Koltanowski, 5 c4 would still be slightly better despite the tempo loss if Black plays 5 ... dc. 5 h3 ♗h5 would probably transpose to the next note; here 5 ... ♗xf3 6 ♕xf3 ♘bd7 7 ♕g3 g6 8 c4 ♗g7 9 ♘c3 dc 10 ♗xc4 e5 11 0-0 0-0 12 ♖d1 ed 13 ed ♘b6 14 ♗b3 ♕d7 15 ♕f3 ± Nikolayevsky-Gurevich, Ukraine Ch 1967. White's two bishops were more important than the potential weakness of the isolated d-pawn.

5	...	♘bd7
6	c4	

Alternatively:
a) 6 h3 ♗h5 7 c4 e6 8 0-0 ♗d6 9 ♖e1 0-0 10 e4 de 11 ♘xe4 ♘xe4 12 ♗xe4 ♗g6 led to an early draw in Kolarov-Filchev, Bulgarian Ch 1955.
b) 6 e4!? de 7 ♘xe4 ♘xe4 8 ♗xe4 ♘f6 9 ♕d3 comes into consideration - Neikirkh and Tsvetkov.

6	...	e6

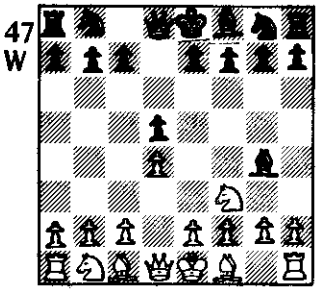
Or:
a) 6 ... dc 7 ♘xc4 ♕c7 8 0-0 ♗xf3 9 ♕xf3 e5 10 de ♘xe5 11 ♕g3 ♘fd7 12 ♗f5! ± - Koltanowski.
b) 6 ... e5!? 7 cd ♘xd5 (7 ... cd 8 de ♘xe5 9 ♗b5+ ♗d7 10 ♗xd7+ gives Black a weak d-pawn - Koltanowski.) 8 h3 (8 0-0 ed 9 ed ♗e7 10 ♘c4 ♘7f6 11 ♘ce5 ♗h5 12 a3 0-0 13 ♗g5 ♕c7 14 ♕c2 ♖ad8 = - Neikirkh and Tsvetkov) 8 ... ♗xf3 (8 ... ♗h5 9 g4 with an active game for White - Neikirkh and Tsvetkov) 9 ♘xf3 ed 10 ♘xd4 ♗b4+ 11 ♗d2 ♕a5 (or 11 ... ♘e5 12 ♗e2) 12 0-0! ♗xd2 13 ♘b3 = - Koltanowski.

7	a3	♗e7
8	♕c2	♗h5
9	b4	

Black is becoming cramped (9 ... a5 10 b5). Koltanowski-Cherta, Sitges 1934, continued 9 ... ♖c8 10 ♘e5 ♗d6 11 f4 ♘g4 12 ♘xg4 ♗xg4 13 0-0 ♕h4?! (better 13 ... a5 and 14 ... 0-0) 14 e4! de 15 ♘xe4 ♗e7 (better 15 ... ♗b8) 16 ♗e3 0-0 17 ♖ae1 ♘f6 18 ♗f2 ♕h6 19 ♘g5 and White soon attacked with f4-f5.

A2

2	...	♗g4*(47)*



3 c4!

3 ♘e5 is a natural reaction, but not so strong. Then:
a) 3 ... ♗f5 4 c4 f6 5 ♘f3 e6 6 ♕b3 b6 7 ♘c3 c6 8 a4 ♘a6 9 cd ed 10 e4 de 11 ♗xa6 ef 12 0-0 ± Lasker-Schiffers, Nuremberg 1896.
b) 3 ... ♗h5 is critical:
b1) 4 g3 ♘d7 5 ♗d3 (better 5 ♗g2 ♘xe5 6 de e6 7 c4 ± Dobosz, *Chess Player* 7) 5 ... e6 6 ♗g2 ♘gf6 7 0-0 ♗d7 8 ♗f4 0-0 9 ♗xd6? (better 9 ♘d2 intending c4 ± - Dobosz) 9 ... cd 10 ♘f4 ♗g6 11 ♘xg6 hg ∓ (0-1, 36) Praszak-Dobosz, Lublin 1974.
b2) 4 g4!? ♗g6 5 h4 (5 ♘xg6 hg 6 ♗g2 e6 = - Dobosz) 5 ... e6! London-St Petersburg, 1886-87 (0-1, 40).
b3) 4 ♕d3 ♕c8 5 c4 f6 6 ♘f3 e6 7 ♘c3 ♗g6 8 ♕d1 c6 9 e3 ♗d6 10 ♗d2 ♘e7 11 ♖c1 ♘d7 12 ♘h4 ± Steinitz-Chigorin, 2nd match game 1889.
b4) 4 c4?! dc 5 ♕a4+ c6 6 ♕xc4 ♘d7 7 ♘xd7 ♕xd7 8 ♘c3 ♖d8 9 ♕b3 (9 e3? e5) 9 ... ♘f6 10 e3 e5! 11 de ♘e4 12 f3 ♘c5 13 ♕c2 ♕e6 14 ♗e2 ♕xe5 15 0-0 ♗g6 16 e4 f5! ∓ Schlechter-Charousek, Nuremburg 1896.

3	...	♗xf3!?

A Koltanowski simultaneous game went instead 3 ... e6 4 ♕b3 b6 5 ♘e5 ♘f6 6 e3 ♗e7 (If 6 ... ♗d6? 7 cd ♗xe5? then 8 de ♘xd5 9 ♕a4+ wins the ♗g4!) 7 cd ed (7 ... ♕xd5 8 ♗b5+ c6 9 ♘xc6 a6 10 ♘xe7+ ♕xb5 11 ♕xb5 ab 12 ♘c8) 8 ♗b5+ ♗d7 9 ♘xd7 ♘bxd7 10 ♗c6 and White won.

Black can transpose to the Chigorin variation of the Queen's Gambit by 3 ... ♘c6 (instead of 3 ... e6 or 3 ... ♗xf3) as in the 10th game of the 1889 match: 4 e3 (best) 4 ... e5!? (or 4 ... e6 5 ♘c3 ♗b4 6 ♕b3 ± Pillsbury-Chigorin, St. Petersburg 1895-96) 5 ♕b3 ♗xf3 (5 ... ♗b4+ 6 ♗d2 ♗xd2+ 7 ♘bxd2 ed 8 cd de 9 fe ♘ce7 10 e4 ± ECO) 6 gf ed 7 cd ♘e5 (7 ... ♘b4 8 e4 ±) 8 ed ♘d7 9 ♘c3 ♕e7+ 10 ♗e3 ♕b4 11 ♕c2 ♘gf6 12 ♗b5 ♖d8 13 0-0-0 a6 14 ♗a4 ♗e7 15 ♖hg1 g6 16 ♗h6 ± (1-0, 27) Steinitz-Chigorin.

4	gf	

4 ef, intending f3-f4, also comes into consideration according to Koltanowski. The text can be

followed up by e4 or (better) e3, ♗g2 and 0-0 when White has the two bishops and targets in Black's weak ♕-side, he said.

The line occurred twice in the Steinitz-Chigorin world championship match of 1889:

a) 4 ... e6 5 cd ♕xd5 (5 ... ed 6 ♕b3 ± Euwe) 6 e4 ♗b4+ 7 ♘c3 ♕a5? (better 7 ... ♕h5) 8 ♗d2 ♘c6 9 d5! ± (4th game).

b) 4 ... dc 5 e4?! (5 e3 ± ECO) 5 ... e5! 6 de ♕xd1+ 7 ♔xd1 ♘c6 8 f4 ♖d8+ 9 ♗d2 ♗c5 10 ♖g1 ♘ge7! ∓ (6th game).

A3

2 ... ♗f5

Koltanowski described this move as 'premature' while Botvinnik wrote that it 'had the advantage that it is comparitively rarely played', implying that there is little else to recommend it. However, the defence is not so easy to deal with in practice. Minev devoted an article to this (and the allied line 1 d4 d5 2 c4 ♗f5) in *Shakhmatny Bulletin 2/1977.*

Once again White has no move as good as:

3 c4! e6

Alternatively:

a) 3 ... dc? 4 ♕a4+ regains the pawn with central control.

b) 3 ... ♘c6? 4 cd ♕xd5 5 ♘c3 and 6 e4 - Koltanowski.

c) 3 ... c6 4 cd cd (4 ... ♕xd5?! 5 ♘c3) 5 ♕b3 ♕c8 6 ♗f4 (not 6 e3?? ♕xc1+) is a sort of Exchange Slav. White follows up with ♘c3 and ♖c1 and has some initiative.

d) 3 ... ♘f6 4 ♕b3! ♘c6 5 ♘c3 (5 ♕xb7? ♗d7! 6 ♘c3 ♖b8 7 ♕a6 ♘b4 ∓∓ Minev) 5 ... e5?! (5 ... e6 below) 6 cd ♘b4? (or 6 ... ♘xd4 7 ♘xd4 ed 8 ♕a4+ c6 9 ♕xd4 ± Levenfish) 7 e4! ♘xe4 8 ♗b5+ c6 9 cd bc 10 ♘xe5! ♗e6 11 ♘xc6 ♕b6 12 ♘xb4 ♕xb5 13 ♕xe6 fe 14 ♘xb5 ♗xb4+ 15 ♔e2 ±± Belavenets-Lisitsin, 10th USSR Ch 1937.

4 ♕b3

Also:

a) 4 cd?! ed 5 ♕b3 ♘c6 6 ♗g5 (6 ♕xb7 ♘b4! or 6 ♗d2 ♖b8 7 ♘c3 ♗e6 - Botvinnik) 6 ... ♗e7 7 ♗xe7 ♘gxe7 8 e3 (8 ♕xb7 ♖b8) 8 ... ♕d6 9 ♘bd2 (9 ♘c3 ♘b4 10 ♖c1 ♗d3) 9 ... 0-0 10 ♖c1 a5! 11 a3 ♖fc8 12 ♗d3 a4 13 ♕c2 ♗xd3 14 ♕xd3 ♘d8 15 0-0 ♘e6 16 ♖c3 (Botvinnik-Keres, World Ch 1948) 16 ... b6 ∓.

b) 4 ♘c3 and now:

b1) 4 ... ♘c6 5 cd ed 6 a3 ♘f6 7 ♗g5 ♗e7 8 e3 ♘e4 9 ♗xe7 ♘xe7 10 ♗d3 0-0 11 0-0 ♖e8 12 ♕e2 ♘xc3 = (½:½, 40) Hohler-Korchnoi, European Teams Ch, Bath 1973.

b2) 4 ... ♘f6 5 ♕b3!? ♘c6 6 ♕xb7?! (6 c5 ± Minev) 6 ... ♘b4 7 ♘b5 ♘g4 8 ♘xc7+ (8 e4 ♖b8! ∓) 8 ... ♕xc7! 9 ♕xa8+ (9 ♕xc7? ♘c2+ mating) 9 ... ♔d7 10 ♘e5+ ♘xe5?! (better 10 ... ♕xe5 - Radulov) 11 de ♘c2+ (11 ... ♘d3+!? - Minev) 12 ♔d1 ♘xa1 13 ♗e3 ♘c2 14 ♗xa7 ∓∓ Learner-West, USA 1974.

b3) 4 ... c6 5 ♕b3 ♕b6 6 c5 ♕xb3 7 ab ♘a6 8 ♗f4 f6 9 e3 ♘b4 10 ♔d2 e5 = Rashkovsky-Belyavsky, USSR 1st League 1977.

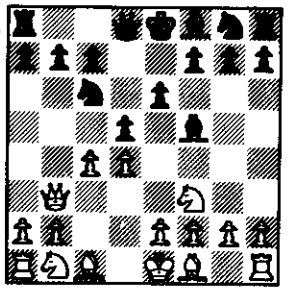
c) 4 e3 ♘f6 5 ♕b3 ♘c6 when:

c1) 6 ♕xb7 ♘b4 7 ♘a3 ♖b8 8 ♕xa7 ♖a8 9 ♕xb7 ♖xa3!? (9 ... ♖b8 draws.) 10 ba ♘c2+ is unclear - Euwe.

c2) 6 c5 ♕c8 (6 ... ♖b8 7 ♗b5 ±) see A32, note b2 to Black's 5th.

c3) 6 ♗d2!? ♖b8 7 ♗e2 (followed by 0-0) with complications in store; Kapelius-Dzindzhikhasvili, USSR 1969.

4 ... ♘c6*(48)*



A31 5 ♗d2

A32 5 c5

If 5 ♗g5!? ♗b4+ (or 5 ... ♕c8!?) 6 ♘c3 dc 7 ♕xc4 ♕d5 - Minev. This needs tests.

Not 5 ♕xb7? ♘b4! and, as in note c1 above, Black has at least a draw.

A31

5 ♗d2 ♖b8

5 ... dc?! was shown to be risky in the 8th Botvinnik-Smyslov match game of 1954: 6 ♕xb7 ♘ge7 (6 ... ♗e4 is somewhat better, e.g. 7 ♘c3 ♖b8 8 ♕a6 ♘b4 9 ♕a4+ ♗c6 10 ♕d1 ±.) 7 ♕b5! ♖b8 8 ♕a4 ♖xb2 9 ♘a3 ♕d7 (9 ... ♖xd2!? should be analysed, e.g. 10 ♔xd2 e5 or 10 ♘xd2 ♕xd4 11 ♖d1 c3 12 ♘dc4 ♕c5.) 10 ♘xc4 ♖b8 11 e3 (±) 11 ... ♘b4 (11 ... ♘d5 12 a3! ±) 12 ♕xd7+ ♔xd7 13 ♗xb4 ♖xb4 14 ♘ce5+ ♔e8 15 ♖d3 f6 16 ♗xf5 and now 16 ... ef! (Botvinnik) should have been played.

6 e3 a6?!

Black's plan of ... dc and ... b5 subsequently fails to materialise. So he should play the more straightforward 6 ... ♘f6 7 ♘c3 ♗e7 which might equalise.

7 ♗d3 ♗xd3

8 ♕xd3 ♘b4

9 ♗xb4 ♗xb4+ 10 ♘bd2 ♘f6 11 0-0 0-0 12 c5 ♗xd2 13 ♘xd2 c6 14 f4 (freezing the centre ready for ♕-side action) 14 ... ♘d7 15 b4 f5?! (15 ... f6 and later ... e5 was the only hope of counterplay.) 16 a4 ♕c7 17 ♖fc1 ♖a8 18 b5 ♖fb8 19 ♘f3 ab (19 ... ♕d8 might be better.) 20 ab ♕d8 21 b6! ♖xa1 22 ♖xa1 h6 23 ♖a7! ± Petrov-Grau, Buenos Aires 1939. White can prepare a breakthrough with an eventual ♘xb7 or ♘xc6. He won in 36 moves.

A32

5 c5 ♖b8*(49)*

Also critical:

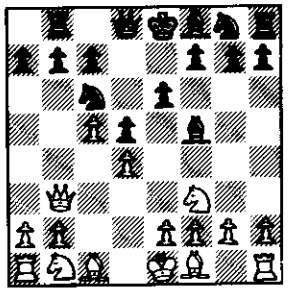
a) 5 ... ♕d7 6 e3 f6 7 ♘c3 ♖b8 8 ♕a4 a6 9 b4 g5 10 ♕b3 (10 b5!? Minev) 10 ... ♘ge7 11 h4 g4 12 ♘d2 ♗h6 13 ♘e2 e5 = O'Kelly-Kostic, Bled 1950.

b) 5 ... ♕c8 and now:

b1) 6 ♗f4 ♘f6 7 ♘c3 ♗e7 8 e3 ± Euwe-Kmoch, Amsterdam 1933.

b2) 6 e3 ♘f6 7 ♗b5 ♘d7 when:

b21) **8 0-0** ♗e7 9 ♕a4 ♘cb8 10 b4 c6 11 ♗e2 ± van den Bosch-Euwe, Amsterdam 1935.
b22) **8 ♗xc6** bc 9 0-0 g6! ∓ Colle-Nimzowitsch, Frankfurt 1930.
b23) **8 ♕a4** ♗e7 9 ♗xc6 bc 10 ♕xc6 0-0 11 0-0 ♖b8 12 ♕a4 (if 12 ♘c3 ♖b4 with good compensation) 12 ... ♗d3 13 ♖e1 e5 14 ♘c3 c6 15 e4 de 16 ♘xe4 ed 17 ♕xd4 ♗xe4 18 ♕xe4 ♗xc5 (Gulko-Dorfman, 45th USSR Ch play-off 1978) and now 19 ♕c2! or 19 ♘g5 ♘f6 20 ♕c2 ± - Moiseyev and Shekhtman in *64*.



6 ♘c3

Koltanowski recommended 6 ♗f4 followed by ♘c3, e3 and ♗f1-e2 or ♗b5 (according to circumstances); the pawn at c5 is a thorn in Black's side.

An example is Flohr-Terpugov, 19th USSR Ch 1951: 6 ♗f4 ♘ge7 7 ♘c3 a6 8 e3 ♘g6 9 ♗g3 ♗e7 10 ♕d1 ♕c7 11 ♗d3 ♗xd3 12 ♕xd3 0-0 13 0-0 f5 14 ♖ab1 ±.

6 ... e5!?

Or 6 ... ♗e7 7 ♗f4 ± Fine-Grau, Stockholm 1937.

7 e4!?

Or perhaps 7 ♘xe5!? Minev analysed 7 ♕xd5 ♕xd5 8 ♘xd5 ed 9 ♘c7+ ♔d7 =.

7	**...**	**ed**
8	**ef**	**dc**
9	**♗b5**	**♗xc5**
10	**0-0 ±**	

Here Black has:
a) **10 ... ♘ge7** 11 ♗xc6+ bc 12 ♕xc3 ♕d6 13 ♕xg7 ± - Portisch.
b) **10 ... ♘f6** 11 ♕xc3 ♕d6 12 ♗f4! ♕xf4 13 ♕xc5 ♕d6 14 ♖fe1 ♘e4 15 ♕xd6 cd 16 ♖ad1 ± Portisch-Keres, Wijk aan Zee 1969.

A4

2 ... ♘c6

Now 3 c4 ♗g4 transposes to the Queen's Gambit, Chigorin Defence. A full treatment of the variation is not possible here, but one example has also tried 3 e3 ♗g4 4 ♗e2 (= ECO) 4 ... ♘f6 5 ♘bd2 ♕d6 (better 5 ... e6 - Lisitsin) 6 b3 e5 7 de ♘xe5 8 ♗b2 ♘xf3+ 9 ♗xf3 ♗f5 (better is 9 ... ♗xf3 10 ♕xf3 ♗e7) 10 0-0 0-0-0 11 c4! dc (11 ... ♗d3 12 ♗e2) 12 ♘xc4 ♕a6 13 ♕c1 ♗e7 14 ♕c3 ± Lisitsin-Holmov, 21st USSR Ch 1954.

White can also consider a form of London System:

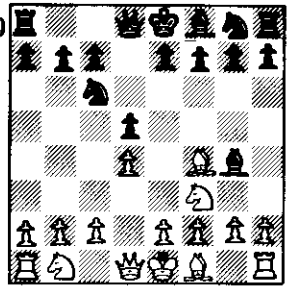
3 ♗f4!? ♗g4*(50)*

Continuing the fight for e5.

If 3 ... ♗f5 4 e3 e6 5 ♗d3 ♘f6 6 ♗xf5 ef 7 ♕d3! ♘e4 8 ♕b5+ ♕d7 9 0-0! ± Euwe-Colle, match 1924.

4 e3

4 c4 won't work here (4 ... dc!). An alternative worth examining is 4 ♘bd2 e.g. 4 ... e6 5 c3 ♗d6 6 ♗g3



♘f6 7 ♘e5 ♗xe5 8 de ♘h5 9 ♕a4 ♘xg3 10 hg ♗f5 11 e3 a6 12 g4 ♗g6 13 0-0-0 b5 14 ♕f4 ♕e7 15 ♘b3 ♖b8 (Black dare not castle.) 16 ♗d3 ♗xd3 17 ♖xd3 a5 18 ♘d4 ♘d7 19 e4 b4 (19 ... c5!?) 20 ed (1-0, 40) Golz-Schmidt, E.German Ch 1968.

4 ... e6
5 ♗e2

A cautionary tale is Langeweg-Dückstein, Zurich 1976: **5 c4** ♘f6 6 cd?? ♗b4+ 0-1 (because if 7 ♘bd2 ♘e4 8 ♗e2 ♗xf3 or 8 dc ♘xd2).

Also playable:
a) **5 h3** ♗h5 6 ♘bd2 ♗d6 = - ECO.
b) **5 ♘bd2**:
b1) **5 ... ♗d6** 6 ♗g3 ♘f6 7 ♗e2 0-0 8 c4 ♕e7 9 ♖c1 ♖fe8 10 a3 ♖ad8 11 0-0 ♗xg3 12 hg ♗f5 13 ♕b3 ♘a5 14 ♕a4 ♘c4 = Zamikhovsky-Ravinsky, USSR 1949.
b2) **5 ... ♘ge7** can also be considered with the idea of ... ♘g6 and ... ♗d6.

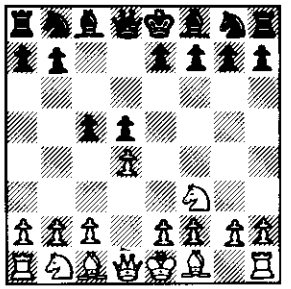
5 ... ♘f6
6 ♘e5 ♗xe2

7 ♕xe2 ♗xe5 8 ♗xe5 c6 9 0-0 ♗e7 10 ♘d2 0-0 11 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 12 c4 ♗e7 = de Greiff-Spassky, Havana 1962.

A5

2 ... *c5(51)*

Black is probably taking on too many commitments with this. In effect he is trying to play the Queen's Gambit himself, a tempo down. It is not easy to demonstrate an outright refutation but White should at least retain the advantage of the move.



A51 3 c4
A52 3 dc!?

Also:
a) **3 e3** is unnecessarily passive, but could transpose into lines of the Colle considered earlier in the book, after 3 ... ♘f6 for example. Others:
a1) Not 3 ... c4?! 4 ♘c3 f5 5 ♘e5 ♘f6 6 b3 ± Pillsbury-Marshall, Buffalo 1901.
a2) 3 ... **♘c6** offers White a last chance to play 4 c4, which however gives him a not very aggressive system against the Tarrasch Defence. Others (4 b3, 4 ♘bd2 or 4 ♗d3?!) allow Black a free position with 4 ... ♗g4, as often demonstrated in games by Dus-Hotimirski before the 1914-18 war.

b) 3 ♗f4 ♕b6?! (3 ... ♘f6 chapter 11) 4 dc ♕xb2 5 ♗e5 ♕b4+ 6 ♘c3 e6 7 ♖b1 ♕xc5 8 ♘b5 ♘a6 9 e3 f6 10 ♗d4 ♕e7 11 ♘xa7 ± Schlechter-Leonhardt, Carlsbad 1911.

c) 3 g3 e6 4 ♗g2 ♘c6 5 0-0 cd (5 ... ♘f6!? 6 c4 is a form of Catalan.) 6 ♘xd4 ♗c5 7 e3 ♘ge7 8 ♘b3 ♗b6 9 ♘1d2 0-0 10 c4 dc 11 ♘xc4 ♕xd1 = Sandor-Karaklajic, Beverwijk 1967.

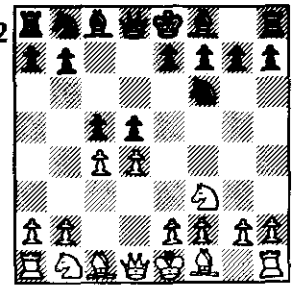
A51

3 c4

This was probably introduced into master praxis by the great Polish strategist Akiba Rubinstein. He usually steered the game into a Queen's Gambit, Tarrasch variation e.g. by 3 ... e6 4 cd ed 5 ♘c3 ♘c6 6 g3. With this system he scored fine victories against Marshall (Breslau 1912) and Capablanca (San Sebastian 1911). Unless Black is a Tarrasch Defence specialist he must reject 3 ... e6 and look for another move.

3 ... ♘f6!? *(52)*

52 W



This position has been comparatively little studied. Other moves:

a) 3 ... cd!? 4 cd ♘f6 see below. Not 4 ... ♕xd5 5 ♘c3! (followed by ♕xd4) nor 4 ... ♕a5+ 5 ♕d2 ♕xd5 6 ♘c3 ♕h5 7 ♘xd4 ♗d7 8 e4 ♘c6 9 f4 - Koltanowski.

b) 3 ... dc when:

b1) 4 dc? ♕xd1+ 5 ♔xd1 ♘c6 6 e3 ♗g4 7 ♗xc4 e6 8 a3 ♗xc5 9 b4 ♗d6 10 ♗b2 ♘f6 11 ♘d2 ♔e7! 12 ♔e2 (better 12 h3 first) 12 ... ♗e5! ∓ Cohn-Rubinstein, St Petersburg 1909.

b2) 4 d5 (or 4 e4!? - Kmoch) 4 ... ♘f6 5 ♘c3 followed by e4 and ♗xc4 with advantage - Koltanowski. 5 ... b5? is of course of no avail because of 6 ♘xb5 ♘xd5? 7 ♕xd5! ♕xd5 8 ♘c7+ etc. What would Rubinstein have done? Black has at any rate a poor form of Benoni.

4 cd

4 dc is also playable. Then:

a) 4 ... ♕a5+? 5 ♗d2 ♕xc5 6 cd ♗f5 7 ♘c3 ♘xd5 8 ♕b3 ♘b4 9 ♗e3 ♕a5 10 ♘d4 ± Holloway-Harding, Cambridge 1972.

b) 4 ... **e6!** (= Pachman) transposes to Alekhine-Kaufman, A52. Does Black really equalize?

4 ... cd

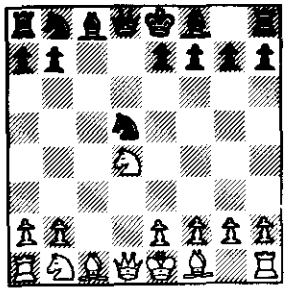
5 ♘xd4!

Thelen-Pachman, Hradec Kralove 1944, went instead 5 ♕xd4 ♕xd5 6 ♘c3 ♕xd4 (6 ... ♕a5!? - Bisguier) 7 ♘xd4 a6! 8 e4 e5 =. Or 8 g3 ♗d7! (Polugayevsky-Vaganian, 42nd USSR Ch 1974) and Black drew with no trouble, but not 8 ... e5 9 ♘c2 ♗d7 10 ♗g2 ♗c6 11 e4! ± - O'Kelly.

5 ... ♘xd5 *(53)*

Or 5 ... a6 6 e4 ♘xe4 7 ♕a4+ ♗d7 8 ♕b3 ♘c5 9 ♕e3 g6 10 ♘f3 ♕c7 11 ♕c3 ± Alekhine-Wolf, Pistyan 1922.

53 B



This is a position from the English Opening (1 c4 c5 2 ♘f3 ♘f6 3 d4 cd 4 ♘xd4 d5 5 cd ♘xd5). That should put it beyond the scope of this volume, but for the fact that most books on the English (e.g. Taimanov's and Cafferty's) do not consider this variation. The following summarises the theory as I find it:

6 e4!

The only move to set Black problems.

6 ... ♘f6

Also critical are:

a) **6 ... ♘b4** 7 ♕a4+ ♘4c6 8 ♘xc6 ♘xc6 9 ♗e3 e.g.:

a1) **9 ... g6** 10 ♘c3 ♗g7 11 ♗b5 ♗d7 12 ♖d1 0-0 13 0-0 ♕c8 14 ♘d5! ♖e8 15 ♗c5! ♗f8 16 ♕a3! ♕d8 17 ♕g3 ♖c8 18 ♗xa7 ± Pachman-Gligoric, Lubliana 1945.

a2) **9 ... ♕a5+** 10 ♕xa5 ♘xa5 11 ♘c3 e6 12 ♗b5+ ♘c6 13 a3 ± - Pirc.

a3) **9 ... ♗d7** 10 ♘c3 e6 11 ♗e2 ♗e7 12 0-0 0-0 (Zita-Louma, Rakovnik 1940) 13 ♖fd1 ± (with chances on the ♕-side) - Pachman.

b) **6 ... ♘c7** (best, according to Pachman) 7 ♘c3 e5 8 ♘db5 ♕xd1+ 9 ♔xd1 ♘xb5 10 ♘xb5 (10 ♗xb5+ ♗d7 = Levin-Pinkus, USA Ch 1946) 10 ... ♘a6 11 ♗e3 ♗e6! (11 ... b6 12 ♗c4 ±) when, thanks to the badly-placed white king Black obtains compensation for the pawn sacrificed. Zita analysed 12 ♘xa7 ♖d8+ 13 ♔c1 ♗c5 and 12 ♗xa7 ♗b4! 13 ♗e3 0-0-0+. This line requires further investigation.

7 ♘c3

Pachman recommends 7 ♗b5+ ♗d7 8 e5!? e.g. 8 ... ♗xb5 9 ♘xb5 ♕xd1+ 10 ♔xd1 ♘d5 11 ♔e2 a6 12 ♖d1 ±.

7 ... e5

'7 ... e6 was preferable' - Kmoch.

8 ♗b5+!

Not 8 ♘db5 (Rubinstein-Reti, Budapest 1926) 8 ... a6! - Kmoch.

8 ... ♗d7

9 ♘f5! ♘c6

10 ♘d6+ ♗xd6 11 ♕xd6 ♕e7 12 ♕xe7+ ♘xe7 13 ♗e3! ± Rubinstein-Mieses, St Petersburg 1909.

A52

3 dc!? *(54)*

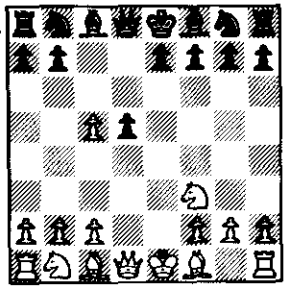
A reversed Queen's Gambit Accepted.

3 ... e6

Alternatives:

a) Alekhine-Kaufman, Odessa 1919, went instead 3 ... **♘f6** 4 c4 e6 5 cd (5 ♘c3 ♗xc5 6 cd is only = according to Neikirkh and Tsvetkov.) 5 ... ed 6 ♗e3 ♘a6 7 g3 ♗xc5 (N and T recommend 7 ... ♘xc5 8 ♗g2 ♗e7 9 0-0 0-0 10 ♘c3

54
B



♗f5 =.) 8 ♗xc5 ♘xc5 9 ♗g2 0-0 10 0-0 ♗f5 (Black has a poor form of Tarrasch Defence now.) 11 ♘c3 ♖e8 12 ♘d4 ♗g6 13 ♗h3! ♘e4 14 ♖c1 ♘xc3 15 ♖xc3 ♘e4 16 ♖b3 ♖b8 17 f4 ±.

b) 3 ... **♕a5+** (Golombek) 4 ♘bd2 ♕xc5 5 e3 ♘c6 6 a3 ± - Euwe.

4 e4!?

Not 4 a3 ♗c5 5 b4 ♗d6 6 ♗b2 ♘f6 7 e3 0-0 8 ♘bd2 a5! ∓ Swiderski-Schlechter, Nuremberg 1896.

4	...	**♗xc5**
5	**♗b5+**	**♘c6**
6	**ed**	

Or 6 0-0 a6 7 ♗a4 ♘ge7 8 ♘c3 d4 9 ♘e2 0-0 10 a3 e5 11 b4 ♗a7 12 ♘g3 ♗e6 13 b5 ab 14 ♗xb5 h6 = Pillsbury-Marshall, New York 1904.

6	...	**ed**
7	**0-0**	**♘ge7**

Not 7 ... ♘f6 8 ♘c3 0-0 9 ♗g5 ♗e7 10 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 11 ♕xd5 ♗xc3 12 ♕xd8 ♖xd8 13 bc ± Lasker-Tarrasch, match 1908.

8 ♘c3

Capablanca-Rubinstein, Bad Kissingen 1928, saw 8 ♘bd2 when Black is a tempo up on the Tarrasch variation of the French Defence (3 ♘d2 c5) and so should have a good game. After 8 ... 0-0 9 ♘b3 ♗b6 10 ♖e1 ♗g4 11 ♗d3 ♘g6 12 h3 ♗xf3 13 ♕xf3 instead of 13 ... ♘ce5? Rubinstein should have played 13 ... ♘ge5 14 ♕d1 ♘xd3 15 ♕xd3 ♕f6 = (16 ♗e3 d4 17 ♗d2 ♖fe8) according to Pachman.

8	...	**0-0**
9	**♗f4**	**♗g4**
10	**♗e2**	**a6**
11	**h3**	**♗e6 =**

Blackburne-Tarrasch, Leipzig 1894.

B

1	**d4**	**♘f6**
2	**♘f3**	

2 ... e6 and 2 ... g6 in this position have already been discussed in detail. Black can also play:

B1 2 ... d6

B2 2 ... c5

Also:

a) **2 ... ♘e4?!** (Keres-Becker, Vienna 1937) might be well met by 3 ♗f4! (compare chapter 5). White is a tempo up on the Trompowski Attack (2 ♗g5 ♘e4 3 ♗f4).

b) **2 ... b6** can be met by either a Colle or London formation, or by 3 ♗g5 (beyond the scope of this book).

c) **2 ... b5!?** is chiefly a psychological move. These Polish/Sokolsky systems for White and Black still await a definitive treatment. I recommend 3 c3 e.g. 3 ... ♗b7 4 a4 a6 5 ab ab 6 ♖xa8 ♗xa8 7 ♕b3.

d) **2 ... f6?** 3 ♘c3 ♗f5 4 ♘h4 ♗g6 5 ♘xg6 hg 6 ♕d3 ♔f7 7 e4 c6 8 ♕f3 e6 9 ♗d3 ± Pillsbury-Magyar, Vienna 1902.

e) **2 ... c6** may be answered by 3 e3 and a Colle formation in which Black cannot readily find counterplay. A ♕-side fianchetto would be pointless and a later ... c5 would cost him a tempo, so 3 ... g6 is his best plan. White can also play 3 c4 (when 3 ... d5 is a Slav Queen's Gambit), 3 ♗f4 or 3 ♗g5!?

B1

2	...	**d6**

Black invites transposition to the Old Indian by 3 c4. White has many possible replies, some of which (3 g3, 3 ♗g5) are beyond the scope of this book.

3 ♘c3!?

This could be played to steer the game into a Pirc Defence (after 3 ... g6).

Other lines with some independent significance are:

a) **3 ♘bd2** ♗f5 (Pachman suggested 3 ... d5!? or 3 ... ♘bd7 4 e4 e5 5 c3 g6.) 4 ♘h4! ♗d7 5 e4 g6 6 ♗c4 c6 7 ♘hf3 ♗g7 8 ♗b3 0-0 9 0-0 a5 10 c3 with a popular Modern Defence position, except that the black bishop is ill-placed on d7. Trifunovic-Puc, Yugoslavia 1967, continued 10 ... b5 11 a3 ♕c7 12 e5 ♘d5 13 ♖e1 a4 14 ♗a2 ♗f5 15 ed ♕xd6 16 ♘e4 ±.

b) A Bogoljubow-Reti game went instead **3 ♗f4** ♘bd7 4 ♘bd2 g6 5 e4 ♗g7 6 ♗d3 0-0 with a position akin to the Geller system against the Modern Defence. The continuation was 7 h3 c6 (better 7 ... ♖e8 - Reti) 8 0-0 ♕c7 9 ♗h2 e5 10 c3 ♘h5 11 a4! a5 12 ♘c4 b5 13 ab c6 14 ♘e3 ♘b6 15 g4! ±.

This game can be found complete in Reti's book *Masters of the Chess Board*.

3 ... ♗g4

Other alternatives to 3 ... g6 are:

a) **3 ... ♗f5** 4 ♘h4 e6 5 ♘xf5 ef 6 ♕d3 ♕d7 7 g3 d5 8 ♗g2 c6 = Sämisch-Reti, Pistyan 1922.

b) **3 ... d5** was recommended by Pachman in view of 4 ♗g5? ♘e4 and 4 ♗f4 ♗f5 5 e3 e6 followed by ... ♗e7, ... 0-0 and ... c5. But an interesting alternative is 4 ♕d3, e.g. 4 ... ♘bd7 5 ♗g5 e6 6 e4 ♗e7 (a sort of French Defence!) 7 e5 ♘e4!? 8 ♗xe7 ♕xe7 9 ♘xe4 de 10 ♕xe4 ♕b4 11 ♘d2 ♕xb2 12 ♖b1 ♕xa2 13 ♗d3 with compensation for the pawn; Smyslov-Bednarski, Havana 1967.

4	**e4**	**♘bd7?!**

4 ... e6 is better.

5	**e5**	**♘g8**
6	**h3**	**♗xf3**

7 ♕xf3 c6 8 ♗f4 d5 (8 ... e6! ± *Informator 25*) 9 e6! fe 10 ♗d3 ♘gf6 11 ♕e2 ± e.g. 11 ... g6 12 ♕xe6 ♗g7 13 0-0 (13 0-0-0) 13 ... ♘h5 14 ♗g5!? (14 ♗e3) 14 ... ♘f8?! (14 ... ♗d4! ∞) Kasparov-Lutikov, Sokolsky Mem., Minsk 1978.

B2

2	...	**c5**

Now 3 c4 is an English - which would transpose to A51 - and could also become a Catalan or Tarrasch Defence.

White can also steer for a Colle by

the conservative 3 e3 or play:

3 d5 b5!?

The alternative is 3 ... d6, which will normally transpose to the Modern Benoni (or at least some sort of Benoni) after White's best move 4 c4.

The only line of independent significance is Spielmann's 3 ... d6 4 ♘c3 ♗f5!?:

a) 5 g3 h6 (5 ... ♘e4! = Pachman) 6 ♗d2 g5 7 h4?! (better 7 0-0) 7 ... g4 8 ♘d2 ♘bd7 9 e4 ♗g6 10 ♘c4 ♗g7 11 ♗f4 0-0 12 ♕d2 ♔h7 13 f3 b5! 14 fg (14 ♘e3 b4 or 14 ♘xb5 gf 15 ♗xf3 ♘xe4) 14 ... bc 15 h5?! ♗xe4 16 ♗xe4 ♘xe4 17 ♘xe4 ♗xb2 18 ♖b1 ♘e5! 19 ♔f1 c3 20 ♕e2 ♕d7 (0-1, 30) Kmoch-Spielmann, Vienna 1922.

b) 5 ♘d2 g5! 6 e4 ♗g6 when:

b1) 7 h4 g4 8 ♗d3 ♘bd7 9 ♘c4 a6 10 a4 b6 11 ♗f4 ♘h5! = Grünfeld-Spielmann, Innsbruck 1922.

b2) 7 ♗e2 ♗g7 8 0-0 ♘bd7 9 ♖e1? (After 9 f4!? might Black play for ♔-side castling?) 9 ... 0-0 10 ♗f1 ♘e5 11 ♘f3 ♘xf3+ 12 ♕xf3 h6 13 ♕d1 (White fails to find a plan.) 13 ... ♘d7 14 ♗e3 ♘e5 15 f3 f5 ∓ Grünfeld-Spielmann, Pistyan 1922.

4 c4*(55)*

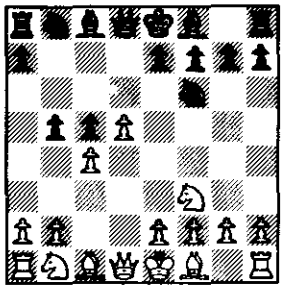
4 ♗g5!? could be played to complicate the game, and 4 ... ♕b6!? is an interesting reply.

4 ... ♗b7

4 ... e6 transposes to the Blumenfeld Counter Gambit.

4 ... d6 or 4 ... g6 would become

55
B



a Benko Gambit.

5 a4

Best according to Pachman, who analyses:

a) 5 ♕c2 e6! ∓.

b) 5 ♘c3 b4 6 ♘b1 e6 ∓.

5 ... bc

6 ♘c3

Here Black has:

a) 6 ... e6 7 e4 (±) 7 ... ♘xe4!? 8 ♘xe4 ed 9 ♘c3 d4 10 ♗xc4! dc 11 ♗xf7+ ♔xf7 12 ♕b3+ ± Rubinstein-Spielmann, Vienna 1922.

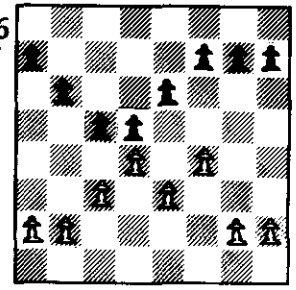
b) 6 ... d6! 7 e4 g6 8 ♗xc4 ♗g7 9 0-0. There is insufficient experience with this sort of position, which can arise when the Benko Gambit (1 d4 ♘f6 2 c4 c5 3 d5 b5) is met by 4 a4 bc.

Since the player of Queen Pawn Openings presumably chooses 2 ♘f3 rather than 2 c4 to avoid defences like the Benoni, my advice is to avoid all this sort of thing by not playing 3 d5. Instead 3 c4 or 3 e3 (which should transpose to lines considered earlier in the book, or to a symmetrical Queen's Gambit Tarrasch) are recommended.

8 Stonewall (2 e3 with f4 and c3)

This opening, though rarely seen nowadays, was not uncommon before the 1914-18 war. It is characterised by the white pawn structure shown in diagram *56*.

56
W



It is easy to see why this formation is called the stonewall! White sets up a barrier on the dark squares and intends to place a knight on e5 in the middle-game, or to attack on the ♔-side with moves like g2-g4-g5 and/or f4-f5. The disadvantages of the opening are the hemmed-in queen's bishop (even more restricted in its scope than in the Colle) and the very slow development of White's attack which gives plenty of time to Black to arrange his counter-blows.

Black's bishops stand best on b7 and e7 against the Stonewall. Nor should he be in any hurry to castle. White is better placed to attack on the ♔-side than in the centre.

1 d4 d5

White can also set about stonewalling against 1 ... ♘f6 by 2 e3 etc., but Black has an even wider range of counters:

a) 2 ... c5 3 c3 b6 followed by ... ♗b7, ... d6, ... ♘bd7 and an eventual ... e5.

b) 2 ... b6 3 f4 ♗b7 4 ♘f3 c5 5 ♗d3 g6 6 0-0 ♗g7 7 c3 0-0 8 ♕e1 d5 (8 ... d6!? Δ ... e5) 9 ♕h4 ♗a6 10 ♗xa6 ♘xa6 11 ♘bd2 b5 12 a3 ♕b6 13 ♘e5 ♖ac8 14 g4 ... Black has a sound development but White retains prospects of a ♔-side attack, Kan-Alatortsev, USSR Young Masters 1936.

c) 2 ... d5 was tried in Nenarokov-Grekov, Moscow Ch 1928. That game continued 3 ♗d3 c5 4 c3 ♘bd7 5 f4 ♘e4 6 ♗xe4 de 7 ♘d2 f5 8 ♘h3 b6 9 ♘xe4! fe 10 ♕h5+ g6 11 ♕d5 ♖b8 12 ♘g5 e6 13 ♘xe6

♕h4+ 14 g3 ♕f6 15 ♕xe4 ♗b7 16 d5 ♔f7 17 ♕a4 ♕e7 18 e4 ♗g7 19 0-0 ♖he8 20 f5 ♔g8 21 ♗f4 ♘e5 22 ♖ad1 gf 23 ef a6 24 ♕e4 ♘f7 25 ♗xb8 ♖xb8 26 f6 ♗xf6 27 ♕f5 ♗g7 28 d6 ♘xd6 29 ♖xd6 1-0.

2 e3 ♘f6

2 ... e6 3 ♗d3 c5 4 c3 ♘c6 5 f4 g5!? 6 fg ♕xg5 7 ♘f3 ♕g4 8 ♕e2 f5 9 ♘bd2 ♘f6 10 ♘f1 ♖g8 (Showalter-Maroczy, London 1899) is unclear.

3 ♗d3 c5

This is generally played, to gain space, but is not absolutely forced.

Instead 3 ... ♘c6 4 f4 has been met by:

a) 4 ... **♗g4** 5 ♘f3 e6 6 c3 ♗e7 7 ♘bd2 0-0 8 ♕e2 ♘h5?! (8 ... ♗f5!? - Neikirkh and Tsvetkov) 9 ♗xh7+ ♔xh7 10 ♘g5+ ♗xg5 11 ♕xg4 ♘xf4 12 ef ♗h6 13 ♘f3 ± Lundquist-Reyes, Moscow 1956.

b) 4 ... **e6** 5 a3 (instead of c3 since ... c5 has been omitted) 5 ... ♗d6 6 ♘f3 0-0 7 ♘c3 b6 8 ♘e5 ♗b7 9 ♕f3 ♘d7 10 ♕h3 f5! = Lee-Chigorin, London 1899.

c) 4 ... **♘b4** 5 ♘f3 ♘xd3+ and now:

c1) **6 ♕xd3** e6 7 0-0 ♗e7 8 b3 0-0 9 c4 b6 10 ♘c3 ♗b7 11 ♗b2 c5 12 ♖ac1 ♖c8 13 ♘e5 ♘e4 = Gottschall-Schlechter, Munich 1900.

c2) **6 cd** e6 (6 ... g6 may also equalize.) 7 0-0 ♗e7 8 ♘bd2 0-0 9 ♕c2 ♗d7 10 ♘b3 ♗a4 11 ♕c3 b6 12 ♕e1 c5 ∓ Tarrasch-Chigorin, Hastings 1895.

3 ... g6 is also possible, e.g. 4 ♘d2 ♗g7 5 f4 c5 6 c3 ♕c7 7 ♘e2 (7 ♕e2 0-0 8 ♘gf3!? may hold the balance - ECO.) 7 ... ♗f5 8 ♗xf5 gf 9 0-0 ♘bd7 10 ♘f3 ♘e4 11 ♗d2 e6 12 ♗e1 0-0-0 ∓ Goldberg-Kamyshov, USSR 1949.

4 c3

Other possibilities (4 ♘c3!?) have not yet been explored.

4 ... e6

Other possibilities:

a) 4 ... **♘c6** 5 f4 ♗g4 (5 ... g6!? ECO; 5 ... e6 below) 6 ♘f3 e6 7 ♘bd2 (7 0-0 ♗d6 8 ♕e1 0-0 9 ♘e5 ♗f5! ∓ Pachman) 7 ... ♗d6 8 g3? (or 8 0-0 cd! ∓) 8 ... ♖c8 9 0-0 ♘d7 10 ♕e1 0-0 11 e4 cd 12 ♘xd4 ♕b6 13 ♕f2 e5! 14 ed ♘e7 15 fe ♘xe5 16 ♗e4 f5 ∓ Oskam-Euwe, corres 1920.

b) 4 ... **♘bd7** 5 f4 g6 6 ♘f3 ♗g7 7 ♘bd2 (7 0-0 0-0 8 ♘e5 ♕c7 ∓) 7 ... b6 (7 ... 0-0 is premature, and White may attack with h3, g4 etc.) 8 ♘bd2 ♗b7 is a reversed Dutch.

c) 4 ... **♕c7** 5 f4 ♗g4 6 ♘f3 e6 7 ♕a4 ♘bd7 8 ♘e5 c4 9 ♘xg4 ♘xg4 10 ♗e2 ♘h6 11 b3 cb 12 ab a6 13 0-0 ♗d6 14 c4 0-0 15 c5 ♗e7 16 b4 ± Chajes-Capablanca, New York 1911.

5 f4 ♘c6

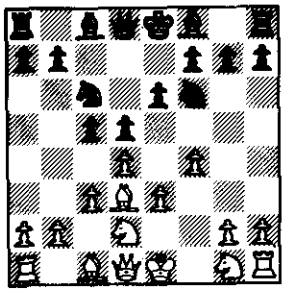
6 ♘d2 *(57)*

Or 6 ♘f3 ♘e4 7 0-0 f5 8 ♘e5 ♘xe5 9 fe ♗d7 10 ♘d2 ♗e7 11 ♘xe4 de 12 ♗c4 b5 13 ♗b3 c4 14 ♗c2 0-0 15 ♖d2 ♗c6 ∓ Marshall-Capablanca, New York 1911.

6 ... ♗d6

The most common response, but the bishop may be better placed on e7 so that an invasion by White's ♘e5 can be repulsed by ... ♘xe5 followed by ... ♘fd7 and ... f6.

57
B



Others:

a) **6 ... ♗d7?** 7 ♘gf3? (better 7 ♕e2 to avoid the next possibility) 7 ... ♗e7? (missing 7 ... ♘g4, a tempo gain allowing Black to set up a counter-Stonewall by 8 ♕e2 f5) 8 0-0 ♕c7 9 ♘e5 ♗d6? (The best hope now is 9 ... 0-0 intending ... ♘e8 and ... f6.) 10 ♕f3 cd? (Releases the tension; 10 ... c4 would be even worse.) 11 ed ♖b8 12 g4 b5 13 g5 ♘g8 14 ♕h5 g6 15 ♗xg6 fg 16 ♘xg6 hg 17 ♕xh8 ♔f8 18 ♘f3 ♗e8 19 ♘e5 b4 20 ♖f3 ♘ce7 21 ♖h3 ♗xe5 22 fe ♘f5 23 ♗d2 b3 24 ♖h7 ♕a5 25 ♖f1 1-0 was a junior game, annotated by Barden in *The Field*, 1975.

b) **6 ... b6** 7 ♘gf3 ♗b7 8 ♘e5 c4 (better 8 ... ♕c7) 9 ♗c2 b5 10 0-0 g6 11 e4 ♘e7 12 a4 a6 13 ab ab 14 ♖xa8 ♕xa8 15 f5! ♗g7 16 ♘xf7!? (Alekhine-Liubimov, Moscow 1909) is unclear, but 16 ♘g4 (Alekhine) would have given White the initiative without the risks of a sacrifice.

c) **6 ... ♗e7** 7 ♘gf3 0-0 8 ♘e5 ♕c7 9 0-0 b6?! 10 g4 (Sheila Jackson-B. Green, Manchester Open 1974) 10 ... ♘e5! 11 fe ♘d7 and Black plays on the ♕-side - J.E.Littlewood in *Chess*.

d) **6 ... ♕c7** sets a positional trap:

d1) **7 ♘gf3?** cd! 8 cd? (According to Nimzowitsch, White would have compensation for the pawn after 8 ed ♕xf4 9 ♘c4 ♕c7 10 ♘ce5 ♗d6 11 ♕e2.) 8 ... ♘b4 9 ♗b1 ♗d7 10 a3 ♖c8! 11 0-0 ♗b5! 12 ♖e1 ♘c2 13 ♗xc2 ♕xc2 14 ♕xc2 ♖xc2 15 h3 ♗d6 16 ♘b1 ♘e4 17 ♘fd2 ♗d3 ∓ (0-1, 37) Van Vliet v. Znosko-Borowski, Ostend 1907.

d2) '**7 ♘h3** followed by ♕f3 would have been the better course' - Nimzowitsch, *My System* (p.193).

d3) **7 ♘df3** ♘e4 8 ♘e5 cd 9 ♗xe4 ♘xe5 10 fe de 11 ed f5! 12 ef gf 13 ♕h5 ♕f7 14 ♕b5 ♕d7 15 ♕h5 ♕f7 ½:½ Marshall-Capablanca, match 1909.

7 ♘h3!?

Bagirov recommends 7 ♕f3 in ECO, e.g. 7 ... ♗d7 8 ♘h3 ♕b6 9 ♘f2 0-0-0 10 0-0 ♔b8 11 e4 de 12 ♘fxe4 ♘xe4 13 ♘xe4 ♗e7 14 dc ♗xc5 15 ♘xc5 ♕xc5 16 ♗e3 ± Marshall-Rubinstein, Vienna 1908.

7 ♘gf3 is also good:

a) 7 ... **b6** 8 ♘e5 ♗b7 9 ♕f3 ± Sultan Khan-Rubinstein, Prague 1931.

b) 7 ... **cd** 8 cd ♗d7 9 a3 ♖c8 10 ♕e2 ♕b6 11 0-0 ♘e7 12 ♘e5 ♗c6 13 b4 ♗a4 14 ♗b2 ♗c2 15 ♖ac1 ♗xd3 16 ♕xd3 0-0 17 ♘b3 (Maroczy-Janowski, Vienna 1902). White won in 42 moves, but is Black at a serious disadvantage?

7 ... ♕c7

Other tries:

a) 7 ... ♕b6 8 0-0 ♗d7 9 ♔h1 0-0-0 10 ♘f3 ♗e8 11 ♘f2 ♘d7 12 ♕e2 f6 13 c4 ♗h5 14 g4 ♗f7 15 a3 ♖he8 16 dc ♘xc5 17 b4 (1-0, 46) Breyer-Leonhardt, Berlin 1920.

b) 7 ... ♗d7 see below.

8 0-0 ♗d7

Possibly 8 ... b6 and 9 ... ♗b7 is better.

9 ♕e2 ♖d8

10 ♘f3 0-0

11 ♘e5 ♗c8 12 ♘f2 b6 13 ♕f3 ♗b7 14 g4 ♘e7 15 g5 ♘e8 16 ♕h3 g6 17 ♘fg4 f5 18 ♘h6+ ♔g7 19 ♕h4 ♘g8 20 ♖f3! ♘xh6? (Loses; Black should play 20 ... ♗xe5 first.) 21 ♕xh6+ ♔g8 22 ♘xg6! hg 23 ♕xg6+ ♕g7 (23 ... ♘g7 24 ♖h3 followed by ♗e2) 24 ♕xe6+ ♕f7 25 ♗xf5 ♘g7 26 ♗h7+! ♔xh7? (26 ... ♔h8 27 ♕h6 ♕h5 28 ♖h3 ♕xh6 29 ♖xh6) 27 ♕h6+ ♔g8 28 g6 1-0 Sorokin-Talvik, Tbilisi Ch 1929.

Summary

The main column line (after 6 ... ♗d6) tends to favour White, because his centre is so solid that Black has difficulty in finding central counterplay against the almost automatic White ♔-side build-up. However, there are several promising suggestions for Black in the notes.

9 Blackmar-Diemer Gambit (2 e4)

The Blackmar-Diemer Gambit (1 d4 d5 2 e4 de 3 ♘c3 ♘f6 4 f3) is one of the small class of openings which, although they must be considered dubious from an objective viewpoint, have the capacity to inspire fanatical devotion in some players. White sacrifices a central pawn and apparently jeopardises the safety of his king. On the other hand, Black is set unfamiliar problems and (because of the very outrageousness of the gambit) is often waging a psychological war within himself at the same time as trying to solve the problems on the board.

A loss against the Blackmar-Diemer in a serious game is one of the most ignominious fates that can befall a chess player - especially as Black losses tend to be short and catastrophic - and Black is loth even to draw. All this of course helps White! So does the fact that most masters who have written on the opening (e.g. Pachman) have tended to under-estimate the dangers that Black faces. The treatment of the gambit by Bagirov in ECO is manifestly inadequate - just one note, a few lines only.

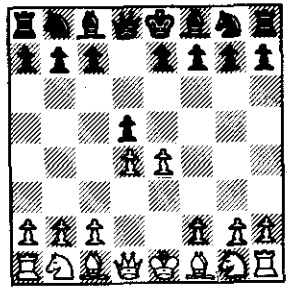
The Blackmar-Diemer is the epitome of coffee-house chess and the people who employ it are often very resourceful players who have studied the published analyses (e.g. by Diemer, Gunderam, Tejler and Kampars) and have worked out their own ways of dealing with the standard defences. Therefore Black should temper with caution his joy at receiving a free pawn when his opponent ventures to play the gambit against him.

The difficulty in dealing adequately with the Blackmar-Diemer in a theoretical work is not a shortage of practical examples and analyses; rather the contrary. The problem is that these ideas have rarely been tested in the fire of international competition among masters. In the majority of available games one or other side plays unconvincingly. It is often very hard to assess whether White has or has not sufficient compensation for

his pawn in the absence of top-class games. Whether you will be successful with the Blackmar-Diemer chiefly depends on your style and on the level of opposition which you meet. In a friendly or lightning game, however, I am all for playing this gambit: it leads almost inevitably to unusual and exciting games.

1 d4 d5
2 e4*(58)*

58
B



First discussed by the New Orleans player A.E.Blackmar in *Brentano's Chess Monthly*, in 1882.

2 ... de

Black can play 2 ... e6 (French) or 2 ... c6 (Caro-Kann) but if 2 ... e5? 3 ♗e3 de 4 f3 f5 (4 ... ♘f6 5 fe ♘xe4 6 ♗d3!) 5 fe! and if 5 ... ♕h4+ 6 g3! ♕xe4+ 7 ♕e2 ♕xh1 8 ♗g2 ± - Diemer.

3 ♘c3!

This was recommended by von Popiel in *Deutsches Wochenschach*, 1893.

Blackmar's 3 f3 is bad because of 3 ... e5! e.g. 4 de (or 4 d5 ♗c5!) 4 ... ♕xd1+ 5 ♔xd1 ♘c6 (Diemer) 6 ♗f4 ♘ge7 ∓ - Korn.

3 ... ♘f6

Not 3 ... ♗f5? 4 f3 ef 5 ♕xf3 ♗c8 6 ♗f4 ♘f6 7 0-0-0 c6 8 d5! ♗g4? 9 dc! ±± Boyarinov-Utemov, USSR 1962.

3 ... e5?! is complicated. Diemer devotes nearly twenty pages to attempts to refute it (4 de - von Popiel; also 4 d5!? or 4 ♘xe4 are discussed at length) but we shall follow Arthur Hall's recommendation in *Chess* (1964). White can play 4 ♗e3 with good compensation, e.g.:

a) 4 ... ♗f5 5 ♗c4 ♘e7 6 f3 ♘c6 7 d5 ef ('too good to be true' - Diemer) 8 ♘xf3 ♘b4 9 ♗b3 ♘g6 10 0-0 ♗d6 11 a3 ♘a6 12 ♘g5 ♘f4 13 ♗xf4 ef 14 ♖e1+ ♗e7 (14 ... ♔f8 had to be tried.) 15 ♘xf7! ♔xf7 16 d6+ ♔g6 17 ♖xe7 h6 18 ♗f7+ ♔h7 19 ♕h5 ♗xc2 20 ♘e4 ♗xe4 21 ♖xe4 ♕f6 22 ♖e6 ♕g5 23 ♗g6+ ♔g8 24 ♖ae1! ♖f8 25 ♖e8 ♕xh5 26 ♖xf8+ 1-0 H.Schmidt-Melcher, W.Germany 1956.

b) 4 ... ed 5 ♗xd4! and now:

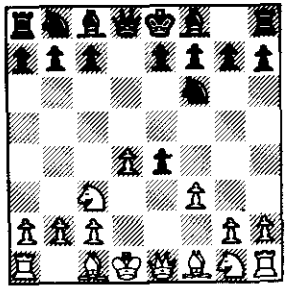
b1) 5 ... ♘c6 6 ♗b5 ♗d7 7 ♘ge2 ♘xd4 8 ♕xd4 ♘f6 9 ♘xe4! ♗xb5 10 ♕e5+ ♕e7 11 ♘xf6+ gf 12 ♕xb5+ c6 (Mabbs-Karaklajic, Bognor Regis 1960) 13 ♕c4! ±. The game went 13 ♕f5 and was eventually drawn.

b2) If 5 ... c5 6 ♗e5! ♕xd1+ 7 ♖xd1+ e.g. 7 ... ♘c6 (or ... ♘d7) 8 ♘b5; 7 ... ♗f5 (or ... ♗g4) 8 ♗b5+; 7 ... f6 8 ♗xb8 or finally 7 ... ♘f6 8 f3 - Diemer.

4 f3*(59)*

4 ♗g5, transposing to what is now known as the Richter-Veresov Attack, was von Popiel's plan. The synthesis of 3 ♘c3 and 4 f3 deserves to be called the Blackmar-Diemer Gambit, though as he explains in his book (p.15) Diemer found this move-order in a footnote to the *Handbuch des Schachspiels*; it had been played in 1889 by one Dr. Ryder of Leipzig.

59
B



Only two moves are worth considering here:

A 4 ... ♗f5

B 4 ... ef

Others in brief:

a) 4 ... e5? 5 de! ♕xd1+ 6 ♔xd1! ♘fd7 7 ♘d5 ♔d8 (the exchange sacrifice is unsound.) 8 ♗g5+ f6 9 ef gf 10 ♘xf6 ♗e7 (10 ... h6 11 ♘xd7+) 11 ♘xe4 ♘c5 12 ♘h3 ♘7e5 13 ♘f4 ♗f5 14 ♗xe7+ ±± Diemer-Elbert, W.Germany 1949.

b) 4 ... e6 5 fe ♗b4 6 ♗d3! ♘xe4 (6 ... c5 7 a3!) 7 ♘ge2! (7 ♗xe4? ♕h4+) 7 ... ♘f6 (7 ... ♕d5 8 ♗e3! - Hall) 8 0-0 b6 9 ♗g5 ♗e7 10 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 11 ♗e4 c6 12 d5! ♕d7 (12 ... cd 13 ♘xd5) 13 de ♕xe6 14 ♘f4 ♕c4 15 ♗d3 ♕c5+ 16 ♔h1 0-0 17 ♘e4 ♕e7 18 ♕h5 ♘d7 19 ♖ae1 ♕d8 20 ♖e3 ♗xb2 21 ♕xh7+!! ♔xh7 22 ♘f6+ ♔h6 23 ♖h3+ ♔g5 24 ♘h7+ (24 ♘e6+!) 24 ... ♔g4 25 ♘h5 ♕f6 26 ♘5xf6+ ♘xf6 27 ♗e2 mate; Duthilleul-Hachin, Rouen 1956.

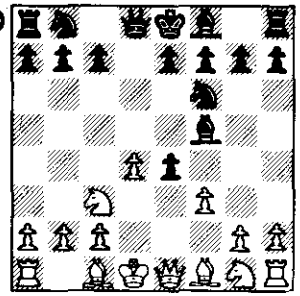
c) 4 ... c6 5 ♘xe4 (5 fe e5! O'Kelly) 5 ... ♘xe4 6 fe e5 7 ♘f3 ed 8 ♗c4! - Diemer.

d) 4 ... c5!? 5 d5 ef 6 ♕xf3 (6 ♘xf3 g6 compare B12) 6 ... ♗g4 (6 ... g6!? - Hall) 7 ♗b5+ ♘bd7 8 ♕f2 e6 9 h3 ♗f5 10 ♗g5 ♗e7 11 d6! ♗xd6 12 0-0-0 ♕c7 (Braune-Bares, W. German Junior Ch 1949) 13 ♗xf6! gf 14 g4 ♗g6 15 ♕xf6 0-0 16 ♗xd7 ♕xd7 17 h4 ±± - Diemer.

A

4 ... ♗f5*(60)*

60
B



Hans Müller's Vienna Defence, which is based on sensible grounds. Since most of Black's losses are due to backward development, resulting from pawn-grabbing, why should Black not refuse the pawn and develop instead? White's fourth move, weakening his ♔-side, means that he cannot switch to a positional game, but must find ways to complicate - usually at the cost of

further holes in his ♔-side pawn structure.

White can now try:

A1 5 g4

A2 5 fe

Diemer also considers 5 d5 (when I suggest 5 ... e6!) and 5 ♗g5 (5 ... ♘bd7).

Then there is the Soller Attack: 5 ♗c4 e6 6 g4 (If 6 fe ♘xe4 7 ♘f3 ♗e7! ∓) 6 ... ♘xg4 7 fg ♕h4+ 8 ♔f1 ♗xg4 with active counterplay; Bellin-Böhm, London 1977.

A1

5 g4 ♗g6

White hopes to harass the minor pieces and use the advanced pawns in an eventual attack on the castled king, but his own king is in at least equal danger.

6 h4 *(61)*

This at least has the merit of consistency. Others:

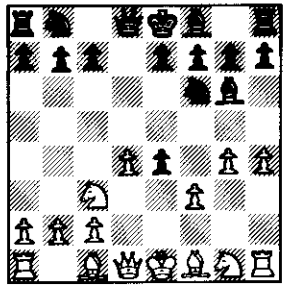
a) **6 f4** e6 7 ♗g2 ♗b4? 8 a3 ♗xc3+ 9 bc ± was suggested by the German postal player M.Kloss. However, Euwe's 7 ... c5 is a considerable improvement.

b) **6 g5** ♘d5 (6 ... ♘h5!? - Baumbach; 6 ... ♘fd7!? - Euwe) when:

b1) **7 ♘xe4** 'recovers the pawn but leads to an inferior position for White as he has no compensation for the ♔-side weakness' as Mednis said. Tartakower-Simonovic, Paris 1954, continued 7 ... e6 8 c4 ♘e7! (not 8 ... ♗b4+? 9 ♔e2! trapping a piece) 9 ♘g3 ♘bc6 10 ♗e3 ♘f5 11 ♘xf5 ♗xf5 12 ♗h3 ♗xh3 13 ♘xh3 and now either 13 ... ♗e7 as played or 13 ... ♘e7! (Diemer) would be strong.

b2) **7 ♗g2** (Peters) and **7 fe** (Kampars) have also been tried, but cannot hope to alter the fundamental drawbacks of White's game.

61
B



6 ... h5

Two cautionary tales:

a) Elgstrand-Honfi, Candidates, ½-final World Corres Ch 1959: **6 ... h6!?** ('unclear' - ECO) 7 ♘h3! c6 (7 ... ef 8 ♕xf3 ♘c6? 9 ♗b5 Weissleder-Svensson, *Fernschach* 1971) 8 ♘f4 ♕d6 9 ♗e3 e5 10 ♘xg6 fg 11 de ♕xe5 12 f4 ♕a5 13 g5! hg 14 fg ♘d5 15 ♕g4! ♘d7 16 ♕xe4+ ♘e7 17 0-0-0 0-0-0 18 ♗h3 ♘f5 19 h5! ♖xh5 20 ♕e6 ♗c5 21 ♗f4 ♗d4 22 ♕xg6 ♗xc3 23 bc 1-0.

b) Nilssen-Anderssen, Grenaa 1973: **6 ... ef?!** 7 ♕xf3 c6 (7 ... ♘c6 8 ♗b5 - *Informator 17*) 8 h5! ♗xc2 9 ♖h2!? (Diemer gave 9 ♕e2 ♕xd4 10 ♕xc2 ♕g4 11 ♕h2!) 9 ... ♕xd4 10 ♖xc2 ♕xg1 11 ♖g2 ♕d4 12 ♗e3 ♕d8 13 ♖d2 ♘bd7 14 0-0-0 with compensation for the pawns. There followed 14 ... ♕a5 (better 14 ... h6) 15 g5 ♘e5 16 ♕e2 ♘fd7 17 ♗f4 e6 18 ♖e1 f6 19 ♗h3 0-0-0 20 ♗xe6 ♗b4 21 ♗xe5 fe 22 ♖ed1 ♗xc3 23 ♖xd7! ♖xd7 24 ♖xd7 ♔b8 25 bc ♕xc3+ 26 ♕c2 ♕e3+ 27 ♕d2 ♕c5+ 28 ♔b2 ♕b5+ 29 ♗b3 a5 30 a4 ♕f1 31 ♕xa5 1-0.

7 g5 ♘d5

If 7 ... ♘fd7 (Müller) White can try 8 ♘xe4 e5 9 ♘e2 (Gunderam) or 8 ♕e2!? (Diemer) rather than 8 fe e5 9 de ♘c6 which Black wants.

8 ♘xe4 e6?!

As Euwe says, a conclusive judgement on the variation must await the testing of his improvement 8 ... c6!? 9 c4 ♘c7 10 ♘h3 ♘d7 11 ♘f4 e5! This may offer Black sufficient counter-chances, but can hardly be called a refutation of the Blackmar-Diemer gambit.

After 8 ... e6 White has several promising continuations:

a) **9 ♘h3** ♘d7 10 c4 ♘5b6 11 ♘f4 ± (Diemer-Asgstrom, Gothenburg 1958) is the line quoted by Euwe.

b) Gunderam suggests **9 c3** ♘bd7 10 ♗d3 e.g.:

b1) **10 ... c5** 11 ♘e2 cd (11 ... ♖c8 12 0-0 or 11 ... ♗e7 12 ♕c2) 12 ♘xd4 e5 (12 ... ♘e5 13 ♗b5+) 13 ♘b5 ♕b6 14 a4 ♘e3 15 ♕e2, or

b2) **10 ... e5** 11 ♕b3 ♘7b6 12 ♘e2 intending ♗d2 and c4.

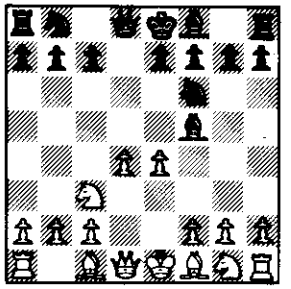
c) **9 ♗c4** (9 a3!? - Diemer) 9 ... ♘b6? 10 ♗b3 ♘c6 11 c3 ♗d6 12 ♘e2 0-0 is an example of what Black should avoid. White has a decisive attack: 13 ♘xf4 ♗xe4 14 fe g6 15 e5 ♗e7 16 ♘xh5! gh? (16 ... ♘xe5 17 de ♕xd1+ 18 ♗xd1 ±) 17 ♕xh5 ♘xd4 18 g6! ♘f3+ 19 ♔e2! fg 20 ♕xg6+ ♔h8 21 ♕h6+ ♔g8 22 ♗xe6+ ♖f7 23 ♕g6+ ♔h8 24 ♗xf7 ♗f8 25 ♕g8 mate.

A2

5 fe *(62)*

Diemer's preferred method. It seems less dangerous to Black, however.

62
B



5 ... ♘xe4

Not 5 ... ♗xe4 6 ♘xe4 ♘xe4 7 ♕f3 ♘d6 (7 ... ♕xd4? 8 c3 ♕e5 9 ♗f4 ♕e6 10 0-0-0) 8 ♗f4 ♘c6 (8 ... c6 9 0-0-0; 8 ... ♘d7!?) 9 ♗d3! ♘xd4 10 ♕f2 ♘c6 11 0-0-0 ± Diemer-Keller, Villingen 1938.

6 ♕f3 ♘d6

Or 6 ... ♘xc3 when:

a) 7 bc ♕c8 8 ♗d3 ♗xd3 9 cd and now MCO (11th ed.) recommends 9 ... c6 ∓ Hoey-Lyon, US Forces Ch 1970. Black's plan is ... ♕e6+ followed by ... ♕d5, or if 10 ♘e2 then 10 ... ♘d7 11 0-0 ♘f6 12 ♗g5 ♕e6 13 ♘f4 ♕f5 and White cannot justify his pawn sacrifice.

b) 7 **♕xf5** ♘d5 (7 ... e6 8 ♕f3 ♕h4+ 9 g3 ♕e4+ 10 ♗e2! ± Seidal-Morozov, W.Germany-USSR corres 1959-60) and now Diemer recommends 8 a3 (e.g. 8 ... e6 9 ♕d3 and 10 ♘f3) to improve on 8 c4?! e6 (and 9 ... ♗b4+) or 8 ♗g5 h6 9 ♕h3 against which A. van der Tak's 9 ... hg 10 ♕xh8 ♘e3 seems

strong.

7 ♗f4 e6

Euwe used to recommend 7 ... ♕c8 but now acknowledges that Black has problems after 8 ♗xd6! cd (8 ... ed 9 0-0-0) 9 ♗b5+ ♗d7 10 ♘ge2! as in Focke-Mulherr, 1958.

8 0-0-0 c6

Strobl-Unzicker, Graz 1970, went instead 8 ... ♘d7 9 g4 ♗g6 10 ♕e3 ♗e7 11 ♘f3 f6!? (Unzicker lost an earlier game with 11 ... 0-0 12 h4 h5 13 ♘e5.) 12 ♕xe6 ♗f7 13 ♕e3 0-0 14 h4 ♘b6 15 d5 ♖e8 ±.

9 g4

MCO only considers 9 d5 cd (9 ... ♗e7 10 de ♗xe6 11 ♘e4+) 10 ♘xd5 ♗e4 11 ♕e3 ed 12 ♖xd5 ♗e7 (or 12 ... f5) 13 ♗b5+ ♘c6 14 ♗xc6+ bc 15 ♖xd6 ♗xd6 16 ♕xe4+ ♔f8 17 ♘f3 ♗xf4+ 18 ♕xf4 ♕f6 19 ♕b4+ ♕e7 ∓ - Diemer, Gunderam and Müller.

9 ... ♗g6

10 ♕e3

Here Black has:

a) **10 ... ♘d7?** 11 d5 cd 12 ♖xd5! ♕c7 13 ♖d2! a6 14 ♕g3 e5 15 ♗xe5 ♘xe5 16 ♘d5! ± - Hall.

b) **10 ... ♗e7** is critical, as Hall said in *Chess* 459-460. Can 11 d5!? (Rasa-Haase, Dunedin 1963) be sound after 11 ... cd, or should White first play Diemer's 11 ♘f3 (hoping for 11 ... ♘d7 12 d5!)? The piece sacrifice on d5 is always in the air, but possibly Black can deal with it.

B

4 ... ef

In view of the problems White is able to create for his opponent in Müller's Defence, it seems best to accept the gambit. Now:

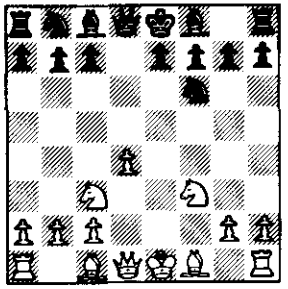
B1 5 ♘xf3

B2 5 ♕xf3?!

B1

5 ♘xf3 *(63)*

63 B



B11 5 ... ♗f5

B12 5 ... g6

Others are inferior:

a) **5 ... ♗g4** (Teichmann) 6 h3 (6 ♗c4!?; 6 ♗e2!? is also possible) and now:

a1) **6 ... ♗h5** 7 g4! ♗g6 8 ♘e5 (± - Euwe) or 8 ♗c4 e6 9 ♕e2 Hall-Nolte, Blackmar-Diemer World corres final.

a2) **6 ... ♗xf3** 7 ♕xf3 c6 (7 ... ♕xd4? 8 ♕xb7) 8 ♗e3 e6 (8 ... ♘bd7 9 0-0-0 ♘b6 10 d5! ⩲ - Diemer) 9 ♗d3 ♘bd7 (9 ... ♗d6!? - Rhodes) 10 0-0 (10 0-0-0 failed in G.Müller-Danner, Blackmar-Diemer thematic corres final) 10 ... ♗e7 11 ♖f2 (11 g4!? - Diemer) 11 ... ♕a5 12 0-0 is said to be = by MCO and ECO. Compare this with the continuation of Diemer-Gereben, Zwolle 1959: 13 ♖af1 h6 (13 ... e5 14 g5 ♘d5 15 ♕f5) 14 h4 c5 15 g5 hg 16 hg cd 17 ♕h3! de 18 ♖g2 ♖fc8 19 gf ♘f6 20 ♕h6 g6 21 ♗xg6 1-0.

b) **5 ... e6** (too passive) 6 ♗g5 (6 ♗d3 is also playable.) 6 ... ♗e7 (6 ... c5 7 d5 a6! - Euwe; or 7 ♗xf6! - Hall) 7 ♕d2 (7 ♗d3 is still strong.) 7 ... 0-0 8 ♗d3 ♘bd7 9 ♕f4 b6 10 ♕h4 ♖e8 11 ♘e5! with a dangerous attack; Diemer-R.Fuller, Hastings Challengers 1957, continued 11 ... ♘f8 12 ♘c6 ♕d6 13 ♘xe7+ ♕xe7 14 0-0 ♘g6 15 ♗xg6 fg 16 ♘e4 ♖f8 17 ♗xf6 gf 18 ♖xf6 ♖xf6 19 ♘xf6+ ♔h8 20 ♕e4 ♖b8 21 ♖f1 ♗b7 22 ♕e5 ♕d6 23 ♘e8+! 1-0.

c) **5 ... c5** 6 d5 g6 is a variant of B12. After 7 ♗f4 a6 8 a4 ♗g7 (Diemer-Bogoljubow, Constance 1948) White can obtain compensation for the pawn by 9 ♗c4 0-0 10 0-0 - Diemer. This needs tests.

B11

5 ... ♗f5

This natural developing move contests White's initiative. It was suggested by Tartakower.

6 ♘e5!?

White feels the need for early complications to justify his pawn sacrifice. Against other moves Black is able to consolidate by plans which are not hard to find, for example:

a) **6 ♗c4** e6 7 0-0 ♘bd7 8 ♕e2 c6 when:

a1) **9 ♘e5** ♘xe5 10 de can be countered by 10 ... ♕d4+ 11 ♔h1 ♘e4 ∓ (Hall) or 10 ... ♘d7 ∓ Elgstrand-Lim Hong Gie, ½-final 4th World Corres Ch 1959-61.

a2) **9 ♗g5 ♗e7** 10 ♖ad1 ♕c7 with a flexible, Caro-Kann type of position - and an extra pawn! Not now 11 ♘e5? because of 11 ... ♘xe5 12 de ♗g4 13 ♕f2 ♕xe5 ∓∓.

b) **6 ♗d3** ♗xd3 7 ♕xd3 ♘bd7 allows Black to choose between ... e6 or ... g6-based development plans, with a ... c5 or ... e5 freeing move when king safety has been achieved. The exchange of bishops reduces White's attacking prospects and Black's position has no weaknesses.

c) **6 ♗g5** (and maybe 6 ♘h4!? ♗g6 7 ♘xg6) offer White some scope for complicating the position. Black should, however, be safe with the same simple development as in notes a and b.

6 ... e6

The analyst G.Gunderam proposed 6 ... h5?! (to forestall g4) but White then seizes the initiative by 7 ♕f3! ♕c8 8 ♗c4 e6 9 ♗g5 and has good compensation for the sacrificed pawn. The plausible 9 ... ♗e7 is answered by 10 ♘xf7! ♗g4 11 ♕d3 ♔xf7 12 h3 as given by the U.S. master, Ken Smith.

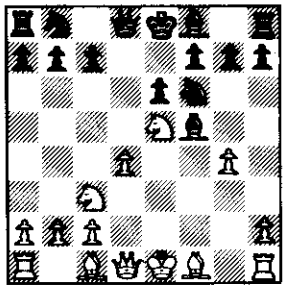
7 g4 *(64)*

This cut-throat continuation is almost always played.

A postal game Marhwardt-Poschk, 1963, went instead 7 ♕f3!? c6 8 ♗e3 ♘bd7 9 0-0-0 with chances for both sides. Black could attempt a direct refutation by 7 ... ♕xd4 8 ♕xb7 ♕xe5+ 9 ♗e2 ♗e4 ∞, e.g. 10 ♘xe4 ♕xe4 11 ♕c8+ ♔e7 12 ♕xc7+ ♘bd7 13 b3 ♘d5 14 ♗a3+ ♔e8 15 ♕b7 ♘c3 ∓∓.

There are now two distinct lines:

64
B



B111 7 ... ♘e4!?
B112 7 ... ♗g6

B111

7 ... ♘e4!?

Black goes for an immediate counter-attack.

8 ♗b5+!

The only move that is any good.

Others:

a) **8 ♕f3?** ♕xd4! (not 8 ... ♕h4+? 9 ♔e2!) ∓.

b) **8 h4?** ♘xc3 9 bc ♗e4 ∓.

c) **8 gf?** ♕h4+ 9 ♔e2 ♕f2+ 10 ♔d3 ♘c5+ 11 dc (11 ♔c4 a6 ∓ Diemer-Gunderam, corres 1958-59) 11 ... ♘a6 12 ♗e3 (or 12 ♘e4 0-0-0+ 13 ♔c3 ♕xf5) 12 ... ♖d8+ 13 ♔c4 ♕xe3 14 ♕xd8+ (14 ♘d3 ♖d4+ leads to mate.) 14 ... ♔xd8 15 ♘xf7+ ♔c8 16 ♘xh8 ♕f4+ ∓∓ Peilen-Kampars, Blackmar-Diemer thematic corres tournament 1968-69.

8	...	**c6**
9	**0-0**	**♘xc3**
10	**bc**	**♗g6**
11	**♗d3**	

If 11 ♘xg6 hg 12 ♕f3 ♕c7 13 ♗f4 then 13 ... ♗d6! poses White awkward problems, Seidel-Gunderam, corres 1963-64.

11	...	**♗d6**
12	**♗xg6!**	

If 12 ♘xg6 hg 13 ♖f2 ♕h4 14 ♕e2 ♘d7 Black's chances are preferable. Euwe gives 15 ♖b1 ♖b8 16 ♗xg6 0-0! but 15 ... 0-0-0 may be even better (16 ♖xf7? ♗xh2+). White can try 15 ♗xg6!? but the endgame after 15 ... ♗xh2+! 16 ♖xh2 ♕xh2+ 17 ♕xh2 ♖xh2 18 ♗xf7+ ♔xf7 19 ♔xh2 e5! is very poor by contrast with the one reached by the text move.

After 12 ♗xg6 Burger-Holzvoigt, 6th German Cup corres, went 12 ... hg 13 ♘xf7 ♗xh2+ 14 ♔g2 ♕d5+ 15 ♕f3! (improving on Gunderam's 15 ♖f3 0-0 16 c4 ♕xc4 ∓) 15 ... ♖f8 16 ♕xd5 ed 17 ♗a3! ♖xf7 18 ♖xf7 ♔f7 19 ♖f1+! This move guarantees that the white rook will reach the 7th rank, causing Black problems.

The game continued 19 ... ♔e8 (19 ... ♔e6 20 ♖e1+ ♔f6 may be somewhat better) 20 ♖f8+ ♔d7 21 ♔xh2 ♔c7 22 ♔g3 a5 23 ♗c1! b5 24 ♗f4+ ♔b7 25 ♖xb8+ with a winning ♔ and pawn ending.

B112

7 ... ♗g6

Black prefers to continue relying on natural moves.

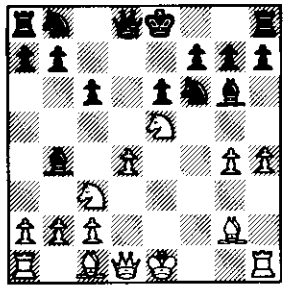
8 ♗g2

8 h4 ♗b4 9 ♗g2 c6 transposes. In this line White leaves his ♔-side wide open and makes many pawn moves - offences against the first principles. Of course Black still has to prove a refutation!

On the other hand, 8 ♕f3!? c6 (8 ... ♕xd4!? again) 9 g5 (or 9 ♗e3 ♗b4 10 ♗d3 ♘bd7 11 ♗xg6 hg - Gunderam) 9 ... ♘g8 10 ♗e3 ♘d7 11 h4 ♘d7 12 h5 ♘xe5 13 de ♗xc2 (Euwe) hardly seems to offer White any compensation for the two lost pawns.

8	...	**c6**
9	**h4**	**♗b4** *(65)*

65
W



10 0-0!?

White has also tried:

a) **10 ♗g5** ♕a5 11 ♗d2 ♗xc3? (but 11 ... ♘bd7 12 a3 ♗xc3 gains a tempo - Gunderam) 12 ♗xc3 ♕c7 13 ♕e2 with compensation thanks to the two bishops (1-0, 28) Sneiders-Fogel, corres 1965.

b) **10 h5** (Lagland-Fernandez, corres 1973-74) 10 ... ♗e4 11 ♗xe4 ♘xe4 12 ♕f3 ♘d6 13 0-0 0-0 - Gunderam. White's ♔-side looks exceedingly porous and he is still a pawn down. His nebulous tactical chances should not be sufficient compensation.

10 ... ♘bd7

10 ... ♗xc3 11 bc 0-0 also comes into consideration.

11 ♘xd7

If 11 h5? (or 11 g5 ♗h5! ∓ - Pachman) 11 ... ♘xe5! 12 de ♗c5+ 13 ♔h1 ♕xd1 14 ♖xd1 ♘xg4! ∓∓ Nicolaisen-Gjerdrum, corres.

11	...	**♕xd7**
12	**h5**	**♗xc3**
13	**bc**	**♗e4**
14	**h6**	**♗xg2**
15	**hg**	**♖g8**
16	**♖xf6**	

The German postal player Groth recommended 16 ♔xg2 in *Fernschach* 1972/9; e.g.:

a) **16** ... ♘d5 17 c4 ♘e7 (17 ... ♘b6 18 c5) 18 ♕f3 (or 18 ♗h6) 18 ... ♘g6 19 ♗h6 and White has the initiative.

b) **16** ... ♘e4 (16 ... ♕d5+ 17 ♔h3! ♘e4 18 ♗h6) 17 ♕f3 ♘d6 18 ♗h6 intending ♕d3.

c) However, I think that the shady side of White's position may be exploited by **16** ... ♘e4! 17 ♕f3 f5! supporting the ♘ on its strong square. Then if 18 ♗h6 0-0-0 19 ♖b1 ♖xg7! with a powerful counte attack, whilst the endgame after 18 gf ♖xg7+ 19 ♔h2 ef 20 ♕xf5 (or 20 ♕h5+ ♕f7) 20 ... ♕xf5 21 ♖xf5 ♘xc3 (or 21 ... 0-0-0) is clearly in Black's favour.

16 ... ♕e7! ∓

This is more active than 16 ... ♗e4 17 ♕e2 ♗g6 18 ♗h6 ♕d6 19 ♕f2 0-0-0 20 ♗f4 ♕d5 ∞ (1-0, 33) Diemer-Witte, BDG-World corres 1968-69.

After 16 ... ♕e7 Engler-Groth, German corres, went 17 ♖f2 ♗d5 18 ♗f4 (18 ♗h6? ♕h4) 18 ... ♖xg7 19 ♖h2 f5 20 g5 ♖xg5+! 21 ♗xg5 ♕xg5+ 22 ♔f1 0-0-0 23 ♕e2 ♖g8

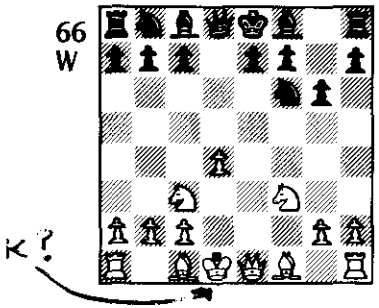
24 ♕f2 ♗c4+ 25 ♔e1 ♕g1+ 26 ♔d2 ♕xa1 27 ♖xh7 ♕f1 28 ♕xf1 ♗xf1 0-1. There is still scope for new invention but B112 seems to vindicate the Tartakower-Gunderam Defence.

B12

5 ... g6*(66)*

Bogoljubow's Defence, in which Black fianchettoes his king's bishop and aims for a solid position. White has no immediate threats to meet, so he can adopt any of several development schemes.

66
W



6 ♗c4

This is almost invariably chosen. Others:

a) **6 ♗g5!?** ♗g7 7 ♕d2 h6 (7 ... 0-0 compare note b) 8 ♗e3 ♘bd7 9 0-0-0 ♘b6 10 ♘e5 c6 11 ♗e2 ♘bd5 12 ♘xd5 ♘xd5 13 ♗f2 intending with pressure; Pape-Fechner, final, Blackmar-Diemer international thematic corres.

b) **6 ♗f4** ♗g7 7 ♕d2 0-0 8 0-0-0 (8 ♗c4!? - Diemer) 8 ... c5:

b1) 9 d5? a6 10 a4 b5 11 ab ab 12 ♗xb5 ♘e4 13 ♕e2 ♘xc3 14 bc ♗xc3 15 ♘d2 ♖a1+ 16 ♘b1 ♕a5 0-1 French-Teiler, corres 1967.

b2) **9 ♘b5!?** (Tejler, Hall) 9 ... ♘a6! (common sense) and Black stands well.

6 ... ♗g7

Now:

B121 7 0-0
B122 7 ♗g5
B123 7 ♘e5

Also:

a) 7 **♕e2!?** 0-0 8 ♗g5 ♗g4 9 0-0-0 (Gunderam) ∞.

b) 7 **♗f4** c6? 8 ♕d2 ♘bd7 9 ♗xf7+ ♔xf7 10 ♘g5+ ♔g8 11 ♘e6 ♕a5 12 0-0 ♘f8 13 ♘c7 ♖b8 14 ♖ae1 e6 15 ♗e5 ♘bd7 16 ♘3d5!! 1-0 (Roos-Fechner, final, Blackmar-Diemer thematic corres) shows how things can go wrong for Black even in this defence, if he neglects basic precautions such as castling.

B121

7 0-0 0-0
8 ♕e1*(67)*

The Studier Attack. Others:

a) **8 ♘e5?** ♘c6! 9 ♘xc6 bc when:

a1) **10 h3** ♘h5 (or 10 ... ♘d5 11 ♗b3 ♗a6 ∓ *Schach-Echo* 6/1953) 11 ♘e2 e5! 12 g4 ♕h4! ∓ Diemer-Niephaus, Freiburg 1951.

a2) **10 ♗f4** ♘fg4 11 d5 e5! 12 de ♕d4+! (0-1, 37) Diemer-Wolk, 5th match game 1951.

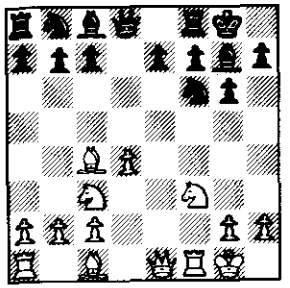
b) **8 ♗g5** c5 9 d5 h6 10 ♗h4 ♘e8! allows Black to consolidate his extra pawn; Diemer-Kloss, corres.

c) **8 ♗f4** or **8 ♔h1** (preparing ♗e3) have not been much studied. They should not be any better.

8 ... ♘bd7!

Not considered by Euwe. Most books give 8 ... ♘c6!? as the best

67
B



defence, e.g. 9 ♕h4 and now:

a) **9 ... ♘g4** (Brinckmann, Euwe) 10 h3! ♗xd4+ 11 ♔h1 ♗f6 12 ♘g5 h6 13 ♘xf7 ♕d4 14 ♖xf6 ef 15 ♘xh6+ ♔g7 16 ♘xg4 ♕xc4 17 ♗h6+ ♔f7 18 ♕xf6+ ♔e8 19 ♕xf8+ ♔d7 20 ♖d1+ 1-0 Studier-Hallier, Freiburg 1959.

b) **9 ... ♗g4** 10 ♗e3 ♗xf3 (10 ... ♕d7 11 ♘e5) 11 ♖xf3 is critical:

b1) **11 ... h6** 12 ♖ad1 (Zevers-Fritts, USA corres 1964-65) 12 ... ♔h7 and if 13 ♗xh6 ♗xh6 14 ♖h3 ♘g8 - Euwe.

b2) **11 ... e6** (Gunderam) e.g. 12 ♖af1 ♘d5 13 ♗g5 ♗xd4+ 14 ♔h1 f6 15 ♘e4 ♘ce7 (Duthilleul-Griesmann, Bordeaux 1958) 16 c3!? is unclear.

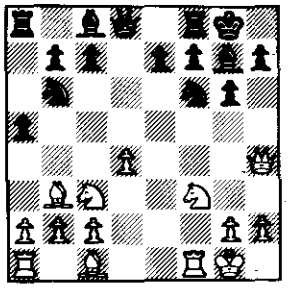
b3) **11** ... e5 12 d5 ♘d4 13 ♗xd4 ed 14 ♕xd4 ♘e8 = Brinckmann, Euwe.

9 ♕h4 ♘b6
10 ♗b3 a5*(68)*

Pachman gives this as favourite for Black. Too optimistic? This position was discussed by D.J. Rogers in *Correspondence Chess* 52/1976. White can try:

a) **11 ♗h6** a4 12 ♘g5 ab 13 ♗xg7 ♔xg7 14 ♖xf6 h6 15 ♖xf7+ ♖xf7

68
W



16 ♕xh6+ ♔xh6 17 ♘xf7+ ♔g7 18 ♘xd8 bc and Black seems to be winning, e.g. 19 ♖f1? ♗g4! or 19 ♖c1 c6 20 ♖xc2 ♖b8! (Rogers) or 19 d5 ♗f5!? 20 ♘xb7? ♘xd5 21 ♘xd5 ♖xa2 22 ♖c1 ♖xb2 23 ♘f4 ♖b1 24 ♘e2 ♗d3 ∓∓ - Harding.

b) **11 a4** and now:

b1) **11 ... ♘g4** 12 ♘e2 (12 h3 ♘f6 13 ♗h6 looks promising.) 12 ... ♘d5 13 c3 ♗f6! 14 ♗g5 ♘de3 ∓ Hayden-Rogers, corres 1975.

b2) **11 ... ♘bd5!?** was rejected by Rogers on account of 12 ♘xd5 ♘xd5 13 ♗xd5 ♕xd5 14 ♕xe7 (14 ... ♗xd4+? 15 ♘xd4 ♕xd4+ 16 ♔h1 threatening ♗h6). However, 14 ... ♕c6! 15 c3 (15 ♗f4 ♗f5! ∓) 15 ... ♗e6 16 ♗f4 ♖ac8 17 ♘e5!? ♕d5 seems to leave chances approximately equal. This deserves further investigation, as does:

b3) **11 ... ♗g4!?** - Pachman.

B12

7 ♗g5 0-0

Or 7 ... ♘bd7 8 ♕d2 c6 9 h3 b5 10 ♗d3 a6 11 0-0 0-0 12 ♗h6 ♘b6 13 ♖ae1 ♗e6 14 ♘e4 ♘xe4 15 ♗xe4 ♘c4 16 ♕c1 ♗d5 17 c3 ♘d6 18 ♗b1 f6 19 ♘h2 ♗xh6 20 ♕xh6

♘f7 21 ♕h4 ♔g7 22 ♘g4 ♕d6 23 ♖e3 ♖ae8 = Soller-Heuer, Switzerland 1959 (1-0, 46). This type of position offers White some positional compensation but it took Black several errors to lose.

8 ♕d2

This contrasts with the ♕e1-h4 manoeuvre characteristic of the Studier Attack. White in effect plays as if he were not a pawn down - the right policy against the Bogojubow Defence.

8 . . . a6

Others:

a) **8** ... c5!?, suggested in Richter and Teschner's book, *Schach-Eroffnungen*, led to an unclear position after 9 d5 ♘bd7 10 a4 ♘b6 11 ♗a2 ♗f5 12 0-0 in Stock-Pape, final, Blackmar-Diemer thematic corres tournament.

b) **8** ... **♗g4** 9 ♘e5 ♗f5 10 0-0-0 ♘bd7 11 ♕f4 ♘b6 (Stock-Fechner, same event) 12 ♗b3 a5! 13 g4 ♗c8! I think Black has better chances on the ♕-wing than White has on the ♔-wing.

9 a4 ♗f5
10 0-0 ♘c6

Richter and Teschner prefer 10 ... ♘bd7 with the idea that if 11 ♗h6 then 11 ... e6!

11 ♖ad1 ♘e4
12 ♘xe4 ♗xe4
13 ♗h6 ♗d5

If 13 ... ♗xf3 14 ♗xg7 ♗xd1 15 ♗xf8 ♕xd4+ 16 ♕xd4 ♘xd4 17 ♗xe7 White has a favourable ending.

14 ♗xg7 ♔xg7

Not 14 ... ♗xc4? 15 ♕h6! with the threat of ♘g5.

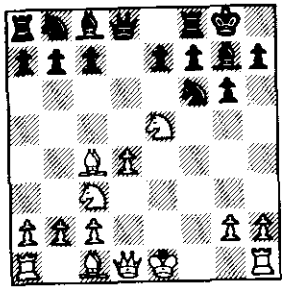
15 ♗e2 ♕d6
16 c4 ♗xf3

17 ♖xf3 ♖ad8 18 d5 ♕c5+ (18 ... h6! Δ 19 ♖h3 g5 or 19 ♕c3+ ♘e5 20 ♖e3 f6 - Richter and Teschner) 19 ♔h1 ♕b4 20 ♕e3 ♘a5 21 ♖h3 ♖h8 22 ♖f1 ♕xb2? 23 ♕xe7 ♖hf8 (23 ... ♖df8 24 ♖hf3!) 24 ♕h4 ♖h8 25 ♖xf7+! ♔xf7 26 ♖f3+ 1-0 Diemer-Vetter, Rastatt 1953.

B123

7 ♘e5 0-0*(69)*

69 W



8 ♗g5

Also worthy of consideration are:

a) **8 ♕e2!?** ∞.

b) **8 ♗f4** (perhaps best) when:

b1) **8** ... **♘bd7** 9 0-0 ♘h5? 10 ♘xf7! ♖xf7 11 ♗xf7+ ♔xf7 12 ♗xc7+.

b2) **8** ... **e6** 9 ♕d2 ♘d5 10 ♗xd5 ed 11 0-0-0 ♗e6 12 h4 h5? (12 ... ♘d7 is critical.) 13 g4! ♗xe5 14 de ♗xg4 15 ♗g5 ♕e8 16 ♘xd5 ♕e6 17 ♗e7 ♘d7 18 ♕h6 ♕xe5 19 ♗xf8 ♖xf8 20 ♖he1 1-0 Bohnke-Engel, corres.

8 . . . ♘bd7

Also possible is 8 ... ♘c6 e.g. 9 ♘xc6 bc 10 ♕d2 ♘d5 (Heil-Bogoljubow, Wangen 1962) and now 11 0-0-0! (Diemer) is only about equal (MCO 10).

9 0-0 c5!

Black reacts vigorously. Others:

a) **9** ... **c6** (Nievergelt; ∓ ECO) 10 ♗b3! (Diemer) and as Horowitz says, White has excellent prospects. Not 10 ... ♘xe5 (10 ... ♘b6 see b) 11 de ♕b6+ 12 ♔h1 ♘g4 because of 13 e6 ♘f2+ 14 ♖xf2 ♕xf2 15 ef+ ♖xf7 16 ♕d8+ ♗f8 17 ♘e4! (17 ♗h6 ♗h3!) 17 ... ♕f5 18 ♘g3 ♕xg5 19 ♗xf7+ ♔xf7 20 ♖f1+ ±± - Euwe.

b) **9** ... **♗b6** 10 ♗b3 c6 11 ♕d2 ♘bd5 (11 ... a5? 12 a4 ♘bd5 13 ♖ae1 ♘xc3 14 bc c5 15 ♕e3! Kaulich-Klenke, corres) 12 ♖ae1 (Diemer-Sutterer, Rastatt 1952) and now 11 ... ♗e6 (Euwe) is critical.

10 ♘xd7 ♕xd7!

Horowitz suggested 10 ... ♗xd7 11 dc ♕c7 = (12 b4 ♗f6), but this is untested.

11 d5 ♘g4

Here White has:

a) **12 h3** ♘e5! 13 ♗b5 ♕c7 14 d6 and now the exchange offer 14 ... ♕xd6! 15 ♕xd6 ed 16 ♗e7 ♗e6 gives Black at least equality - Diemer, Euwe.

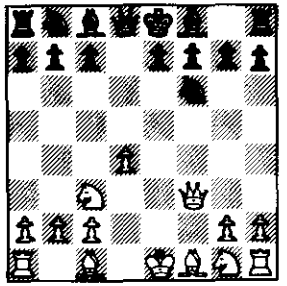
b) **12 ♕e1** ♕d6 13 ♕h4 (or 13 ♗f4 e5 - Euwe) 13 ... f6 14 ♗f4 e5 15 ♗d2 (15 ♘e4 ♕d8) 15 ... f5 16 h3 ♘f6 17 ♘b5 ♕d8 18 d6+ ♔h8 19 ♗g5 a6 20 ♘c7 ♖b8 and Black has a tenable position - Kloss in *Fernschach* 1954. Diemer supports his assessment with the sample continuation 21 ♖ad1 b5 22 ♗e6 ♖b6 23 ♗xc8 ♕xc8 24 ♘d5 ♘xd5 25 ♖xd5 ♕d7! (26 ♗e7 ♖fc8).

B2

5 ♕xf3!?*(70)*

It is sometimes claimed that this move, the subject of Diemer's book *Vom Ersten Zug An Auf Matt* ('Towards mate from move one') is stronger than the recapture with the knight. It has certainly been less analysed than 5 ♘xf3 but its soundness is more debatable.

70 B



White leaves a second tempting pawn en prise, but if Black declines it then where is the white king's knight to be developed?

5 . . . g6!

Bogoljubow's Defence is clearly best here, I think.

Others:

a) **5** ... **♕xd4** is given as the refutation by both Euwe and Pachman, but matters are not so clear after:

a1) **6 ♗f4** (intending 7 ♘b5) - Bagirov, ECO.

a2) Not **6 ♗d3?** ♕g4 7 ♕f2 e5 8 ♘f3 ♗b4 ∓ - Pachman.

a3) If **6 ♗e3!?** then:

a31) 6 ... ♕b4? 7 0-0-0 ♗g4?! 8 ♘b5! ±± is a famous trap.

a32) **6** ... **♕g4** 7 ♕f2 e5 is critical (not 7 ... ♕b4? 8 0-0-0 ♘g4 9 ♘d5!

♕a5 10 ♕e1! ± Diemer), e.g. 8 ♗d3 e4 (or 8 ... ♗b4 9 ♘ge2 Δ 10 0-0-0 - Diemer) 9 ♗c4 ♕f5 10 ♕g3 c6 11 ♘h3. This line has occurred in a few postal games and deserves more testing.

b) 5 ... c6 6 ♗d3 (6 ♗e3!? - ECO) when:

b1) 6 ... ♕xd4 7 ♗e3 ♕g4 8 ♕f2 e5 9 h3 ♕h5 10 ♘ge2 ♗d6 11 0-0-0 (Δ 12 g4) 11 ... e4 12 ♗xe4 ♘xe4 13 ♘xe4 ♗e7 14 ♘f4 ♕a5 15 ♕g3 0-0 16 ♖d5!! cd 17 ♘h5 g6 18 ♘hf6+ ♗xf6 19 ♘xf6+ ♔g7 20 ♕e5 ♔h8 21 ♗h6 ♘c6 22 ♗g7+! ♔xg7 23 ♘e8+ ♔h6 24 ♕f4+ g5 25 ♕f6+ ♔h5 26 ♘g7+ 1-0 Mabbs-L. Alexander, London 1961.

b2) 6 ... **♗g4** 7 ♕f2 e6 8 h3 ♗h5 9 ♘ge2 ♘bd7 10 0-0 ♗e7 11 g4 ♗g6 12 g5! ♕a5 (12 ... ♗xd3 13 gf ♗xe2 14 fg) 13 gf gf 14 ♘f4 0-0-0 15 ♗d2 ♕g5+ 16 ♔h1 ♕h6 17 ♕h2! ♕h4 (17 ... ♗xd3 18 ♘e6! ♗d6 19 ♗xh6 ♗xh2 20 ♘xd8 ♗xf1 21 ♘xf7) 18 ♖fg1 f5 19 b4 e5 20 b5!! ef 21 bc ♘b6 22 cb+ ♔xb7 23 ♗f4 ♗d6 24 ♗xd6 ♖xd6 25 ♕xd6 ♗h5 26 ♕g3 1-0 (Honfi-Füster, Hungarian Ch 1950) is that rarity - a Blackmar-Diemer between two players of genuine IM strength, and won by White at that.

6 ♗f4

Or 6 ♗d3 ♗g7 7 ♘ge2 0-0 8 ♗f4 ♘c6 9 0-0-0 transposing.

6 ... ♗g7
7 0-0-0

Diemer has also experimented with 7 ♘b5!? ♘a6 and now 8 ♘ge2 or 8 0-0-0.

7 ... 0-0
8 ♗d3

If 8 ♗c4 ♘bd7! (8 ... ♘c6 9 d5) 9 ♘ge2 (or 9 ♘b5 ♘e8 10 ♕g3 ♘d6) 9 ... ♘b6 10 ♗b3 a5 intending ... ♗g4 and/or ... ♘bd5 - analysis.

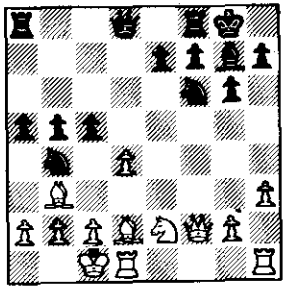
8 ... ♘c6!

Diemer-Burger, 1950, went instead 8 ... ♘bd7 (8 ... ♗g4? 9 ♕xb7) 9 g4! c5 10 h4! cd 11 h5 dc 12 g5 cb+ 13 ♔b1 ♘b6 14 gf ♗xf6 15 hg ♘a4 16 gf+ winning the queen. Another Diemer game went 8 ... c6 9 ♘ge2 ♗e6 10 h4 ♘d5 11 h5! etc.

9 ♘ge2 ♗g4
10 ♕f2 ♘b4
11 ♗c4 c6
12 h3 ♗xe2
13 ♘xe2 b5
14 ♗b3 a5
15 ♗d2 *(71)*

Or 15 c3 a4 16 a3 ab 17 cb ♘d5 ∓ Oscarsson-Hornstein, ½-final 4th Corres World Ch 1959-61.

71
B



Black is probably winning. Two examples:

a) 15 ... **a4!?** 16 ♗xb4? ab 17 a3 ♗h5+ 18 ♔b1 bc+ 19 ♔xc2 ♘d5! 20 ♕h4! ♗g7 21 ♗c5 ♘e3+ 22 ♔c1 ♗f6 23 ♕e4 ♘xd1 24 ♖xd1 ♕d5 25 ♕xd5! cd 26 ♘c3 ♖fb8 27 ♘xd5 ♗g5+ 28 ♔b1 ♖b7! 29 ♖d3 e6 30 ♘c3 f5 31 ♔a2 ♖d8 32 ♔b3 e5 33 d5 e4 34 ♖d1 ♗f6 35 ♔b4 ♗xc3 36 ♔xc3 ♖bd7 37 d6 ♔f7 38 ♖d4 ♔e6 39 a4 ♖c8 40 b4 ba 41 ♔c4 a3 42 ♖d2 ♖a8 43 ♖a2 ♖xd6 44 ♗xd6 ♔xd6 and Black won; Diemer-Bogoljubow, South Baden Ch 1949. However, White may be able to get away with 16 ♗xf7+! ♖xf7 17 ♗xb4 ♘d5 18 ♕e1 e.g. 18 ... ♘e3 19 ♖d3 ♘xg2? 20 ♕g3. Therefore, when I reached the diagram position in a postal game, I played instead:

b) **15 ... ♘bd5** 16 ♘g3 a4 17 ♗xd5 ♘xd5 ∓ Now Micklethwaite-Harding, corres 1974-75, continued 18 h4 (possibly 18 ♔b1) 18 ... b4 19 h5 b3 20 cb ab 21 a3 ♕b6 22 ♘e2 ♖xa3?!! (22 ... c5! is less flamboyant, but more accurate.) 23 ba ♕a6 24 ♔b2? (24 ♗c3! might be a refutation.) 24 ... ♕d3 25 ♔a1 ♕c2 0-1.

Conclusion

Black can decline the gambit by Müllers 4 ... ♗f5 but White seems to get adequate tactical chances in A1, and maybe even in A2. Acceptance of the gambit seems best, followed by ... g6 if White captured with the queen. If White plays the superior 5 ♘xf3 then the choice is between ... g6 once again, or the more forcing Tartakower-Gunderam Defence, 5 ... ♗f5. If then 6 ♘e5 e6 7 g4 ♗g6! Bear in mind that Bogoljubow is the only world-class player to be involved in Blackmar-Diemer praxis, and that he always preferred plans involving the ♔-side fianchetto for Black. He obtained good results so there seem to be good grounds for following his example. Black after all should be looking for lines that give him winning chances, not for equalizing continuations.

From White's point of view, you are probably not afraid of risk (in fact you probably enjoy it) or else you would not consider playing this gambit. It certainly offers good practical chances of an attacking win and relatively few opponents will feel comfortable against it. The viability of the Blackmar-Diemer in postal chess at sub-master level shows that the correct defences are by no means obvious to everyone.

If you hope to reach a Blackmar-Diemer after 1 d4 ♘f6, you can try 2 ♘c3 (as 2 ... d5 3 e4 ♘xe4 4 ♘xe4 de 5 ♗c4 is good) but 2 ... c5 is often the answer. You are most likely to get what you want via 2 f3!? d5 (2 ... c5 can now lead to a Sämisch King's Indian) 3 e4 de 4 ♘c3. Good hunting!

Index of Complete Games

(underlined = player named was White)

L.Alexander 100
Anderssen 90
Antoshin 68
Aronson 16
Bagirov 4
Bernstein 45
Blackburne 12
Bogoljubow 31
Bohnke 98
Boleslavsky 58, 68
Böök 30
Botterill 61
Bronstein 49, 54
Buerger 20
Bukhman 70
Bukic 1
Capablanca 37, 38, 85
Carleton 29
Catala 30
Cederquist 43
Charousek 7
Chernev 35
Ciric 41
Chernikov 70
Colle 18, 20, 31, 31, 35, 37, 71
Cvetkovic 48
Denker 35
Diemer 93, 98
Dunkelblum 39
Elgstrand 90
Enevoldsen 6
Engel 98
Engler 95
Euwe 16, 71
Fairhurst 43
Farago 49
Flohr 37
Franklin 29, 60, 61
French 96
R.Fuller 93
Füster 100
Gerasimov 14
Grekov 83
Groth 95
Gulko 55
Hallier 97
Harding 101
Honfi 90, 100
Iglitsky 36
Kan 36
Karpov 39
Keogh 43
Koltanowski 19, 30, 37
Kopayev 26
Kots 54
Kottnauer 68
Kovacevic 41
Larsen 55
Leonhardt 43
Mabbs 100
Marovic 47
Marshall 5, 42, 85
Mattison 35
Melcher 88
Micklethwaite 101
Milner-Barry 71
Napolitano 45
Nenarokov 83
Nilssen 90
Nimzowitsch 6
O'Hanlon 31
O'Kelly 30
Olafsson 55, 68
Platonov 39
Rakic 4, 47, 48
Rantanen 43
Ree 60
Rubinstein 16, 38
von Scheve 5
Schlechter 43
Schmidt 88
Selesniev 42
Smyslov 14, 58
Sorokin 86
Soultanbeieff 39
Spassky 1
Spielmann 19
Stoltz 18
Stolyar 16
Studier 97
Suchting 7
Sultan Khan 71
Talvik 86
Tejler 96
Vaganian 55
Vetter 98
Yasvoin 26
Zukertort 12

Index of Variations

Page numbers italicised.

Colle

1 d4 ♘f6 2 ♘f3 Δ e3

2 ... e6 3 e3 d5 4 ♗d3
4 ... b6 *19*
4 ... ♗e7 *19*
4 ... ♗d6 *20*
4 ... c5 5 b3 *12*
4 ... c5 5 c3 ♘c6 6 ♘bd2 ♗d6 *23*
6 ... ♗e7 *28*
5 ... ♘bd7 6 ♘bd2 ♗d6 *29*
6 ... ♗e7 *32*
2 ... e6 3 e3 b6 *34*
3 ... c5 4 ♘bd2 b6 *38*
2 ... d5 3 e3 g6 *16*
3 ... c5 *17*
3 ... ♗g4 *69*
3 ... ♗f5 *70*
3 ... c6 *72*

London

1 d4 Δ 2 ♘f3, 3 ♗f4

1 ... d5 2 ♘f3 e6 3 ♗f4 *41*
2 ... c5 3 ♗f4 *42*

2 ... ♘f6 3 ♗f4 c5 *43*
3 ... e6 *45*
1 ... ♘f6 2 ♘f3 e6 3 ♗f4 c5 4 c3 ♕b6 *49*
2 ... g6 3 ♗f4 ♗g7 4 c3 *53*
4 ♘bd2 *54*
4 e3 0-0 *56*
4 ... d6 *63*
3 ♘c3 d5 4 ♗f4 *66*

Miscellaneous
1 d4 d5 2 ♘f3

2 ... ♗g4 *73*
2 ... ♗f5 *74*
2 ... ♘c6 *76*
2 ... c5 3 c4 *78*
2 ... c5 3 dc *79*

1 d4 ♘f6

2 ♘f3 d6 *81*
2 ... c5 *81*
2 e3 ♘f6 3 ♗d3 c5 4 c3 e6 5 f4 (Stonewall) *83*

Blackmar-Diemer Gambit
1 d4 d5 2 e4 de *88*

3 ♘c3 ♘f6 4 f3 ♗f5 5 g4 *90*
5 fe *91*
4 ... ef 5 ♘xf3 ♗f5 *93*
5 ... g6 *96*
5 ♕xf3 *99*